

Mapping the Consumption Gap:  
Planned Data Center Capacity versus Electricity Supply in  
California

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# Abstract

California’s utilities reported 23,277 MW of data center energization requests to the California Energy Commission (CEC) in December 2025, of which 20,677 MW are located in the state: 5,086 MW with signed agreements, 6,987 MW in active applications and 8,604 MW of inquiries. That is 40 percent of the record CAISO peak and about twenty times the roughly 1,000 MW of data center load that exists. This report asks how much of it is likely to be served by 2030, whether California’s supply can keep up, what a flexible load could do about the difference, and how well the state’s way of counting compares with the other regimes in use. It is an independent replication and audit of the CEC’s data center forecast method, built on public data with every input recorded in a manifest and every figure traceable to its files.

The CEC’s published confidence levels and utilization factor, with SVP’s requests exempt as the Commission states, reproduce the CEC’s own 2040 endpoints exactly and its 2030 components within 2 to 6 percent. Applied symmetrically to the supply side, a completion model estimated on 925 unit-vintages of California’s own planned generators since 2016 removes a third of the 20 GW planned list for 2030. A 10,000-draw Monte Carlo over both sides puts the 2030 gap between demand growth and supply growth at 50 TWh (19 to 78) and 7.2 GW at the net peak (4.2 to 10.1), with data centers 18 TWh and 2.3 GW of it; the proposal’s upper bound, every requested megawatt operating flat, gives 202 to 242 TWh and 25 to 30 GW. Imports, the state’s own load forecast, hydro and Diablo Canyon drive the energy gap, not the data center assumptions. Replicating the Duke Nicholas Institute’s method on CAISO hourly load gives 3.8 GW of curtailment-enabled headroom at 0.5 percent curtailment, twice the probability-weighted data center addition and half the weighted peak gap. Under seven counting regimes the same requests are 20,677 MW (the California, Texas and Finnish registry rules), 5,086 MW (PJM and the Texas forecast rule), about 2,400 MW at ERCOT’s realized phase-transition rates and about 1,000 MW as measured load. The data are frozen on September 26, 2026, the repository is tagged, and the processed outputs ship with the report.

# Summary for the Reader

This page answers the questions the project set out to answer, in one line each, and says where in the report the evidence sits. Every number below appears in a figure or table of the chapter named, and every figure carries a source line naming the files and manifest ids it was built from.

| Question                                                        | Answer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Where                            |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Where does the grid stand today?                                | CAISO demand has been flat at 216 to 224 TWh a year since 2019, but its shape changed: spring midday net load fell from 10.6 to 6.4 GW while the 20:00 net load stayed near 22 to 25 GW; the record peak is 52,061 MW (September 6, 2022); prices at the SCE point were negative in 877 hours of 2025; the accounting carbon intensity fell from 257 to 186 g/kWh. | Chapter 2, Figures 2.1 to 2.7    |
| How much of the state's power do data centers use?              | About 3 to 4 percent: 7.0 to 9.3 TWh a year against 240 TWh of retail sales, roughly 1,000 MW of peak; a range of estimates, not one number.                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Chapter 2, Figure 2.8            |
| How high is data center construction?                           | Nationally from USD 1.6 to 75.2 billion a year (2014 to mid-2026) with a break in early 2022 and 61 percent a year after it; California's own indicators (employment, Silicon Valley construction) did not move, but requests to connect did.                                                                                                                      | Chapter 3, Figures 3.1 to 3.3    |
| RQ1: how large is the pipeline, by stage, relative to the grid? | 20,677 MW in California (5,086 signed, 6,987 applications, 8,604 inquiries): 40 percent of the record peak, 21 times existing data center load, 5 times the state's forecast peak growth to 2030; as energy, 181 TWh a year if all ran flat, 84 percent of CAISO's demand.                                                                                         | Chapter 3, Figure 3.4, Table 3.9 |
| How has supply grown?                                           | In-state generation 204 to 205 TWh (2010 to 2025) with gas 53 to 36 percent and solar plus wind 3 to 34 percent; capacity 73 to 107 GW; 65 percent of planned generators since 2016 were built; 6.5 GW retire by 2030.                                                                                                                                             | Chapter 4                        |
| RQ2: the 2030 gap?                                              | Median 50 TWh and 7.2 GW (5th to 95th percentile 19 to 78 TWh, 4.2 to 10.1 GW), of which data centers are 18 TWh and 2.3 GW; the upper bound of every MW running flat is 202 to 242 TWh and 25 to 30 GW.                                                                                                                                                           | Chapter 5, Figures 5.1 to 5.3    |
| RQ4: what can flexibility absorb?                               | 3.8 GW at 0.5 percent curtailment (Duke's method on CAISO load; Duke: 5.0), twice the weighted data center load, half the weighted peak gap, a fifth of the upper bound.                                                                                                                                                                                           | Chapter 5, Figure 5.4            |
| RQ3: how do the counting regimes compare?                       | The same requests are 20,677 MW under California's, Texas's and Finland's rules, 5,086 under PJM's, about 2,400 at ERCOT's realized rates and about 1,000 as measured load; ERCOT scores highest on timeliness, California on coverage.                                                                                                                            | Chapter 5, Figures 5.5 to 5.6    |
| What is the contribution?                                       | An independent replication and audit of the CEC's forecast method: its parameters reproduce its own numbers; the supply side is discounted the same way; the gap comes with its uncertainty and its drivers named.                                                                                                                                                 | Chapter 6                        |

**Glossary.** **CAISO:** the California Independent System Operator, the nonprofit that runs the wholesale market and high-voltage grid for about 80 percent of the state’s load; the rest is served by other balancing authorities such as LADWP and SMUD. **Balancing authority:** the entity that keeps supply and demand matched in a defined area; EIA-930 reports hourly load by balancing authority. **CEC, IEPR, CED:** the California Energy Commission, its biennial Integrated Energy Policy Report, and the California Energy Demand forecast adopted through it. **Energization request and tiers:** a customer’s request for utility service, sorted by the CEC into inquiries, active applications and signed agreements. **Confidence level, utilization factor, ramp:** the CEC’s three discounts, the probability a request is built, the share of requested capacity actually drawn at peak (67 percent), and the years to full load. **Net load:** demand minus utility-scale solar and wind, the load the rest of the fleet must serve. **Curtailement:** solar or wind output turned down because it cannot be used or moved. **DLAP:** a default load aggregation point, the price node at which a utility’s load settles. **ELCC:** effective load-carrying capability, the share of a resource’s nameplate that counts toward the peak. **PRM:** planning reserve margin, the capacity held above the expected peak. **ERCOT, PJM:** the Texas grid operator and the Mid-Atlantic regional transmission organization, used here for their published queue and forecast rules. **Firm and non-firm:** PJM’s split between requests backed by a service obligation and those that are not. **Once-through cooling (OTC):** coastal gas units whose cooling-water permits set their retirement dates. **Headroom:** the constant load that could be added before demand exceeds the historical peak more than a stated share of the time, given curtailement. **Monte Carlo, Sobol index:** repeated random draws of the inputs to get a distribution of the result, and the share of that result’s variance attributable to each input.

# Chapter 1

## Introduction

### 1.1 The question

At the IRTF SUSTAIN workshop in July 2026, Jukka Manner showed that Finland operates about 285 MW of data centers while its public investment registry lists 7,777 MW more, phased from feasibility study to investment decision [Manner, 2026]. The registry makes the gap between what is planned and what exists visible in one place. The United States has no such registry. What is known about planned American data centers is scattered across state energy agencies, grid operators, utility filings and commercial trackers, each counting in its own units and at its own stage of maturity, and the same project can appear in several of them at once.

California is the largest state without a registry and the one whose numbers travel furthest. In December 2025 its utilities reported 23,277 MW of data center energization requests to the California Energy Commission (CEC), sorted into three tiers: 5,086 MW with signed service agreements, 9,587 MW in active applications and 8,604 MW of inquiries [California Energy Commission, 2026b,d]. The CEC does not count those requests at face value. It applies a confidence level to each tier, a utilization factor and a ramp, and carries the result into the adopted demand forecast as 1,743 MW at the 2030 CAISO peak in its Planning forecast and 4,377 MW in its Local Reliability scenario [California Energy Commission, 2026e]. Whether those discounts are right is an empirical question that the state’s own record, and the records of Texas and the Mid-Atlantic, can inform.

### 1.2 Research questions and scope

The proposal set four research questions, restated here for a California-only scope after Finland was dropped as a replication target and kept only as the motivating example:

- **RQ1.** How large is California’s planned data center pipeline by stage, in absolute terms and relative to the grid it would connect to?
- **RQ2.** What is the gap between planned demand and supply through 2030, raw and probability-weighted, in annual energy and at the net peak?
- **RQ3.** How do the data and measurement regimes that count planned loads, the CEC tiers, ERCOT’s interconnection phases, PJM’s firm and non-firm vetting, the EIA pilot survey, Texas SB 6 and FERC Docket RM26-4, differ, and what would California’s headline number be under each?

- **RQ4.** How much of the gap could load flexibility absorb, measured as the curtailment-enabled headroom of the existing system?

Alongside those, the report answers the questions asked during the work: how much of the state’s electricity data centers use today, how high data center construction has climbed since the release of ChatGPT, where the grid stands now, and how California’s generation has grown. Texas and PJM enter as data rather than as narrative. ERCOT publishes the only monthly, phase-level series of large-load requests large enough to estimate how a pipeline actually moves, and PJM publishes the only explicit firm and non-firm rule; both are used to test the CEC’s discounts rather than to compare states.

The geographic boundary is stated wherever it matters. Hourly load, prices and carbon intensity are CAISO’s; generation, capacity, retirements and the demand forecast are statewide; the tiers are California-only, with the 2,600 MW that Valley Electric Association reported for Nevada carried as a memo line because it sits inside the CAISO balancing area but outside the state. The request data are the December 2025 vintage, the newest complete set at the data freeze.

### 1.3 Contribution

The contribution is an independent replication and audit of the CEC’s method with transparent, tested assumptions rather than a new forecast. Five things are new. First, the CEC’s published parameters are shown to reproduce its own forecast, including the exemption of Silicon Valley Power’s queue that the methodology memo states but does not quantify, so the forecast can be rebuilt and varied by anyone (Chapter 5). Second, the supply side is discounted with the same discipline as the demand side, using a completion model estimated on every California generator planned since 2016 and the outcome of each by December 2025 (Chapter 4). Third, the CEC’s confidence levels are set against two external yardsticks: monthly phase-transition rates estimated from ERCOT’s queue reports and the firm-only rule PJM applies (Chapter 5). Fourth, the gap is reported as a distribution with a stated upper bound, with a sensitivity analysis that names the assumptions that move it. Fifth, the Duke Nicholas Institute’s headroom method is replicated on CAISO load and expressed as a share of the gap, and seven counting regimes, Finland’s EK registry among them, are scored on a common rubric with the same requests restated under each rule.

Every number in the report can be followed back to a file. Raw downloads are immutable and recorded with their URL, access date and SHA-256 in a manifest; the processed outputs, figures and LaTeX tables are regenerated by one command per chapter; every figure carries its source line, naming the processed files, manifest ids and code that produced it; the appendix repeats those lines as tables; and the data are frozen on a stated date, the repository tagged, and the processed outputs exported with the report.

### 1.4 Related work in brief

The national picture is set by the Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory’s usage reports and EPRI’s state table, which put data centers at a few percent of United States consumption in 2023 with California among the larger states [Electric Power Research Institute, 2024]; Chapter 2 uses EPRI’s California share as one of four estimates of existing use. The CEC’s own methodology memo, its preliminary and final forecast decks and the CED 2025 forms are the primary documents this report audits [California Energy Commission, 2026d, 2025, Smith, 2026, California Energy Commission, 2026c]. On attrition, LBNL’s interconnection-queue studies and NERC’s large-load

assessments document how few requests reach operation and how often the same project is submitted in several places; this report estimates California’s own generator attrition from EIA-860M vintages instead of borrowing a national rate [U.S. Energy Information Administration, 2026b]. The Duke Nicholas Institute’s headroom study supplies the flexibility method and the CAISO values that Chapter 5 replicates [Norris et al., 2025]. The break-test and forecasting methods of Chapter 3 follow Chow and Bai and Perron [Chow, 1960, Bai and Perron, 1998, 2003], and the sensitivity analysis uses Sobol indices as implemented in SALib [Sobol’, 2001, Herman and Usher, 2017].

## 1.5 Structure of the report

Chapter 2 measures the grid as it stands and the range of existing data center use. Chapter 3 measures data center growth, reproduces the Census construction chart with break tests, builds California proxies and answers RQ1 from the tier vintages. Chapter 4 builds the supply side: generation and imports since 2010, capacity, storage and curtailment, the retirement schedule, the realization model and probability-weighted supply for 2030. Chapter 5 puts the two sides together for RQ2, replicates the headroom method for RQ4 and compares the counting regimes for RQ3. Chapter 6 restates the contribution, sets out what the audit found about each of the CEC’s assumptions, draws the policy implications and states the limits. Appendix A lists the provenance of every figure.

## Chapter 2

# Current Status of Data Centers and the Grid in California

This chapter establishes the baseline that the gap analysis in later chapters is measured against. It answers two questions: what the CAISO grid looks like hour by hour today, and how much electricity California’s existing data centers already use. Every number is computed from the raw files listed in `data/raw/manifest.csv`; the notebook `notebooks/01_baseline_grid.ipynb` reproduces each table and figure.

### 2.1 Grid baseline: CAISO demand, net load and imports, 2019–2025

Hourly demand, generation by fuel and net interchange for the CAISO balancing authority come from the EIA-930 Hourly Electric Grid Monitor, using EIA’s “Adjusted” series [U.S. Energy Information Administration, 2026d]. Net load is demand minus utility-scale solar and wind. Two definitional points matter. First, EIA-930 demand for CISO includes battery charging and pumping load, whereas CAISO’s own reported demand excludes charging; in 2025 the hourly gap between the two series tracks battery charging almost one for one (slope 0.91, correlation 0.87). Both definitions are kept in the processed table. Second, EIA’s series contains reporting artifacts, chiefly in early 2019, where demand falls implausibly below CAISO’s demand plus charging; those hours are nulled rather than corrected, leaving 8,435 valid hours in 2019 (325 missing, 3.7 percent) and at most 27 missing hours in any later year; annual energy is the mean of the valid hours times the calendar hours, which imputes the missing hours at the annual mean, and the duration curves and profiles below are drawn over valid hours only. Third, EIA-930 carries no CISO interchange at all, in any of its reported, imputed or adjusted variants, from July 2 to November 3, 2024, and no hydro for parts of 2019 and 2020; those hours are filled from CAISO’s own five-minute imports and hydro series through a per-year linear calibration fitted on the overlapping hours (correlation 0.986 or better; the fill log is `ch1_eia930_fill_log.csv`). Fourth, EIA warns that CAISO changed its data collection for natural gas in December 2023 and that the EIA-930 gas series is not comparable across that date [U.S. Energy Information Administration, 2025b]. The warning is confirmed here: through November 2023 EIA’s CISO gas generation matches CAISO’s own five-minute fuel mix to within 0.1 TWh a month, and from December 2023 it exceeds it by 0.7 to 1.8 TWh a month, 20 TWh in 2024 and 25 TWh in 2025 (`ch1_gas_series_comparability_monthly.csv`). Gas figures in Tables 2.2 and 2.3 are EIA’s series and must not be compared across that month; Table 2.1 shows the month-by-month comparison.

Table 2.1: EIA-930 CISO natural gas generation against CAISO’s own fuel-mix gas series around the December 2023 reporting change, with the gas CO<sub>2</sub> factor implied by CAISO’s accounting.

| Month      | EIA-930 CISO gas (TWh) | CAISO fuel-mix gas (TWh) | EIA minus CAISO (TWh) | CAISO gas share of demand (%) | Implied gas CO <sub>2</sub> factor, CAISO accounting (kg/MWh) |
|------------|------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sep 2023   | 7.09                   | 7.09                     | +0.01                 | 38.0                          | 440                                                           |
| Oct 2023   | 9.05                   | 9.06                     | -0.01                 | 50.8                          | 441                                                           |
| Nov 2023   | 8.05                   | 7.97                     | +0.08                 | 48.8                          | 438                                                           |
| Dec 2023   | 8.94                   | 8.25                     | +0.69                 | 47.8                          | 432                                                           |
| Jan 2024   | 9.21                   | 7.94                     | +1.26                 | 47.9                          | 439                                                           |
| Feb 2024   | 6.34                   | 5.13                     | +1.21                 | 33.6                          | 440                                                           |
| Mar 2024   | 4.85                   | 3.36                     | +1.49                 | 21.9                          | 440                                                           |
| Apr 2024   | 4.49                   | 2.71                     | +1.78                 | 18.6                          | 452                                                           |
| 2023 total | 88.0                   | 87.2                     | +0.8                  | —                             | —                                                             |
| 2024 total | 85.5                   | 65.2                     | +20.3                 | —                             | —                                                             |
| 2025 total | 79.0                   | 54.2                     | +24.8                 | —                             | —                                                             |

Table 2.2: CAISO annual baseline from EIA-930 (Adjusted series), 2019–2025. Demand energy is the mean of valid hours times calendar hours. Storage charging is the estimated net charging of the CAISO battery fleet from the five-minute fuel mix. Import share is net imports divided by demand. Gas is EIA’s series, not comparable across December 2023.

| Year | Demand (TWh) | Peak (GW) | Load factor | Peak net load (GW) | Min net load (GW) | Solar (TWh) | Wind (TWh) | Storage charging (TWh) | Net imports (TWh) | Imports (% of demand) |
|------|--------------|-----------|-------------|--------------------|-------------------|-------------|------------|------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------|
| 2019 | 215.8        | 43.8      | 0.56        | 40.5               | 5.2               | 27.7        | 15.9       | 0.1                    | 53.8              | 25                    |
| 2020 | 218.0        | 46.6      | 0.53        | 44.0               | 5.6               | 28.6        | 14.9       | 0.1                    | 59.4              | 27                    |
| 2021 | 219.2        | 43.6      | 0.57        | 40.5               | 3.0               | 32.8        | 18.3       | 0.9                    | 54.5              | 25                    |
| 2022 | 223.7        | 51.1      | 0.50        | 47.5               | 1.9               | 35.8        | 17.4       | 1.7                    | 48.7              | 22                    |
| 2023 | 218.2        | 44.0      | 0.57        | 41.8               | 1.7               | 37.2        | 16.4       | 4.4                    | 28.8              | 13                    |
| 2024 | 224.1        | 47.6      | 0.54        | 42.4               | 0.3               | 44.8        | 20.1       | 9.5                    | 31.7              | 14                    |
| 2025 | 224.1        | 43.9      | 0.58        | 39.8               | -3.3              | 49.7        | 19.8       | 14.2                   | 36.1              | 16                    |

Table 2.2 shows a grid whose annual demand has been flat since 2019 while its composition changed. Demand ranged between 216 and 224 TWh in every year. Utility-scale solar output rose from 27.7 TWh to 49.7 TWh and the combined solar and wind share of demand went from a fifth to nearly a third. Net imports fell from a quarter of demand in 2019 to 13 percent in 2023 and 14 to 16 percent in 2024 and 2025. Battery charging, negligible in 2019, reached 14 TWh in 2025, and battery discharge peaked above 10 GW (Table 2.6). The hourly demand record remains 51.1 GW, set on September 6, 2022 at 18:00.

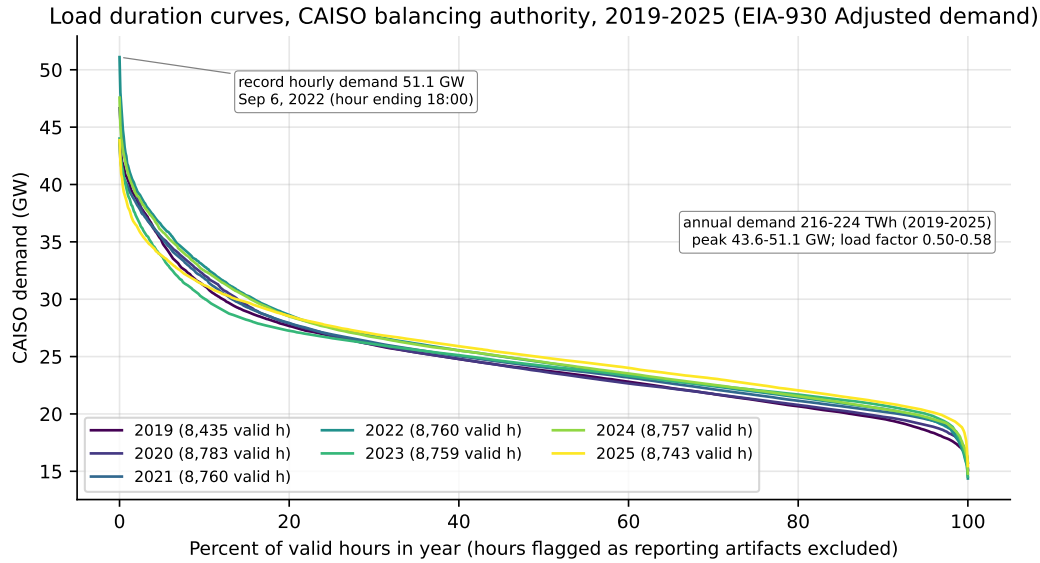


Figure 2.1: Load duration curves over valid hours (counts in the legend), CAISO, 2019–2025. Hours flagged as reporting artifacts are excluded and interchange and hydro gaps are filled from CAISO series. Source: EIA-930 Adjusted demand.

Source line: fig1\_01. Data: ch1\_load\_duration\_curves.csv; ch1\_ciso\_annual\_summary.csv; ciso\_hourly\_2019\_2025\_clean.parquet. Sources (manifest ids): eia930\_balance\_2019\_jan\_jun .. 2025\_jul\_dec; caiso\_outlook demand and fuelsource (fills, artifact filter). Code: ch1\_baseline.load\_eia930\_ciso, clean\_demand\_against\_caiso, fill\_from\_caiso, duration\_curves; run\_chapter1 step 1. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

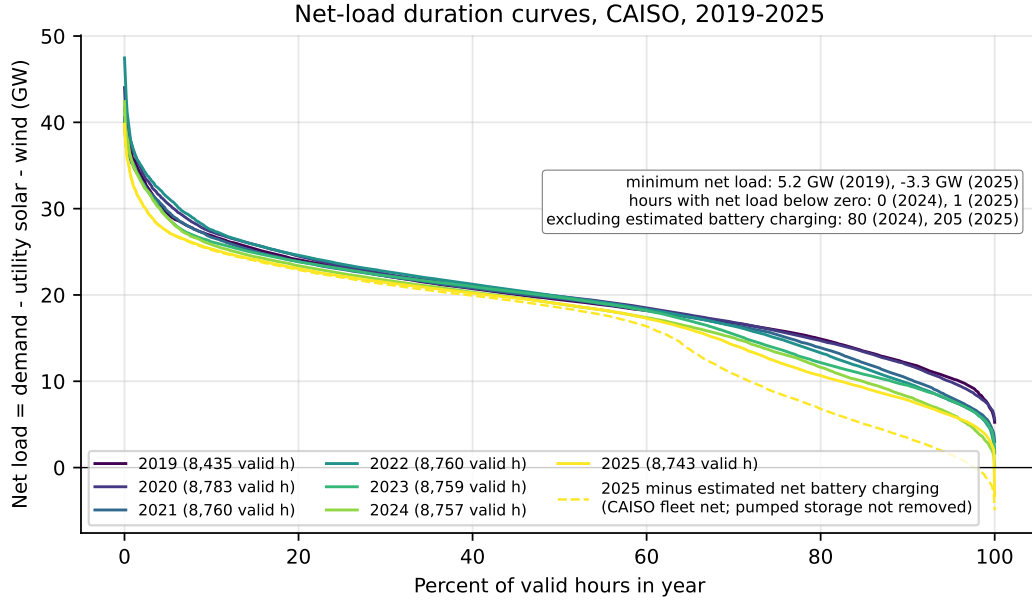


fig1\_02. Data: ch1\_net\_load\_duration\_curves.csv; ch1\_ciso\_annual\_summary.csv; ciso\_hourly\_2019\_2025\_clean.parquet. Sources (manifest ids): eia930 balance files; caiso\_outlook fuelsource (Batteries). Code: ch1\_baseline.add\_storage\_adjusted, duration\_curves; run\_chapter1 step 1. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 2.2: Net-load duration curves over valid hours, CAISO, 2019–2025. The dashed line subtracts the estimated net battery charging of the CAISO fleet from 2025 demand; it does not remove pumped storage and cannot recover gross charging in hours when part of the fleet discharges. Source: EIA-930, CAISO fuel mix.

Source line: fig1\_02. Data: ch1\_net\_load\_duration\_curves.csv; ch1\_ciso\_annual\_summary.csv; ciso\_hourly\_2019\_2025\_clean.parquet. Sources (manifest ids): eia930 balance files; caiso\_outlook fuelsource (Batteries). Code: ch1\_baseline.add\_storage\_adjusted, duration\_curves; run\_chapter1 step 1. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figures 2.1 and 2.2 make the contrast visible. The load duration curves are nearly indistinguishable across years. The net-load duration curves diverge at the low end: by 2024 and 2025 the lowest-net-load hours approach zero, and once battery charging, which is itself a response to the surplus, is removed from demand, utility solar and wind alone exceeded end-use demand in 80 hours of 2024 and 205 hours of 2025. This midday surplus is the physical basis for the flexibility question in Chapter 5.

Average daily profiles by season, CAISO: demand (top) and net load (bottom), 2019 / 2022 / 2025

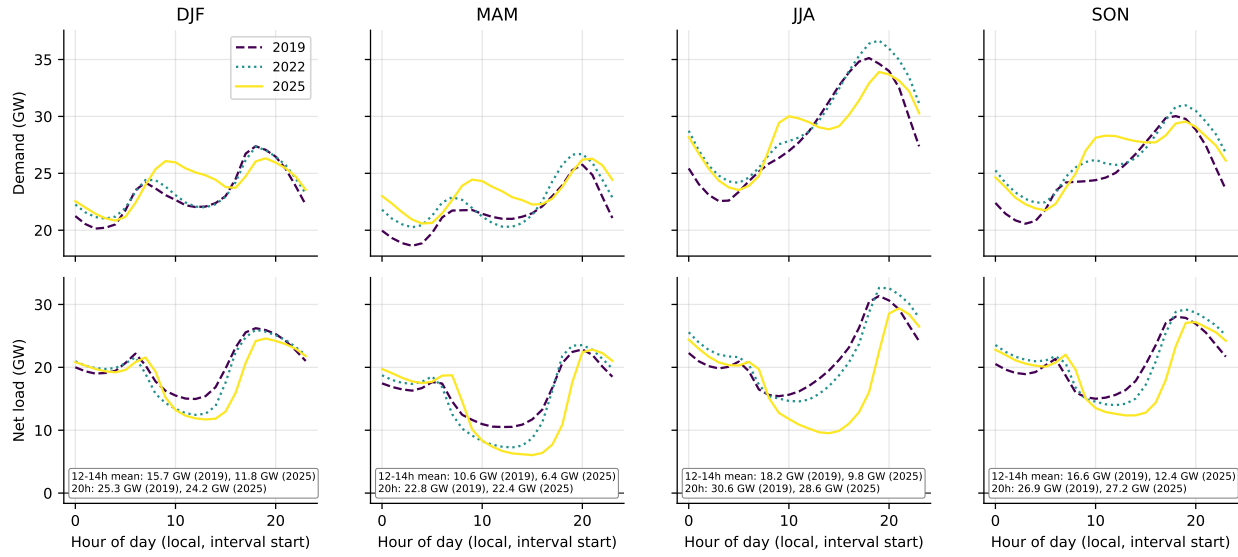


fig1\_03. Data: ch1\_seasonal\_profiles.csv. Sources (manifest ids): eia930 balance files. Code: ch1\_baseline.seasonal\_profiles; run\_chapter1 step 1. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 2.3: Average daily profiles by season: demand (top) and net load (bottom), 2019, 2022 and 2025. Means over valid hours; descriptive averages, not weather-normalised, and demand includes storage charging and pumping. Source: EIA-930.

Source line: fig1\_03. Data: ch1\_seasonal\_profiles.csv. Sources (manifest ids): eia930 balance files. Code: ch1\_baseline.seasonal\_profiles; run\_chapter1 step 1. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

The seasonal profiles in Figure 2.3 show the mechanism. Demand profiles are similar across years, with a modest midday rise in 2025 that reflects storage charging. Net-load profiles deepen at midday and steepen in the evening: in spring the average net load between 12:00 and 14:00 fell from 10.6 GW in 2019 to 6.4 GW in 2025 while the 20:00 value stayed near 22 GW, and in summer the average net load between 12:00 and 14:00 fell from about 18 GW to under 10 GW (the values printed on the figure are the 12:00 to 14:00 and 20:00 means for 2019 and 2025).

Table 2.3: The 100 highest net-load hours of each year: when they occur and what serves them. Mean gas is EIA's series (comparability note in the text). Source: EIA-930.

| Year | Net load range (GW) | Distinct days | Jul-Sep (%) | 17:00–21:00 (%) | Median start | Mean solar (GW) | Mean imports (GW) | Mean gas (GW) |
|------|---------------------|---------------|-------------|-----------------|--------------|-----------------|-------------------|---------------|
| 2019 | 35.6–40.5           | 34            | 90          | 99              | 18:00        | 0.9             | 8.5               | 18.5          |
| 2020 | 36.4–44.0           | 30            | 92          | 86              | 18:00        | 1.2             | 7.4               | 22.6          |
| 2021 | 34.7–40.5           | 42            | 92          | 100             | 19:00        | 0.6             | 6.3               | 21.0          |
| 2022 | 36.6–47.5           | 27            | 95          | 82              | 19:00        | 1.2             | 7.4               | 22.5          |
| 2023 | 35.0–41.8           | 35            | 96          | 93              | 20:00        | 0.6             | 3.6               | 21.8          |
| 2024 | 34.7–42.4           | 37            | 91          | 79              | 20:00        | 0.9             | 4.7               | 20.9          |
| 2025 | 32.3–39.8           | 33            | 98          | 78              | 20:00        | 0.7             | 4.6               | 17.3          |

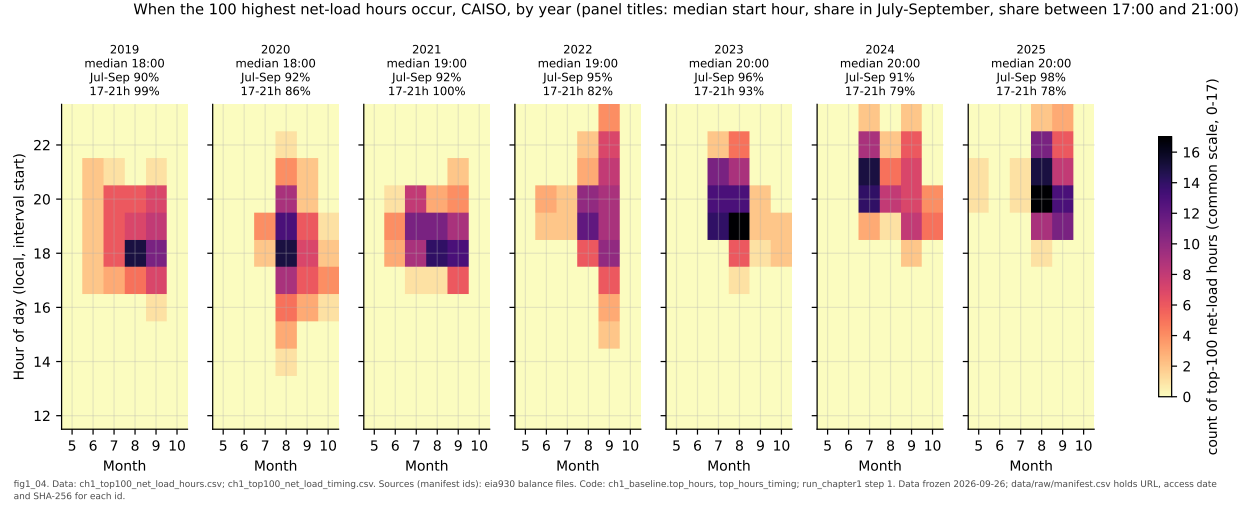


Figure 2.4: Month and hour of the 100 highest net-load hours, by year, on one common colour scale. Source: EIA-930.

Source line: fig1\_04. Data: ch1\_top100\_net\_load\_hours.csv; ch1\_top100\_net\_load\_timing.csv. Sources (manifest ids): eia930 balance files. Code: ch1\_baseline.top\_hours, top\_hours\_timing; run\_chapter1 step 1. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Table 2.3 and Figure 2.4 identify the hours that set capacity needs. In every year at least 90 percent of the top 100 net-load hours fall in July through September and at least 78 percent between 17:00 and 21:00. Their median start time moved from 18:00 in 2019 and 2020 to 19:00 in 2021 and 2022 and to 20:00 from 2023 onward, the signature of solar pushing the net peak past sunset and of storage shaving the early evening. Solar contributes between 0.6 and 1.2 GW on average in these hours; gas contributes 17 to 23 GW and imports 4 to 9 GW. The implication for a flat load such as a data center is direct: each megawatt adds one for one to hours that solar does not serve, and the relevant capacity resources are storage, gas and imports.

## 2.2 Day-ahead prices and negative-price hours

Hourly day-ahead prices at the three investor-owned utility default load aggregation points come from CAISO OASIS [California Independent System Operator, 2026c]. OASIS retains roughly 39 months of data, so hourly prices run from July 2023; 2024 and 2025 are complete years and 2026 covers January 1 to September 22. EIA's daily ICE hub prices at NP15 and SP15 extend to 2015 but are daily block averages [U.S. Energy Information Administration, 2026e].

Table 2.4: Day-ahead LMP statistics at CAISO default load aggregation points. Source: CAISO OASIS PRC\_LMP, DAM.

| Node       | Year  | Hours | Mean | Median | P5    | P95  | Min   | Hours < \$0 | Hours ≤ \$5 | Negative hours<br>10:00–16:00 (%) |
|------------|-------|-------|------|--------|-------|------|-------|-------------|-------------|-----------------------------------|
| (\$/MWh)   |       |       |      |        |       |      |       |             |             |                                   |
| PG&E DLAP  | 2024  | 8784  | 43.0 | 40.1   | 9.0   | 76.2 | -33.1 | 190         | 327         | 88                                |
| PG&E DLAP  | 2025  | 8760  | 40.6 | 42.4   | 8.7   | 63.8 | -36.8 | 218         | 337         | 94                                |
| PG&E DLAP  | 2026* | 6359  | 31.5 | 31.9   | 0.4   | 60.1 | -14.2 | 294         | 480         | 87                                |
| SCE DLAP   | 2024  | 8784  | 34.0 | 37.0   | -20.0 | 67.7 | -66.6 | 1131        | 1369        | 77                                |
| SCE DLAP   | 2025  | 8760  | 34.4 | 40.2   | -8.3  | 60.5 | -40.5 | 877         | 1109        | 78                                |
| SCE DLAP   | 2026* | 6359  | 28.7 | 30.3   | -9.0  | 64.8 | -17.9 | 890         | 1123        | 72                                |
| SDG&E DLAP | 2024  | 8784  | 36.2 | 38.2   | -17.3 | 72.5 | -63.1 | 989         | 1227        | 77                                |
| SDG&E DLAP | 2025  | 8760  | 37.5 | 42.4   | -6.8  | 65.8 | -40.1 | 748         | 955         | 80                                |
| SDG&E DLAP | 2026* | 6359  | 32.3 | 33.1   | -7.2  | 70.3 | -17.2 | 706         | 950         | 74                                |

\* partial year: 2026 covers January 1 to September 22.

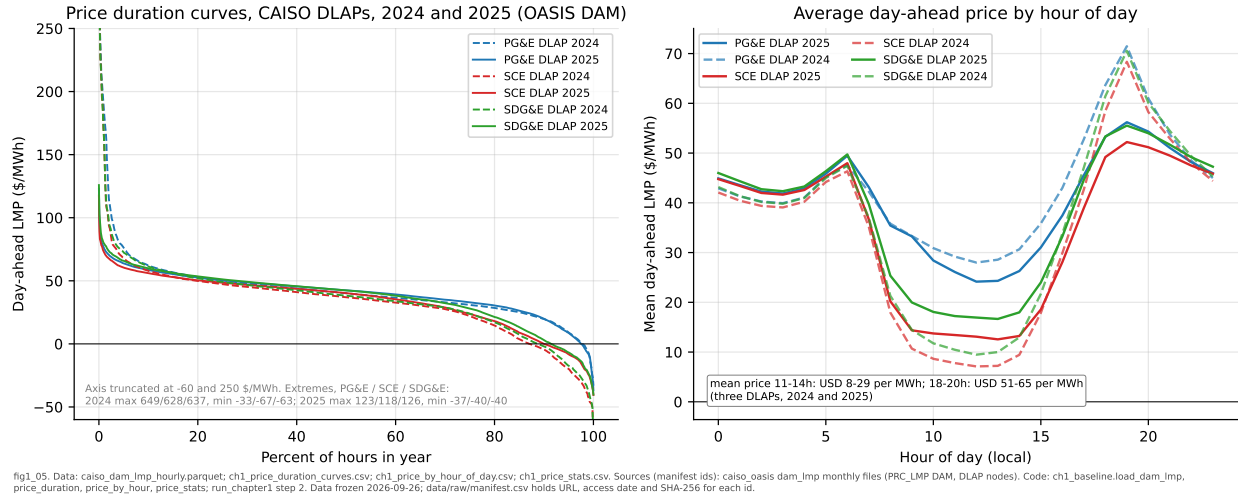


Figure 2.5: Price duration curves (left) and average price by hour of day (right), 2024 and 2025; one colour per DLAP, dashed 2024 and solid 2025. The duration axis is truncated at  $-60$  and  $250$   $\$/\text{MWh}$  and the extremes are printed in the panel (2024 maxima of 628 to 649  $\$/\text{MWh}$ ). Source: CAISO OASIS.

Source line: fig1\_05. Data: caiso\_dam\_lmp\_hourly.parquet; ch1\_price\_duration\_curves.csv; ch1\_price\_by\_hour\_of\_day.csv; ch1\_price\_stats.csv. Sources (manifest ids): caiso\_oasis dam\_lmp monthly files (PRC\_LMP DAM, DLAP nodes).

Code: ch1\_baseline.load\_dam\_lmp, price\_duration, price\_by\_hour, price\_stats; run\_chapter1 step 2. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Negative-price hours by DLAP: complete years and matched Jan 1-Sep 22 windows  
(labels: share of hours in the window; OASIS retention starts July 2023)

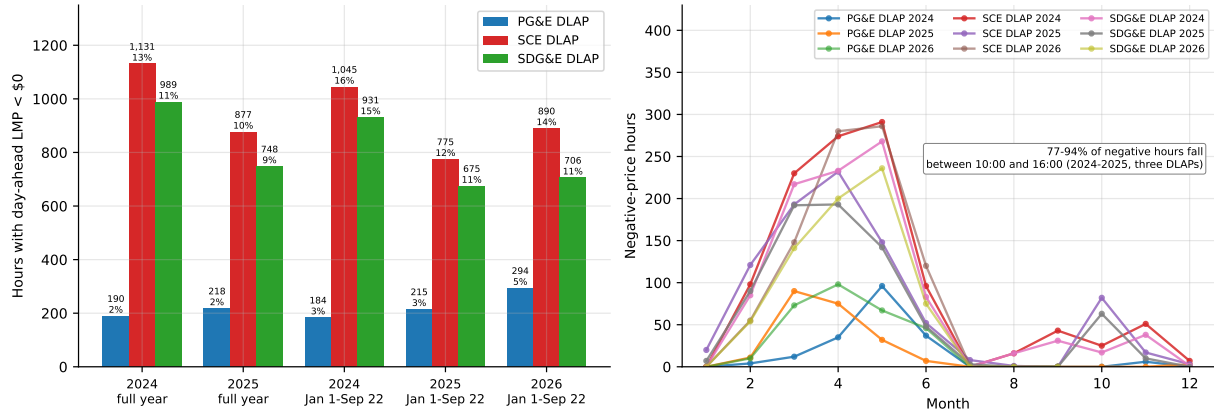


fig1\_06. Data: ch1\_negative\_price\_hours\_windows.csv; ch1\_negative\_price\_hours\_by\_month.csv; ch1\_price\_stats.csv. Sources (manifest ids): caiso\_oasis dam\_lmp monthly files. Code: ch1\_baseline.negative\_hours\_by\_month, price\_stats; run\_chapter1 step 2. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 2.6: Negative-price hours at the three DLAPs. Left: the complete years 2024 and 2025 and matched January 1 to September 22 windows for 2024, 2025 and 2026, with the share of hours in each window; 2023 (July to December only) is omitted from the comparison. Right: by month. Source: CAISO OASIS.

Source line: fig1\_06. Data: ch1\_negative\_price\_hours\_windows.csv; ch1\_negative\_price\_hours\_by\_month.csv; ch1\_price\_stats.csv. Sources (manifest ids): caiso\_oasis dam\_lmp monthly files. Code: ch1\_baseline.negative\_hours\_by\_month, price\_stats; run\_chapter1 step 2. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Negative day-ahead prices are now routine in Southern California (Table 2.4, Figures 2.5 and 2.6). The SCE aggregation point cleared below zero in 1,131 hours of 2024 and 877 hours of 2025, and in 890 hours of 2026 through September 22; SDG&E's point saw 989 and 748 hours; PG&E's 190 and 218. On the matched January 1 to September 22 window the SCE point had 1,045 negative hours in 2024, 775 in 2025 and 890 in 2026, 16, 12 and 14 percent of the hours in the window, so 2026 sits between the two complete years rather than above them (ch1\_negative\_price\_hours\_windows.csv). Between 72 and 94 percent of those hours fall between 10:00 and 16:00, concentrated in February through June, and the average price by hour of day drops to \$7–\$30 per MWh at midday against \$50–\$70 in the evening peak. The daily ICE block prices show almost no negative days, which is why the hourly series is required. This is the California-specific fact that Chapter 5 uses: a data center able to place consumption in those hours faces a zero or negative marginal energy price, and one that cannot adds to the evening hours where prices and net load are highest.

## 2.3 Hourly carbon intensity

CAISO's Today's Outlook reports five-minute CO<sub>2</sub> by source, with imports carried at CAISO's default factor and export emissions netted against them [California Independent System Operator, 2026d]. The indicator used here is that accounting total divided by CAISO demand, energy-weighted per year: an accounting rate for the supply serving CAISO demand, not a measured consumption footprint. Three properties of the data are made explicit. First, because exports are netted, net CO<sub>2</sub> is negative in export-heavy hours (374 in 2024, 425 in 2025); the headline series keeps those hours at their negative values, and a variant that floors them at zero is shown as a sensitivity (it raises 2025 from 186.3 to 187.7 g/kWh). Second, CAISO publishes a fixed grid of

288 five-minute rows for every calendar day, including the two daylight-saving transition days, so the repeated autumn hour and the skipped spring hour cannot be separated; an hour is counted as valid when at least six of its twelve intervals exist for both CO<sub>2</sub> and demand, hours with no source data are left missing rather than counted as zero, and coverage is 99.8 percent of calendar hours or better in every year. Third, EIA’s warning that CAISO’s natural gas data collection changed in December 2023 [U.S. Energy Information Administration, 2025b] applies to the EIA-930 gas series, not to CAISO’s own accounting: the emission factor implied by CAISO’s gas CO<sub>2</sub> over CAISO’s gas generation stays between 432 and 452 kg/MWh in every month from June 2023 to June 2024 and between 437 and 458 in every year, and CAISO’s gas share of demand moves from 48.8 to 47.8 to 47.9 percent across November, December and January. The EPA eGRID output rate for the CAMX subregion is drawn as a reference with a different boundary: a generation-based rate for the whole subregion with no import factor [U.S. Environmental Protection Agency, 2025].

Table 2.5: CO<sub>2</sub> accounting intensity of CAISO demand: CAISO’s CO<sub>2</sub> accounting (imports net of exports) divided by CAISO demand, energy-weighted, with the floored variant, the number of negative hours and valid hours as a share of the calendar. eGRID CAMX is a generation output rate with a different boundary. Source: CAISO Today’s Outlook, eGRID 2023.

| Year                                   | Accounting<br>(g/kWh) | Floored<br>(g/kWh) | Negative<br>hours | P5<br>(g/kWh) | P95<br>(g/kWh) | CO <sub>2</sub><br>(Mt) | Imports<br>share (%) | Gas<br>share (%) | Valid<br>hours (%) |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------|-------------------|---------------|----------------|-------------------------|----------------------|------------------|--------------------|
| 2019                                   | 256.7                 | 256.8              | 8                 | 109           | 361            | 55.9                    | 42                   | 53               | 100.0              |
| 2020                                   | 277.4                 | 277.4              | 0                 | 132           | 368            | 60.4                    | 42                   | 54               | 100.0              |
| 2021                                   | 274.5                 | 274.5              | 0                 | 125           | 361            | 59.7                    | 37                   | 59               | 100.0              |
| 2022                                   | 264.4                 | 264.4              | 13                | 108           | 355            | 58.1                    | 34                   | 63               | 100.0              |
| 2023                                   | 241.9                 | 242.0              | 19                | 85            | 344            | 51.1                    | 21                   | 75               | 100.0              |
| 2024                                   | 199.4                 | 200.7              | 374               | 7             | 322            | 42.4                    | 27                   | 68               | 99.8               |
| 2025                                   | 186.3                 | 187.7              | 425               | 1             | 319            | 38.8                    | 35                   | 61               | 100.0              |
| eGRID 2023 CAMX generation output rate | 198.1                 | –                  | –                 | –             | –              | 47.3                    | –                    | –                | –                  |

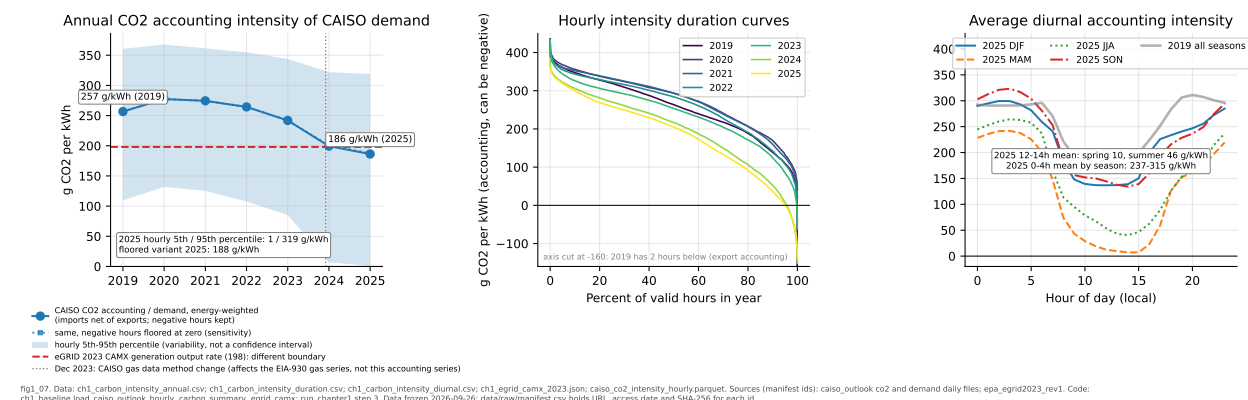


Figure 2.7: Annual, duration-curve and diurnal views of the CAISO CO<sub>2</sub> accounting intensity. Left: headline series with negative hours kept, the floored sensitivity, the hourly 5th to 95th percentile band (variability, not a confidence interval), the eGRID reference and the December 2023 EIA-930 gas reporting change. Middle: hourly duration curves, axis cut at  $-160$  g/kWh. Right: 2025 seasonal diurnal means against 2019. Source: CAISO Today’s Outlook, eGRID 2023.

Source line: fig1\_07. Data: ch1\_carbon\_intensity\_annual.csv; ch1\_carbon\_intensity\_duration.csv; ch1\_carbon\_intensity\_diurnal.csv; ch1\_egrid\_camx\_2023.json; caiso\_co2\_intensity\_hourly.parquet. Sources (manifest ids): caiso\_outlook co2 and demand daily files; epa\_egrid2023\_rev1. Code: ch1\_baseline.load\_caiso\_outlook\_hourly, carbon\_summary, egrid\_camx; run\_chapter1 step 3. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Table 2.6: CAISO battery fleet energy and peak power from the five-minute fuel mix.

| Year | Discharge (TWh) | Charge (TWh) | Peak discharge (GW) | Peak charge (GW) |
|------|-----------------|--------------|---------------------|------------------|
| 2019 | 0.05            | 0.08         | 0.1                 | 0.1              |
| 2020 | 0.06            | 0.08         | 0.2                 | 0.2              |
| 2021 | 0.83            | 0.92         | 1.4                 | 1.2              |
| 2022 | 2.73            | 1.70         | 3.0                 | 2.1              |
| 2023 | 4.34            | 4.45         | 4.8                 | 4.3              |
| 2024 | 8.18            | 9.45         | 7.8                 | 7.2              |
| 2025 | 12.29           | 14.21        | 10.7                | 9.3              |

The accounting intensity fell from 257 g/kWh in 2019 to 186 g/kWh in 2025 (Table 2.5, Figure 2.7); the floored variant gives 257 and 188. The hourly spread widened: in 2025 the fifth percentile was 1 g/kWh and the ninety-fifth 319 g/kWh, and the average midday hour was about 10 g/kWh in spring and 46 g/kWh in summer against roughly 240 to 315 g/kWh at night. eGRID’s 2023 CAMX generation rate of 198 g/kWh is lower than the 2023 accounting figure of 242 g/kWh because it excludes the import factor and covers the whole subregion; it is a single-year reference, not a trend. The decline is consistent with the solar and battery additions of Table 2.2, but the series remains an accounting construct: a validated consumption-emissions series would need CAISO’s greenhouse gas tracking reports as an independent check, which is deferred to the supply chapter. For a flat load the annual factor is the relevant one; for a flexible load the diurnal ratio, about five to one in summer and far larger in spring, is the relevant number, and an average intensity is not a marginal emissions factor for load shifting.

## 2.4 How much of the state’s power do data centers use

No agency meters California’s data center consumption, and the four items in Table 2.8 and Figure 2.8 are not four comparable estimates of one quantity. They are grouped by what they are: one statewide historical estimate, one assumed conversion of a published peak, one illustrative count-based sensitivity and one utility subset. Shares are computed against EIA-861 California retail sales for the year that matches each item, 239.5 TWh in 2023 and 245.7 TWh in 2024 (Parts A, C and D, which avoids counting delivery-only sales twice) [U.S. Energy Information Administration, 2025a].

Table 2.7: Silicon Valley Power fact-sheet series used for the utility-subset estimate.

| Fact sheet year | Peak demand (MW) | System load factor (%) | Retail sales (TWh) | Purchased and generated supply (TWh) | Peak $\times$ load factor $\times$ 8760 (TWh) |
|-----------------|------------------|------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 2017            | 586.6            | 72.5                   | –                  | 3.73                                 | 3.73                                          |
| 2018            | 526.2            | 80.1                   | –                  | 3.69                                 | 3.69                                          |
| 2019            | 587.8            | 72.4                   | –                  | 3.73                                 | 3.73                                          |
| 2020            | 586.3            | 75.0                   | 3.74               | 3.85                                 | 3.85                                          |
| 2021            | 594.8            | 79.3                   | 4.03               | 4.13                                 | 4.13                                          |
| 2022            | 693.9            | 74.3                   | 4.41               | 4.52                                 | 4.52                                          |
| 2023            | 669.2            | 78.3                   | 4.48               | 4.59                                 | 4.59                                          |

Silicon Valley Power utility fact sheets; retail sales are reported from 2020. Data center shares applied to 2023 retail sales: 53 percent (SVP data center page), 55 percent (SVP Assembly deck, January 2026), about 60 percent (Santa Clara officials, 2025); SVP reports 64 to 67 percent utilization of requested capacity for its data center customers.

Table 2.8: Evidence and assumptions for existing California data center electricity use, by type. Shares use EIA-861 retail sales of the year in parentheses.

| Group                       | Method                                                                       | Data year | TWh per year | Share of retail sales, % (year) |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|--------------|---------------------------------|
| A. Statewide estimate       | EPRI 2024 state table, 2023 consumption                                      | 2023      | 9.3          | 3.9 (2023)                      |
| B. Assumed conversion       | CEC 1,000 MW existing peak (Dec 2025) x assumed annual load factor 0.80-0.95 | 2025      | 7.0–8.3      | 2.9–3.4 (2024)                  |
| C. Illustrative sensitivity | Count-based: 321 Kollar-Grady facility points x assumed energy per facility  | 2023      | 6.8–13.6     | 2.8–5.7 (2023)                  |
| D. Utility subset           | Silicon Valley Power only: 53-60% of SVP 2023 retail sales                   | 2023      | 2.4–2.7      | 1.0–1.1 (2023)                  |

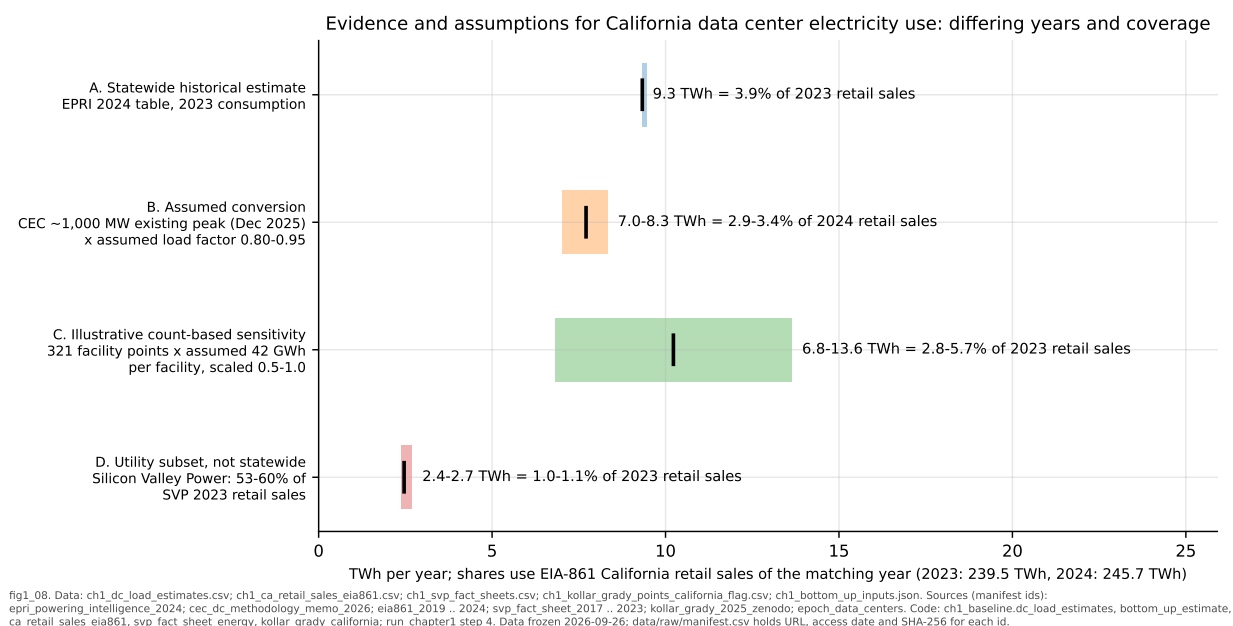


Figure 2.8: Existing data center electricity use in California: one statewide estimate (A), one assumed conversion (B), one illustrative sensitivity (C) and one utility subset (D), with matching-year retail-sales shares. No metered statewide total exists.

*Source line:* fig1\_08. Data: ch1\_dc\_load\_estimates.csv; ch1\_ca\_retail\_sales\_eia861.csv; ch1\_svp\_fact\_sheets.csv; ch1\_kollar\_grady\_points\_california\_flag.csv; ch1\_bottom\_up\_inputs.json. Sources (manifest ids): epri\_powering\_intelligence\_2024; cec\_dc\_methodology\_memo\_2026; eia861\_2019 .. 2024; svp\_fact\_sheet\_2017 .. 2023; kollar\_grady\_2025\_zenodo; epoch\_data\_centers. Code: ch1\_baseline.dc\_load\_estimates, bottom\_up\_estimate, ca\_retail\_sales\_eia861, svp\_fact\_sheet\_energy, kollar\_grady\_california; run\_chapter1 step 4. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

1. **A. Statewide estimate.** EPRI's 2024 study estimates California data centers consumed 9,331,619 MWh in 2023, 3.70 percent of state consumption on EPRI's denominator, the third-largest state total after Virginia and Texas [Electric Power Research Institute, 2024, pp. 13, 28]; against EIA-861 2023 retail sales it is 3.9 percent. This is the only statewide historical estimate in the set.
2. **B. Assumed conversion.** The CEC's methodology memo states that "as of December 2025, approximately 1,000 megawatts (MW) of existing data center peak demand operates in

California” [California Energy Commission, 2026d, pp. 2, 18]. Converting a peak into energy needs an annual load factor that no source reports. The CEC’s daily load-factor profiles for existing facilities range from 75 to 100 percent of the daily maximum [California Energy Commission, 2025], and an assumed annual factor of 0.80 to 0.95 turns the 1,000 MW into 7.0 to 8.3 TWh, 2.9 to 3.4 percent of 2024 retail sales. It is a conversion scenario, not a measured total.

3. **C. Illustrative sensitivity.** The Kollar and Grady inventory places 321 of its 2,484 facility points inside California, 102 of them within 12 km of Santa Clara [Kollar and Grady, 2025], but carries no per-facility power, and the Epoch AI hub snapshot contains no California observation [Epoch AI, 2026a], which is a limit of its coverage rather than a count of zero. The sensitivity multiplies the count by an assumed annual energy per facility taken from the Silicon Valley Power cluster: 42 GWh, or 55 percent of SVP’s 2023 retail sales spread over its 58 data centers, an average load of 4.8 MW, scaled by 0.5, 0.75 and 1.0 because the statewide inventory includes many small facilities. The result, 6.8 to 13.6 TWh or 2.8 to 5.7 percent, uses no peak-demand or utilization factor. It is an assumption set whose representativeness is untested, shown to bound the statewide figure rather than to estimate it.
4. **D. Utility subset.** The municipal utility of Santa Clara reports 58 data centers, the largest cluster on the West Coast, taking 55 percent of its power use [Silicon Valley Power, 2026a]; its web page states 53 percent [Silicon Valley Power, 2026b], and city officials cited about 60 percent in 2025 [San José Spotlight, 2025]. Applied to SVP’s 2023 retail sales of 4.48 TWh (Table 2.7) [Silicon Valley Power, 2024] (its purchased and generated supply was 4.59 TWh, which is what a peak of 669.2 MW times a 78.3 percent load factor reconstructs), the cluster used 2.4 to 2.7 TWh, about one percent of statewide 2023 sales; the percentages come from different dates than the sales figure. SVP also reports that its best-performing data center customers reach about 67 percent utilization of requested capacity and that observed utilization was about 64 percent in 2023 [Silicon Valley Power, 2025], the empirical origin of the CEC’s 67 percent factor; that ratio relates operating peak to requested capacity and is not an annual load factor.

The statewide estimate and the assumed conversion agree at 7 to 9 TWh, roughly 3 to 4 percent of retail sales, and the sensitivity admits 3 to 6 percent. One municipal utility hosts about a quarter to a third of that. The defensible statement for the rest of this study is that existing data centers used about 3 to 4 percent of California’s electricity in 2023 to 2025, that the load is geographically concentrated, and that no metered statewide total exists. Against roughly 1 GW of existing peak, the CEC’s December 2025 energization requests located in California total 20,677 MW, or 23,277 MW including the 2,600 MW that VEA reports for Nevada [California Energy Commission, 2026d], a ratio of about 21 that is the California analogue of Finland’s 27x [Manner, 2026] and the subject of Chapter 3.

## 2.5 Institutional context

**The January 2026 forecast decision.** The CEC adopted the California Energy Demand 2025–2045 forecast set on January 21, 2026 [California Energy Commission, 2026c]. The set includes three data center scenarios built from the energization tiers. What the joint agencies then chose to do with those scenarios is the institutional fact that matters. The Single Forecast Set Agreement between the CEC, the CPUC and the CAISO, signed in January 2026 and updated on April 15,

2026, directs that CPUC integrated resource planning and CAISO bulk-system transmission studies for the 2026–2027 cycle “will continue to use the 2024 IEPR planning forecast,” that the 2027–2028 cycle will use an IRP portfolio based on the same 2024 forecast, and that system resource adequacy requirements for 2027 “will use the 2025 IEPR planning forecast without known loads” [California Energy Commission, California Public Utilities Commission and California Independent System Operator, 2026, pp. 7–8]. Only local transmission reliability studies use the 2025 IEPR local reliability forecast with known loads. The agencies give two reasons: the approach “manages volatility and promotes stability in electric system resource and infrastructure planning currently underway,” and it “allows CEC staff additional time to collect and review historical data, observe the impacts of known loads, data centers, and recent federal policy changes, and refine forecast approaches as needed” [California Energy Commission, California Public Utilities Commission and California Independent System Operator, 2026, p. 8]. In plain terms, the state now tracks data center energization requests in tiers, converts them into forecast scenarios, and then holds the resulting increment out of the forecast that drives generation procurement and bulk transmission for at least two planning cycles. The 2024 IEPR data center mid case, built from the smaller December 2024 tiers, remains the number in use.

**Utility pipeline statements.** PG&E told the CEC in February 2025 that it had “a large pipeline of applications to interconnect new data centers” with about 1.5 GW in final engineering or construction and more than half expected within four years [Nelli, 2025]. In July 2025 it announced a 10 GW pipeline over ten years, of which 17 projects totaling about 1.5 GW were in final engineering for operation between 2026 and 2030, and estimated that each gigawatt of new data center demand could lower other customers’ bills by one to two percent [Pacific Gas and Electric Company, 2025]. Its second-quarter 2026 earnings release describes “an overall pipeline of over 12 gigawatts” [PG&E Corporation, 2026]. PG&E has, however, filed a request for confidentiality over its project-level data center data in the IEPR docket every month since August 2025 [Pacific Gas and Electric Company, 2026a], so its pipeline is public only in aggregate. Southern California Edison took the opposite path. It reported 80 MW of existing data center demand in February 2025 with 200 MW of near-term and 400 MW of mid-term growth [Dean, 2025], and it files a public project-level database. The January 2026 vintage lists 115 entries with 8,299 MW of requested peak: 76 MW under signed agreements, 3,313 MW in applications, 1,772 MW in inquiries, and 3,137 MW already canceled [Southern California Edison, 2026]. The CEC’s own summer 2025 tally put SCE’s requests at 5,828 MW and PG&E’s at 11,668 MW [California Energy Commission, 2025]. The canceled share in SCE’s file, 38 percent of everything ever requested, is the first direct California evidence on attrition and is used in Chapter 5.

**CPUC large-load proceedings.** The proposal could not confirm a CPUC large-load tariff docket; the record now can. On April 9, 2026 the CPUC opened Rulemaking 26-04-009 on Advanced Electric Rate Design, which states that “in coordination with the Senate Bill 57 assessment, this proceeding will consider rate design issues for data centers and other large load customers” [California Public Utilities Commission, 2026, p. 1]. Senate Bill 57 (Padilla), chaptered on October 11, 2025, requires the CPUC to assess whether costs of serving new data center loads shift to other customers and to report to the Legislature by January 1, 2027 [California Legislature, 2025b]. Senate Bill 886 (Padilla), the California Technology Innovation and Ratepayer Protection Act, was chaptered on September 21, 2026 and requires the CPUC, on or before January 1, 2028, to establish new tariffs or update electric rules for the interconnection and service of participating large customers, and to ensure those tariffs “prevent the creation of stranded costs for, or cost

shifts to, nonparticipating customers” [California Legislature, 2026, KQED, 2026]. Assembly Bill 222, which would have required data center energy reporting and efficiency metrics, was held in the Senate Appropriations Committee on August 29, 2025 [California Legislature, 2025a]. On the interconnection side, the CPUC approved an interim PG&E Electric Rule 30 on July 24, 2025 to streamline transmission-level service for large customers that fund the required infrastructure up front [California Public Utilities Commission, 2025]. The sequence is consistent: the state has moved from studying the cost question (SB 57) to mandating a tariff answer (SB 886) within a year, while the forecast that drives procurement still excludes the load the tariff is meant to price.

## 2.6 The current status in the workshop format, 2025 to 2026

The Finnish study that motivated this project presented its grid baseline as five charts for the current year: hourly consumption against generation, hourly prices, hourly emission factors, monthly imports and exports, and wind output against installed capacity [Manner, 2026]. Figures 2.9 to 2.13 repeat them for CAISO from the sources of this chapter, so that the two grids can be read side by side. Table 2.9 carries the minimum, maximum and mean of every hourly series with the hour at which each extreme occurred, and Table 2.10 the monthly imports and exports. The 2026 hourly series run from January 1 to September 20, the last complete day in the EIA-930 file at the freeze; the same artifact filter as in Section 2.1 removed 10 hours.

Table 2.9: Minimum, maximum and mean of the hourly series in the workshop-format figures, with the local hour of each extreme. Prices are wholesale day-ahead energy prices. The CO<sub>2</sub> factors are CAISO’s accounting: the consumption factor divides net CO<sub>2</sub> (imports net of exports) by demand, the production factor divides the CO<sub>2</sub> of the sources inside CAISO by in-CAISO generation.

| Series                                                                         | Period                   | Unit    | Hours  | Minimum | at               | Maximum | at               | Mean   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------|--------|---------|------------------|---------|------------------|--------|
| CAISO demand (electricity load)                                                | 2026-01-01 to 2026-09-20 | MW      | 6,301  | 18,748  | 2026-03-29 05:00 | 49,959  | 2026-09-09 18:00 | 27,202 |
| Net generation inside CAISO                                                    | 2026-01-01 to 2026-09-20 | MW      | 6,311  | 4,703   | 2026-08-19 04:00 | 44,050  | 2026-09-09 18:00 | 19,329 |
| Net imports                                                                    | 2026-01-01 to 2026-09-20 | MW      | 6,285  | -4,901  | 2026-06-21 15:00 | 11,236  | 2026-01-16 03:00 | 4,405  |
| Wind generation                                                                | 2026-01-01 to 2026-09-20 | MW      | 6,311  | 22      | 2026-01-18 13:00 | 7,126   | 2026-05-15 02:00 | 2,582  |
| Solar generation                                                               | 2026-01-01 to 2026-09-20 | MW      | 6,311  | -74     | 2026-08-08 21:00 | 20,852  | 2026-08-19 12:00 | 6,548  |
| Day-ahead price, PG&E DLAP                                                     | 2025-01-01 to 2026-09-22 | USD/MWh | 15,119 | -36.8   | 2025-03-23 14:00 | 217.1   | 2026-09-09 18:00 | 36.8   |
| Day-ahead price, SCE DLAP                                                      | 2025-01-01 to 2026-09-22 | USD/MWh | 15,119 | -40.5   | 2025-03-15 15:00 | 210.5   | 2026-09-09 19:00 | 32.0   |
| Day-ahead price, SDG&E DLAP                                                    | 2025-01-01 to 2026-09-22 | USD/MWh | 15,119 | -40.1   | 2025-03-29 13:00 | 214.6   | 2026-09-09 19:00 | 35.3   |
| CO <sub>2</sub> intensity of CAISO demand, accounting (imports net of exports) | 2026-01-01 to 2026-09-20 | g/kWh   | 6,311  | -128.9  | 2026-06-21 14:00 | 395.2   | 2026-08-28 04:00 | 162.6  |
| CO <sub>2</sub> intensity of generation inside CAISO (production factor)       | 2026-01-01 to 2026-09-20 | g/kWh   | 6,311  | 13.5    | 2026-05-07 15:00 | 356.9   | 2026-08-28 00:00 | 116.4  |

**Consumption and generation.** Over the 6,301 valid hours from January 1 to September 20, 2026, CAISO demand ran from 18,748 to 49,959 MW with a mean of 27,202 MW; net generation inside CAISO ran from 4,703 to 44,050 MW with a mean of 19,329 MW, and net imports averaged 4,405 MW (Figure 2.9). The distance between the two lines is the import dependence that the Finnish chart also shows. It is widest in January and February and narrowest in the summer afternoons, when solar output is highest; the demand maximum and the generation maximum fell in the same hour, 18:00 on September 9, 2026.

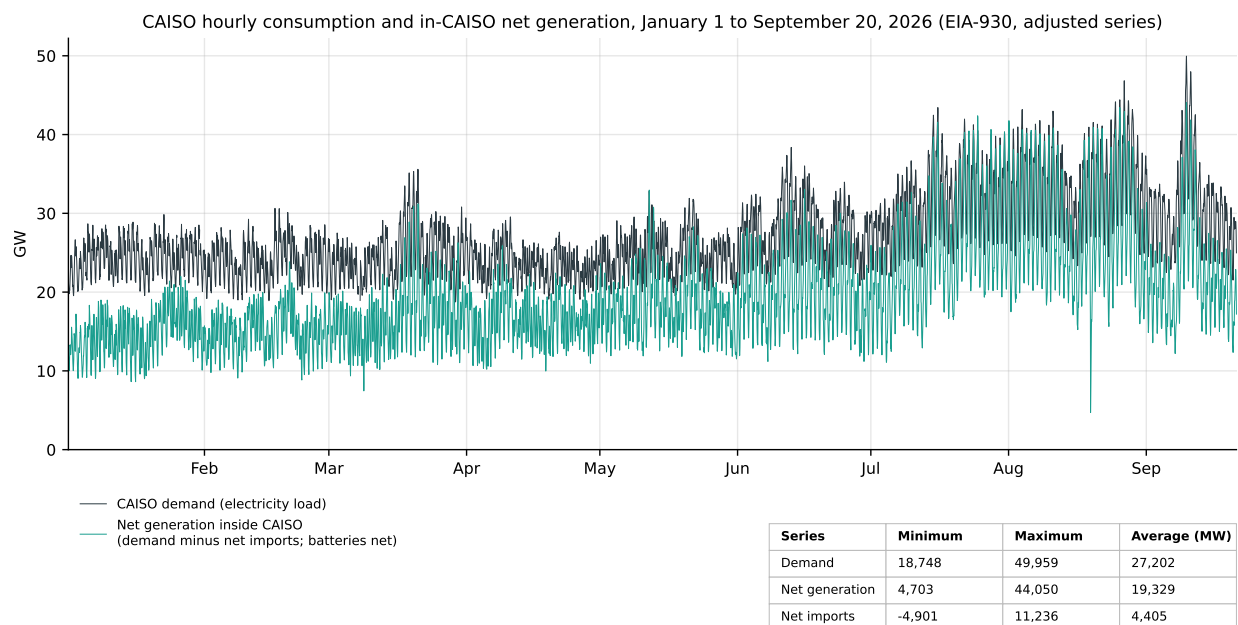


fig1\_09. Data: ch1\_hourly\_2026\_workshop.csv; ch1\_workshop\_stats.csv; caiso\_co2\_intensity\_hourly\_2026.parquet; caiso\_fuelmix\_hourly\_2026.parquet. Sources (manifest ids): eia930\_balance\_2026\_jan\_jun..2026\_jul\_dec; caiso\_outlook\_demand and fuelsource\_2026 (artifact filter). Code: ch1\_baseline.load\_eia930\_ciso, clean\_demand\_against\_ciso, hourly\_stats; run\_chapter1 step 5. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 2.9: Hourly CAISO demand and net generation inside CAISO, January 1 to September 20, 2026, with the minimum, maximum and mean of each series and of net imports. Source: EIA-930 balance files, adjusted series, artifact filter of Section 2.1.

*Source line:* fig1\_09. Data: ch1\_hourly\_2026\_workshop.csv; ch1\_workshop\_stats.csv; caiso\_co2\_intensity\_hourly\_2026.parquet; caiso\_fuelmix\_hourly\_2026.parquet. Sources (manifest ids): eia930\_balance\_2026\_jan\_jun..2026\_jul\_dec; caiso\_outlook\_demand and fuelsource\_2026 (artifact filter). Code: ch1\_baseline.load\_eia930\_ciso, clean\_demand\_against\_ciso, hourly\_stats; run\_chapter1 step 5. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

**Prices.** Day-ahead prices at the three default load aggregation points averaged 36.8, 32.0 and 35.3 USD/MWh (PG&E, SCE and SDG&E) over the 15,119 hours from January 2025 to September 22, 2026, with minimums between  $-36.8$  and  $-40.5$  and maximums between 210.5 and 217.1 USD/MWh (Figure 2.10). These are wholesale energy prices before transmission, distribution and retail charges, so their level is not comparable with the Finnish consumer price with taxes; the pattern is. The lowest prices of both years came in March, the highest in the same hour as the 2026 demand maximum, 18:00 to 19:00 on September 9, 2026, and the negative hours of Section 2.2 cluster in spring.

Day-ahead hourly prices at the three default load aggregation points, January 2025 to September 22, 2026 (CAISO OASIS; wholesale energy price, before retail charges and taxes)

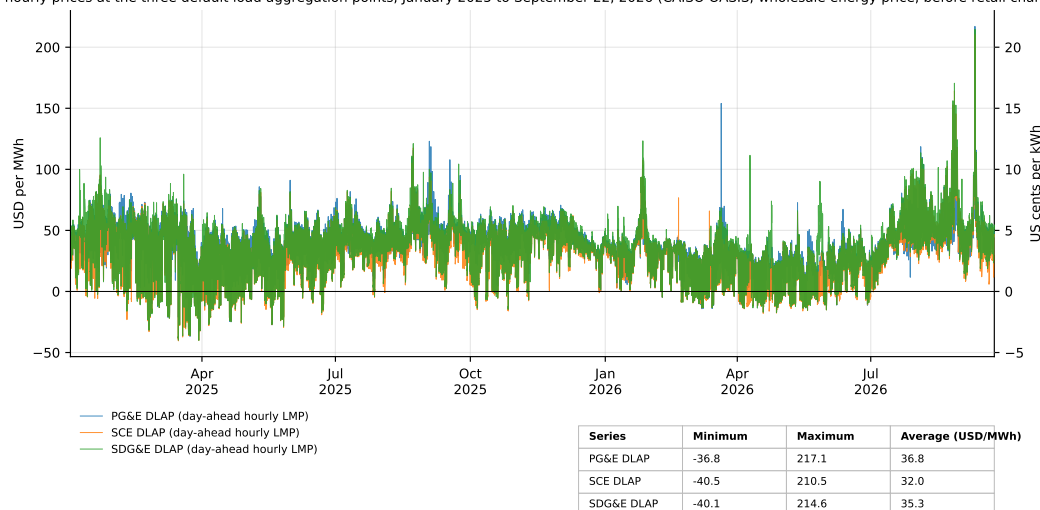


fig1\_10. Data: caiso\_dam\_lmp\_hourly.parquet; ch1\_workshop\_stats.csv. Sources (manifest ids): caiso\_oasis\_dam\_lmp monthly files 2025-01 .. 2026-09. Code: ch1\_baseline.load\_dam\_lmp, hourly\_stats; run\_chapter1 step 5. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 2.10: Hourly day-ahead prices at the PG&E, SCE and SDG&E default load aggregation points, January 2025 to September 22, 2026, in USD per MWh and US cents per kWh, with the minimum, maximum and mean of each series. Source: CAISO OASIS PRC\_LMP.

Source line: fig1\_10. Data: caiso\_dam\_lmp\_hourly.parquet; ch1\_workshop\_stats.csv. Sources (manifest ids): caiso\_oasis\_dam\_lmp monthly files 2025-01 .. 2026-09. Code: ch1\_baseline.load\_dam\_lmp, hourly\_stats; run\_chapter1 step 5. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

**Emissions.** The consumption-side factor of Section 2.3, CAISO's net CO<sub>2</sub> accounting divided by demand, averaged 162.6 g/kWh over January 1 to September 20, 2026 and ranged from -128.9 to 395.2 g/kWh; the production-side factor, the CO<sub>2</sub> of the sources inside CAISO divided by in-CAISO generation, averaged 116.4 g/kWh and ranged from 13.5 to 356.9 g/kWh (Figure 2.11). The consumption factor sits above the production factor in every month because imports are carried at CAISO's default factor; it falls below zero in the export-heavy spring hours, and both factors are lowest in the middle of the day and highest in the summer nights. The Finnish factors that Manner showed for the same months averaged 29 to 31 g/kWh [Manner, 2026], a fifth to a quarter of the CAISO values.

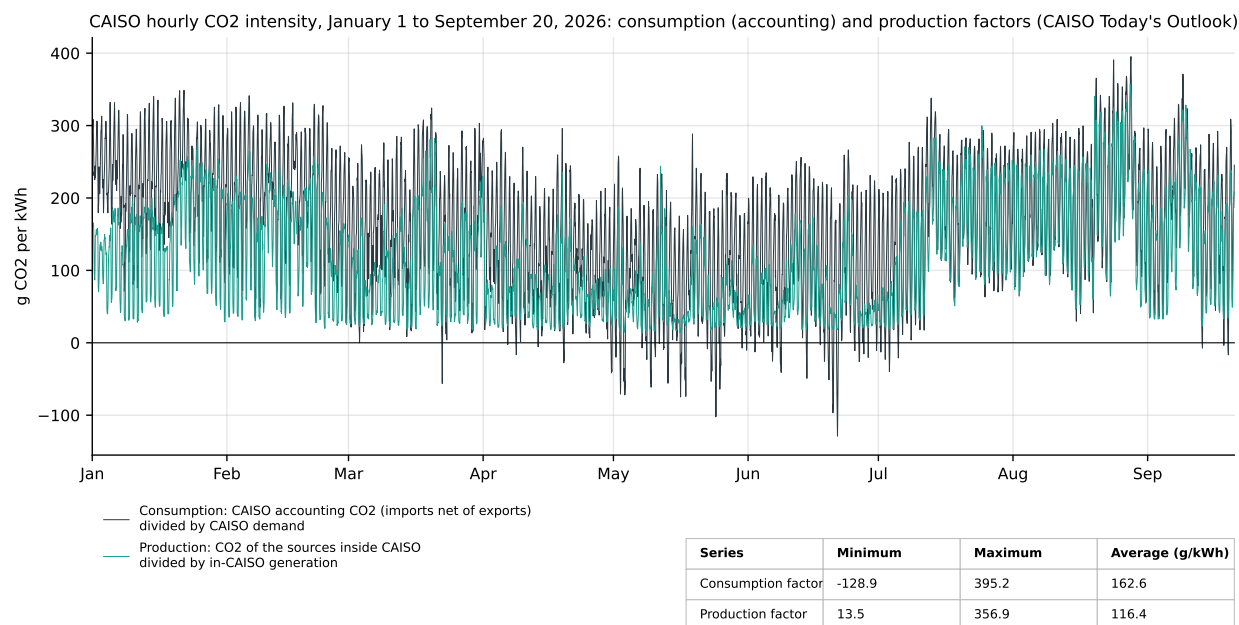


Figure 2.11: Hourly CO<sub>2</sub> intensity of CAISO demand (consumption, accounting basis) and of generation inside CAISO (production basis), January 1 to September 20, 2026, with the minimum, maximum and mean of each. Source: CAISO Today's Outlook CO<sub>2</sub>, demand and fuel-mix files.

Source line: fig1\_11. Data: ch1\_carbon\_intensity\_hourly\_2026.csv; ch1\_workshop\_stats.csv; caiso\_co2\_intensity\_hourly\_2026.parquet; caiso\_fuelmix\_hourly\_2026.parquet. Sources (manifest ids): caiso\_outlook\_co2, demand and fuelsource 2026 daily files. Code: ch1\_baseline.load\_caiso\_outlook\_hourly, load\_caiso\_fuelmix\_hourly, production\_intensity, hourly\_stats; run\_chapter1 step 5. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

**Imports and exports.** The neighbour-level interchange of EIA-930 separates gross imports from gross exports, which the net series of Section 2.1 cannot. Over the twelve months of 2025 CAISO imported 42.0 TWh and exported 6.0 TWh, a net 35.9 TWh over the 8,712 hours present, against the 36.1 TWh net imports of Table 2.2 computed from the balance file with its gaps filled; from January to August 2026 the figures are 30.1, 5.1 and 25.0 TWh (Figure 2.12, Table 2.10). Imports peaked at 5,547 GWh in December 2025 and were lowest at 2,622 GWh in July 2025; exports were lowest at 115 GWh in December 2025 and highest at 1,026 GWh in May 2026, the spring months in which the negative prices occur. The hourly sum over neighbours reproduces the balance file's net interchange to within 1 MW on average (note to Table 2.10).

CAISO gross imports and exports by month, January 2025 to August 2026 (EIA-930 interchange with each neighbouring balancing authority; complete months)

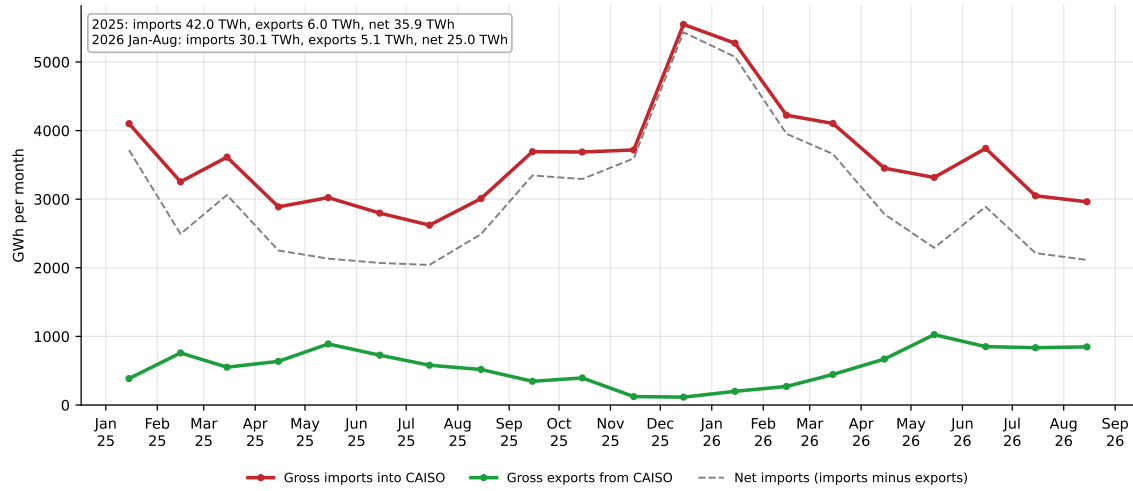


fig1\_12. Data: ch1\_imports\_exports\_monthly.csv; ciso\_interchange\_gross\_2025\_2026.parquet. Sources (manifest ids): eia930\_interchange\_2025\_jan\_jun .. 2026\_jul\_dec; eia930\_balance\_2025\_jan\_jun .. 2026\_jul\_dec (net check). Code: ch1\_baseline.load\_eia930\_interchange\_ciso, monthly\_imports\_exports; run\_chapter1 step 5. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 2.12: Gross imports into and exports from CAISO by month, January 2025 to August 2026, from the EIA-930 interchange with each neighbouring balancing authority; months with at least 95 percent of their hours present. Source: EIA-930 interchange files.

Source line: fig1\_12. Data: ch1\_imports\_exports\_monthly.csv; ciso\_interchange\_gross\_2025\_2026.parquet. Sources (manifest ids): eia930\_interchange\_2025\_jan\_jun .. 2026\_jul\_dec; eia930\_balance\_2025\_jan\_jun .. 2026\_jul\_dec (net check). Code: ch1\_baseline.load\_eia930\_interchange\_ciso, monthly\_imports\_exports; run\_chapter1 step 5. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Table 2.10: Gross imports, gross exports and net imports of CAISO by month (GWh) with the hours present, January 2025 to September 2026. Source: EIA-930 interchange files.

| Month        | Gross imports<br>(GWh) | Gross exports<br>(GWh) | Net imports<br>(GWh) | Hours present          |
|--------------|------------------------|------------------------|----------------------|------------------------|
| 2025-01      | 4,102                  | 386                    | 3,716                | 744 / 744              |
| 2025-02      | 3,253                  | 759                    | 2,494                | 672 / 672              |
| 2025-03      | 3,613                  | 551                    | 3,062                | 719 / 744              |
| 2025-04      | 2,888                  | 636                    | 2,252                | 720 / 720              |
| 2025-05      | 3,023                  | 890                    | 2,133                | 744 / 744              |
| 2025-06      | 2,797                  | 727                    | 2,071                | 720 / 720              |
| 2025-07      | 2,622                  | 580                    | 2,042                | 744 / 744              |
| 2025-08      | 3,009                  | 518                    | 2,491                | 744 / 744              |
| 2025-09      | 3,692                  | 346                    | 3,346                | 720 / 720              |
| 2025-10      | 3,688                  | 395                    | 3,293                | 720 / 744              |
| 2025-11      | 3,718                  | 123                    | 3,594                | 721 / 720              |
| 2025-12      | 5,547                  | 115                    | 5,433                | 744 / 744              |
| 2026-01      | 5,274                  | 199                    | 5,075                | 744 / 744              |
| 2026-02      | 4,224                  | 271                    | 3,954                | 672 / 672              |
| 2026-03      | 4,103                  | 445                    | 3,658                | 718 / 744              |
| 2026-04      | 3,452                  | 670                    | 2,782                | 719 / 720              |
| 2026-05      | 3,317                  | 1,026                  | 2,291                | 744 / 744              |
| 2026-06      | 3,741                  | 851                    | 2,890                | 720 / 720              |
| 2026-07      | 3,049                  | 835                    | 2,214                | 744 / 744              |
| 2026-08      | 2,962                  | 847                    | 2,115                | 744 / 744              |
| 2026-09      | 2,860                  | 294                    | 2,567                | 456 / 720 (incomplete) |
| 2025 total   | 41,953                 | 6,025                  | 35,928               | 8712                   |
| 2026 to date | 32,983                 | 5,438                  | 27,546               | 6261                   |

Check: the hourly sum of the neighbour flows against the balance file's net interchange over 14,949 hours of 2025–2026: mean absolute difference 1 MW, correlation 1.0000.

**Wind and solar against installed capacity.** The CAISO balancing authority held 9,994 MW of wind and 25,810 MW of solar nameplate in operation in July 2026 (Table 2.11); the state of California alone holds 6,479 MW of wind, because much of CAISO's wind sits in neighbouring states [U.S. Energy Information Administration, 2026b]. From January 1 to September 20, 2026 wind averaged 2,582 MW, 26 percent of nameplate, with a maximum of 7,126 MW or 71 percent; solar averaged 6,548 MW, 25 percent of nameplate, with a maximum of 20,852 MW or 81 percent (Figure 2.13). The Finnish wind fleet ran at 24 percent of its 9,405 MW over the same months [Manner, 2026], so the two systems have wind fleets of the same size and the same capacity factor; the difference is California's solar, which is two and a half times its wind.

Table 2.11: Operating wind and solar nameplate capacity in July 2026, inside the CAISO balancing authority and inside the state of California. Source: EIA-860M July 2026, Operating sheet.

| Technology | CAISO balancing authority<br>nameplate (MW) units |       | State of California<br>nameplate (MW) units |       |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------|-------|---------------------------------------------|-------|
| Solar      | 25,810                                            | 1,056 | 25,495                                      | 1,155 |
| Wind       | 9,994                                             | 130   | 6,479                                       | 129   |

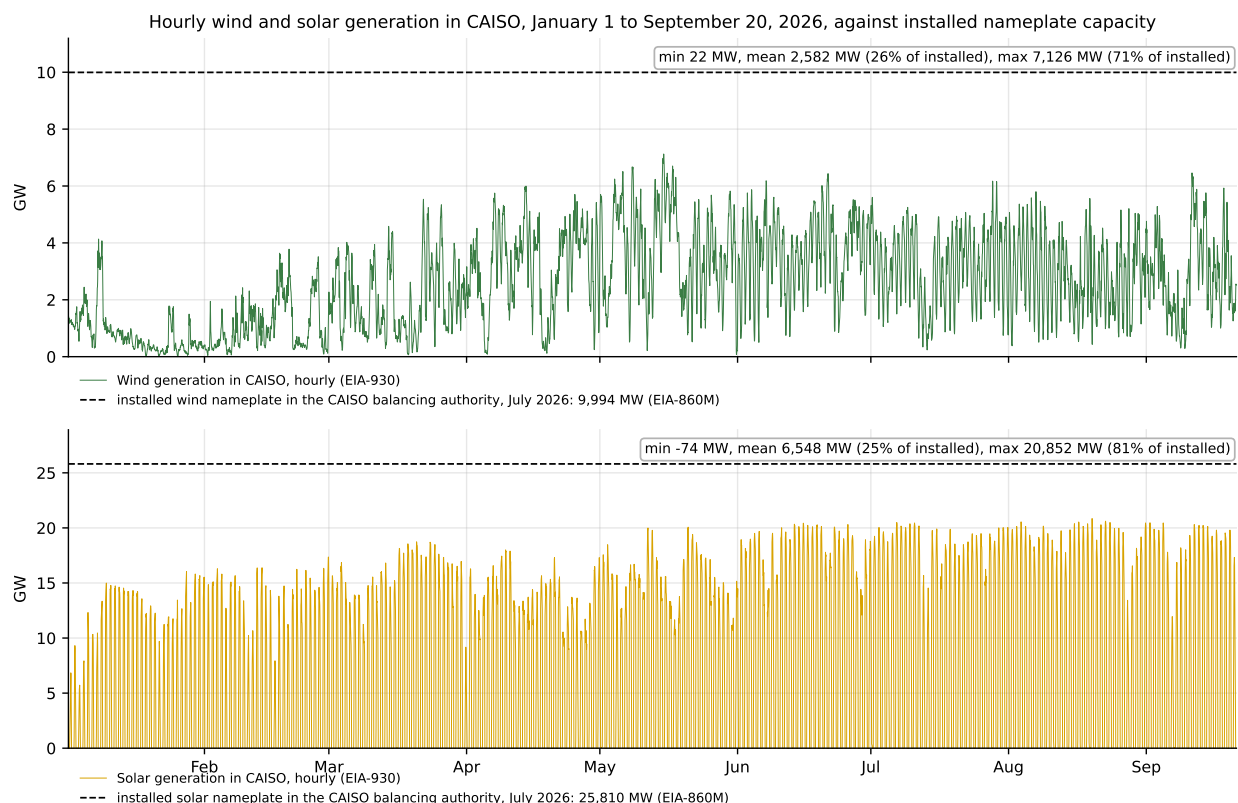


fig1\_13. Data: ch1\_hourly\_2026\_workshop.csv; ch1\_installed\_wind\_solar\_2026\_07.csv; ch1\_workshop\_stats.csv. Sources (manifest ids): eia930\_balance\_2026\_jan\_jun .. 2026\_jul\_dec; eia860m\_2026\_07. Code: ch1\_baseline.load\_eia930\_ciso, eia860m\_ba\_capacity, hourly\_stats; run\_chapter1 step 5. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 2.13: Hourly wind (top) and solar (bottom) generation in CAISO, January 1 to September 20, 2026, against the installed nameplate capacity of the CAISO balancing authority in July 2026, with the minimum, mean and maximum of each. Sources: EIA-930 balance files; EIA-860M July 2026.

Source line: fig1\_13. Data: ch1\_hourly\_2026\_workshop.csv; ch1\_installed\_wind\_solar\_2026\_07.csv; ch1\_workshop\_stats.csv. Sources (manifest ids): eia930\_balance\_2026\_jan\_jun .. 2026\_jul\_dec; eia860m\_2026\_07. Code: ch1\_baseline.load\_eia930\_ciso, eia860m\_ba\_capacity, hourly\_stats; run\_chapter1 step 5. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

**The Finnish benchmarks from their sources.** The proposal undertook to replicate Manner's benchmarks from the original public data rather than from his slides. Table 2.12 does so where the sources are open without a key. Statistics Finland's monthly supply table gives Finland's 2025 consumption as 84.5 TWh against 78.9 TWh generated in the country and 5.6 TWh of net imports, with wind at 22.2 TWh and nuclear at 31.3 TWh; over January to June 2026 consumption averaged 10,635 MW and in-country generation 9,761 MW, against the 10,454 and 9,609 MWh per hour on Manner's chart, which runs to early July [Statistics Finland, 2026, Manner, 2026]. Finnish wind produced 10.5 TWh in those six months, a capacity factor of 25.7 percent at the 9,405 MW that his slide gives as installed, against his 24 percent; the CAISO fleet, at 9,994 MW, produced the same 10.5 TWh over the same six months at a capacity factor of 24.2 percent (Figure 2.13). Statistics Finland's price table puts the total price with taxes for enterprises buying 20,000 to 70,000 MWh a year at 4.73 cents per kWh in 2025 and 6.50 in the first half of 2026, and for the largest class at 4.30 and 6.98, which brackets the 6.23 cents his hourly series averages; the energy component alone was 4.7 cents. The CAISO day-ahead price averaged 3.75 cents per kWh across the three

aggregation points in 2025 before any retail charge, so the two systems' wholesale energy costs are of the same order and Finland's advantage is in what is added on top. The CO<sub>2</sub> factors are Fingrid's datasets 265 and 266, whose definitions match the consumption and production factors of Figure 2.11; their data API requires a key, so the 29 and 31 g/kWh stand as Manner reports them, against 162.6 and 116.4 for CAISO in 2026 [Fingrid, 2026]. The registry itself is downloadable: the EK workbook of September 15, 2026 lists 9,276 MW of data center projects in the feasibility, planning and investment-decision phases, up from the 7,777 MW Manner read on June 15, and 238 MW that started operation since 2021, against the roughly 285 MW he gives as operating [Confederation of Finnish Industries (EK), 2026]; the September detail is in Table 5.22.

Table 2.12: Finnish benchmarks replicated from Statistics Finland, Fingrid’s dataset definitions and the EK registry, with the values Manner’s slides give where the source needs a key, and the CAISO counterparts from this chapter.

| Benchmark                                                                                    | Finland | CAISO  | Unit  | Finnish source and basis                                                                                                                                            | CAISO counterpart                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|--------|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Total electricity consumption 2025                                                           | 84.5    | 224.1  | TWh   | Statistics Finland 12su, twelve months of 2025                                                                                                                      | CAISO demand 2025 (Table 2.2)                                                      |
| Total electricity generation 2025                                                            | 78.9    | 188.0  | TWh   | Statistics Finland 12su                                                                                                                                             | CAISO demand minus net imports 2025                                                |
| Net imports 2025                                                                             | 5.6     | 36.1   | TWh   | Statistics Finland 12su (Sweden and Norway in, Estonia out)                                                                                                         | CAISO net imports 2025 (Table 2.2)                                                 |
| Wind generation 2025                                                                         | 22.2    | 19.8   | TWh   | Statistics Finland 12su                                                                                                                                             | CAISO wind 2025                                                                    |
| Nuclear generation 2025                                                                      | 31.3    | 17.6   | TWh   | Statistics Finland 12su                                                                                                                                             | California nuclear generation 2025 (EIA-923, chapter 4)                            |
| Average consumption, January to June 2026                                                    | 10,635  | 24,888 | MW    | Statistics Finland 12su, six months over 4,344 h; Manner’s slide 4 shows 10,454 MWh/h to early July                                                                 | CAISO demand, January to June 2026 (Figure 2.9)                                    |
| Average generation inside Finland, January to June 2026                                      | 9,761   | 16,703 | MW    | Statistics Finland 12su; Manner’s slide 4 shows 9,609 MWh/h                                                                                                         | net generation inside CAISO, January to June 2026                                  |
| Wind generation, January to June 2026                                                        | 10.5    | 10.5   | TWh   | Statistics Finland 12su                                                                                                                                             | CAISO wind, January to June 2026                                                   |
| Wind capacity factor, January to June 2026                                                   | 25.7    | 24.2   | %     | Statistics Finland wind generation over 9,405 MW installed (Manner slide 8; Fingrid dataset 268 holds the series behind it) times 4,344 h; Manner’s slide shows 24% | CAISO wind over 9,994 MW nameplate (Table 2.11)                                    |
| Electricity price with taxes, enterprises 2,000 to 19,999 MWh a year, 2025                   | 7.06    | –      | c/kWh | Statistics Finland 13rb, total price, twelve-month mean                                                                                                             | nan                                                                                |
| Electricity price with taxes, enterprises 20,000 to 69,999 MWh a year, 2025                  | 4.73    | 3.75   | c/kWh | Statistics Finland 13rb                                                                                                                                             | mean day-ahead price of the three DLAPs 2025, wholesale only, in cents (Table 2.5) |
| Electricity price with taxes, enterprises 70,000 to 150,000 MWh a year, 2025                 | 4.30    | –      | c/kWh | Statistics Finland 13rb                                                                                                                                             | nan                                                                                |
| Electricity price with taxes, enterprises 20,000 to 69,999 MWh a year, January to June 2026  | 6.50    | –      | c/kWh | Statistics Finland 13rb; Manner’s slide 5 gives 6.23 c/kWh with taxes as the 2025-2026 hourly mean                                                                  | nan                                                                                |
| Electricity price with taxes, enterprises 70,000 to 150,000 MWh a year, January to June 2026 | 6.98    | –      | c/kWh | Statistics Finland 13rb                                                                                                                                             | nan                                                                                |
| Energy component of that price, 2025 and January to June 2026                                | 4.69    | –      | c/kWh | Statistics Finland 13rb, electric energy excluding tax, 20,000 to 69,999 MWh class, mean of the two periods                                                         | nan                                                                                |
| Household price with taxes, 5,000 to 15,000 kWh a year, 2025                                 | 17.61   | –      | c/kWh | Statistics Finland 13rb                                                                                                                                             | not compiled (retail tariffs are outside the record)                               |
| CO2 factor of electricity consumed, January to June 2026 (mean)                              | 29.0    | 162.6  | g/kWh | Fingrid dataset 265 as shown on Manner’s slide 6 (the data API requires a key)                                                                                      | CAISO consumption factor, January to September 2026 (Figure 2.11)                  |
| CO2 factor of electricity produced, January to June 2026 (mean)                              | 31.0    | 116.4  | g/kWh | Fingrid dataset 266 as shown on Manner’s slide 6                                                                                                                    | in-CAISO production factor, January to September 2026 (Figure 2.11)                |
| Data center capacity operating                                                               | 285     | 1,000  | MW    | Manner slide 9 (half of it one Google site)                                                                                                                         | CEC, existing data center peak demand, December 2025                               |
| Data center capacity registered, all phases (June 15 2026)                                   | 7,777   | –      | MW    | EK dashboard as read by Manner (slide 12): 2,446 decided or dated by end-2027, 3,310 planning, 2,020 feasibility                                                    | nan                                                                                |
| Data center capacity registered, all phases (September 15 2026)                              | 9,276   | –      | MW    | EK workbook, Theme = Data center, phases feasibility study, planning and investment decision (chapter 5, EK registry table)                                         | nan                                                                                |

## Chapter 3

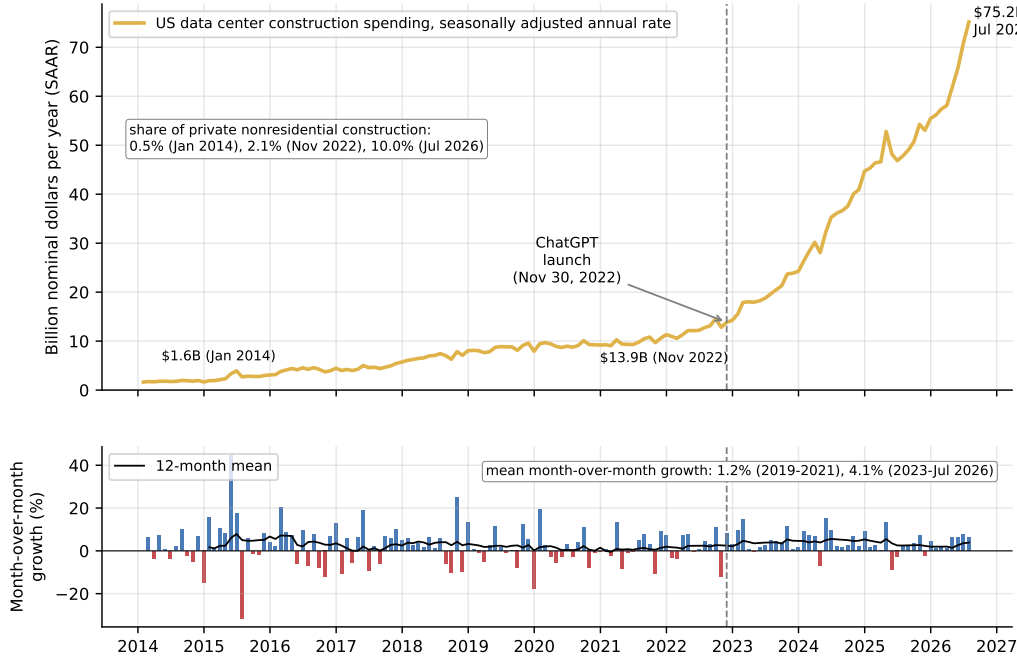
# Data Center Growth in California

This chapter answers RQ1: how California’s planned data center capacity varies by stage of development, in absolute terms and relative to the scale of the existing grid. It first reproduces the national construction-spending series that frames public discussion, tests it for structural breaks, and then asks whether California’s own indicators show the same acceleration. It ends with every vintage of the CEC’s energization tiers and the RQ1 table. All code is in `src/ch2_growth.py` and `notebooks/02_data_center_growth.ipynb`.

### 3.1 The national construction boom, reproduced

The Census Bureau’s Value of Construction Put in Place survey has carried a “data center” line under private nonresidential construction since January 2014 [U.S. Census Bureau, 2026]. Figure 3.1 reproduces the widely circulated chart from the raw seasonally adjusted workbook and adds month-over-month growth. Spending at a seasonally adjusted annual rate rose from \$1.6 billion in January 2014 to \$13.9 billion in November 2022 and \$75.2 billion in July 2026 (preliminary). Data centers were half a percent of private nonresidential construction in 2014, two percent when ChatGPT launched, and ten percent in July 2026. Month-over-month growth averaged 4.1 percent from 2023 through mid-2026 against 1.2 percent in 2019 through 2021. No comparable state-level series exists: the Census publishes this category for the nation only, and the California picture must be built from proxies (Section 3.3).

US private construction spending, data center category (nominal dollars, seasonally adjusted annual rate), Jan 2014 to Jul 2026 (Census C30)



Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Value of Construction Put in Place (privsatime.xlsx), accessed 2026-09-21; p = preliminary

fig2\_01. Data: ch2\_census\_c30\_data\_center.csv. Sources (manifest ids): census\_c30\_privsatime; census\_c30\_privtime. Code: ch2\_growth.census\_c30; run\_chapter2 step 1. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 3.1: US private data center construction spending, seasonally adjusted annual rate, with month-over-month growth. Source: Census C30, July 2026 preliminary.

Source line: fig2\_01. Data: ch2\_census\_c30\_data\_center.csv. Sources (manifest ids): census\_c30\_privsatime; census\_c30\_privtime. Code: ch2\_growth.census\_c30; run\_chapter2 step 1. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

## 3.2 Structural breaks and forecasts

The analysis works on the log of the seasonally adjusted series, so that a linear trend is a constant compound growth rate. Three questions are asked in turn: does a break at the known date change the trend (Chow test, Chow, 1960); where does the data itself place breaks when none is imposed (Bai-Perron, Bai and Perron, 1998, 2003); and what does a time-series model project. Growth rates carry Newey-West standard errors. The Bai-Perron search uses 15 percent trimming (a minimum segment of 23 months) and allows up to five breaks, the most the trimming permits, so that the choice of  $m$  is never censored by the search. The number of breaks is chosen three ways: by BIC, by the LWZ criterion, and by the sequential  $\text{supF}(l+1|l)$  procedure, in which each additional break is tested against the  $l$ -break model with a moving-block residual bootstrap  $p$ -value.  $\text{supF}(0|1)$  gets the same bootstrap under the no-break null, and the single-break date a residual-bootstrap 90 percent interval. The `ruptures` dynamic-programming search [Truong et al., 2020] is run as an independent check.

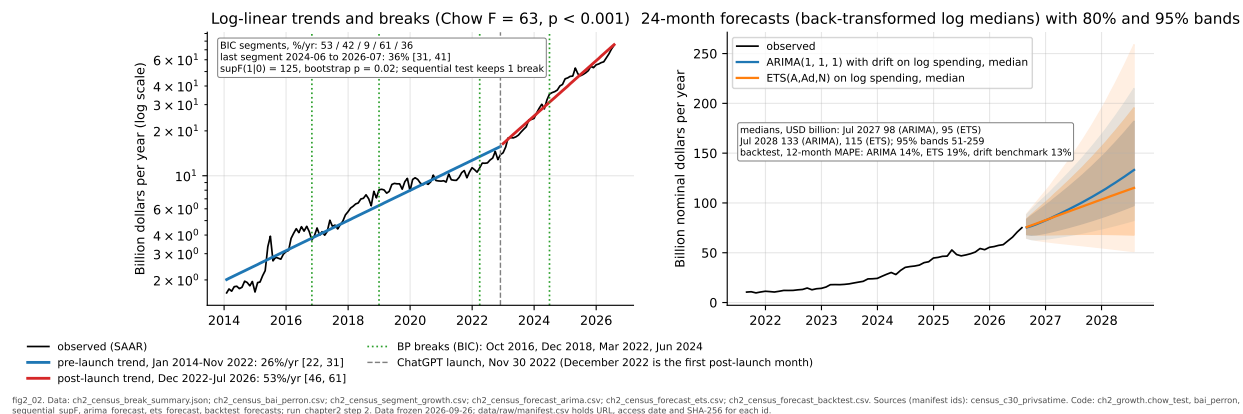


Figure 3.2: Left: log-linear trends before and after December 2022 with Bai-Perron break dates. Right: 24-month ARIMA and ETS forecasts with 80 and 95 percent prediction bands.

Source line: fig2\_02. Data: ch2\_census\_break\_summary.json; ch2\_census\_bai\_perron.csv; ch2\_census\_segment\_growth.csv; ch2\_census\_forecast\_arima.csv; ch2\_census\_forecast\_ets.csv; ch2\_census\_forecast\_backtest.csv. Sources (manifest ids): census\_c30\_privsatime. Code: ch2\_growth.chow\_test, bai\_perron, sequential\_supF, arima\_forecast, ets\_forecast, backtest\_forecasts; run\_chapter2 step 2. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Table 3.1: Bai-Perron global search on the log Census series: break dates, sum of squared residuals, information criteria, supF(0|m), and the sequential supF(m|m - 1) with its bootstrap p-value, for m = 0 to 5 breaks.

| Breaks m | Break dates (first month of new regime)     | SSR   | BIC    | LWZ    | supF(0 m) | supF(m m - 1) | boot. p |
|----------|---------------------------------------------|-------|--------|--------|-----------|---------------|---------|
| 0        | —                                           | 5.967 | -3.165 | -3.101 | —         | —             | —       |
| 1        | 2020-11                                     | 2.205 | -4.061 | -3.900 | 125.4     | 125.4         | 0.020   |
| 2        | 2018-12, 2022-03                            | 1.375 | -4.433 | -4.176 | 121.1     | 36.7          | 0.085   |
| 3        | 2016-10, 2018-12, 2022-03                   | 1.091 | -4.565 | -4.210 | 106.5     | 40.6          | 0.020   |
| 4        | 2016-10, 2018-12, 2022-03, 2024-06          | 0.880 | -4.680 | -4.228 | 101.9     | 40.6          | 0.005   |
| 5        | 2016-02, 2018-01, 2020-04, 2022-05, 2024-06 | 0.832 | -4.636 | -4.086 | 85.7      | —             | —       |

Table 3.2: Compound growth by segment of the BIC-selected partition (Newey-West 95 percent intervals).

| Segment (BIC partition) | Months | Compound growth (%/yr) | 95% interval |
|-------------------------|--------|------------------------|--------------|
| 2014-01 to 2016-09      | 33     | 53                     | [45, 61]     |
| 2016-10 to 2018-11      | 26     | 42                     | [37, 47]     |
| 2018-12 to 2022-02      | 39     | 9                      | [7, 10]      |
| 2022-03 to 2024-05      | 27     | 61                     | [56, 67]     |
| 2024-06 to 2026-07      | 26     | 36                     | [31, 41]     |

The known-date test is unambiguous. A break in intercept and slope at December 2022, the first full month after the November 30 launch, gives a Chow  $F$  of 63 ( $p < 0.001$ ) and the HAC-robust Wald test agrees ( $p < 0.001$ ). Compound growth was 26 percent a year (95 percent interval 22 to 31) through November 2022 and 53 percent a year (46 to 61) from December 2022. Neither

the date annotation nor the test establishes that the launch caused the acceleration; they establish that the trend changed then. Letting the data locate the breaks changes the story in two respects (Tables 3.1 and 3.2). BIC and LWZ both choose four breaks, in October 2016, December 2018, March 2022 and June 2024. The current expansion therefore began eight months before ChatGPT, in the hyperscaler capital-spending ramp of early 2022, and it has already slowed once: the segment from March 2022 to May 2024 grew at 61 percent a year (56 to 67) and the segment from June 2024 to July 2026 at 36 percent a year (31 to 41), still four times the 9 percent of 2019 to early 2022. The sequential procedure is more conservative.  $\text{supF}(1|0)$  of 125 rejects the no-break model ( $p = 0.02$ ), but  $\text{supF}(2|1)$  of 37 has a bootstrap  $p$ -value of 0.085, so at the 5 percent level the procedure stops at one break, in November 2020, even though the third and fourth breaks are each significant once the earlier ones are in place ( $p = 0.02$  and  $p = 0.005$ ). `ruptures` reproduces all four BIC dates within one month. The forecasts in Table 3.3 continue the recent trend: an ARIMA(1,1,1) with drift and a damped-trend ETS, both fitted to log spending, put July 2027 at \$95 to \$98 billion and July 2028 at \$115 to \$133 billion, with 95 percent bands from \$51 to \$259 billion by then. The point forecasts are back-transformed log medians, not arithmetic means, and the series is national nominal dollars, so the forecasts say nothing about California megawatts. A rolling-origin backtest over the last 24 months (Table 3.4) shows why they are exploratory: at a twelve-month horizon the mean absolute percentage error is 14 percent for the ARIMA and 19 percent for the ETS against 13 percent for a log random walk with drift, every model ran below the outcomes on average, and the 95 percent bands covered 92 percent of outcomes for the ARIMA and 79 percent for the ETS. The bands, not the point forecasts, are the finding: a series whose growth rate has shifted four times in twelve years, and which a drift benchmark forecasts as well as either model, is not something a planner should extrapolate.

Table 3.3: Forecasts of US data center construction spending, 6, 12 and 24 months ahead: back-transformed log medians with 80 and 95 percent bands, nominal dollars.

| Month    | ARIMA(1, 1, 1) with drift |               |               | ETS(A,Ad,N) |               |               |
|----------|---------------------------|---------------|---------------|-------------|---------------|---------------|
|          | Mean                      | 80% band      | 95% band      | Mean        | 80% band      | 95% band      |
| Jan 2027 | 84.5                      | [70.7, 101.0] | [64.3, 111.0] | 84.4        | [68.0, 104.7] | [60.6, 117.4] |
| Jul 2027 | 98.3                      | [78.0, 124.0] | [68.9, 140.2] | 94.8        | [68.4, 131.3] | [57.6, 156.0] |
| Jul 2028 | 133.2                     | [97.4, 182.1] | [82.5, 214.9] | 115.1       | [67.8, 195.6] | [51.2, 258.9] |

Billion dollars per year, seasonally adjusted annual rate.

Table 3.4: Rolling-origin backtest over the last 24 months: mean absolute percentage error on the level scale, root-mean-square log error, mean log error (bias) and band coverage, by horizon, for the two models and two benchmarks.

| Model                             | MAPE (%) | 1 month ahead |            |              |  | MAPE (%) | 6 months ahead |            |              |  | MAPE (%) | 12 months ahead |            |              |  |
|-----------------------------------|----------|---------------|------------|--------------|--|----------|----------------|------------|--------------|--|----------|-----------------|------------|--------------|--|
|                                   |          | RMSE (log)    | bias (log) | cover. 80/95 |  |          | RMSE (log)     | bias (log) | cover. 80/95 |  |          | RMSE (log)      | bias (log) | cover. 80/95 |  |
| ARIMA (log, drift)                | 4.6      | 0.06          | -0.02      | 96 / 100     |  | 11.6     | 0.14           | -0.08      | 75 / 100     |  | 14.0     | 0.20            | -0.11      | 67 / 92      |  |
| ETS(A,Ad,N) (log)                 | 4.9      | 0.06          | -0.03      | 96 / 100     |  | 13.9     | 0.18           | -0.11      | 75 / 92      |  | 18.8     | 0.30            | -0.20      | 67 / 79      |  |
| drift benchmark (log random walk) | 4.0      | 0.06          | -0.01      | - / -        |  | 10.2     | 0.12           | -0.06      | - / -        |  | 13.0     | 0.18            | -0.10      | - / -        |  |
| naive benchmark (last value)      | 5.1      | 0.07          | -0.04      | - / -        |  | 18.2     | 0.23           | -0.21      | - / -        |  | 31.2     | 0.41            | -0.39      | - / -        |  |

### 3.3 California proxies

Three California indicators are subjected to the same battery, with the known break set to the first period after November 2022 (Figure 3.3, Table 3.5).

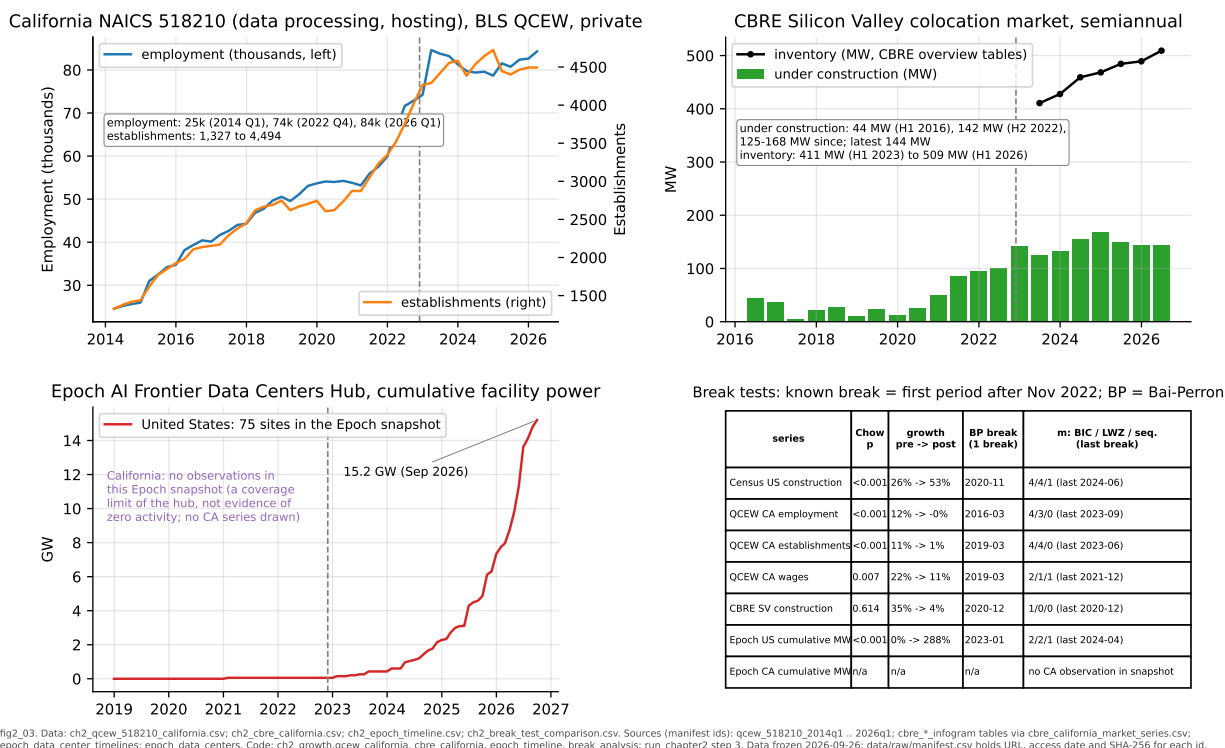


Figure 3.3: California proxies for data center growth: BLS QCEW NAICS 518210 labour indicators (top left), CBRE Silicon Valley construction and inventory (top right), Epoch AI frontier sites, whose snapshot has no California observation (bottom left), and the break-test summary (bottom right); the single-break column is the one-break model's estimate and p-values below 0.001 are shown as such.

Source line: fig2\_03. Data: ch2\_qcew\_518210\_california.csv; ch2\_cbre\_california.csv; ch2\_epoch\_timeline.csv; ch2\_break\_test\_comparison.csv. Sources (manifest ids): qcew\_518210\_2014q1 .. 2026q1; cbre\_\*\_infogram tables via cbre\_california\_market\_series.csv; epoch\_data\_center\_timelines; epoch\_data\_centers. Code: ch2\_growth.qcew\_california, cbre\_california, epoch\_timeline, break\_analysis; run\_chapter2 step 3. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Table 3.5: Break tests on the Census series and the California proxies. Chow: known break at the first period after November 2022. BP: Bai-Perron single break with residual-bootstrap 90 percent interval, the number of breaks chosen by BIC, LWZ and the sequential procedure, the BIC-selected dates, and the bootstrap  $p$ -value of  $\sup F(0|1)$ .

| Series                                                      | n   | Chow F                                                                                     | p     | HAC p | Growth before (%/yr) | Growth after (%/yr) | BP break (1) | 90% interval       | m: BIC/LWZ/seq. | BP breaks (BIC)                    | boot. p |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|-------|----------------------|---------------------|--------------|--------------------|-----------------|------------------------------------|---------|
| Census data center construction (monthly, SAAR)             | 151 | 63.0                                                                                       | 0.000 | 0.000 | 26 [22, 31]          | 53 [46, 61]         | 2020-11      | 2020-11 to 2020-11 | 4/4/1           | 2016-10, 2018-12, 2022-03, 2024-06 | 0.010   |
| QCEW 518210 California employment (quarterly)               | 49  | 15.0                                                                                       | 0.000 | 0.000 | 12 [9, 14]           | -0 [-2, 2]          | 2016-03      | 2016-03 to 2021-12 | 4/3/0           | 2016-03, 2018-09, 2021-03, 2023-09 | 0.035   |
| QCEW 518210 California establishments (quarterly)           | 49  | 11.0                                                                                       | 0.000 | 0.000 | 11 [9, 13]           | 1 [-1, 2]           | 2019-03      | 2016-12 to 2022-09 | 4/4/0           | 2016-03, 2018-03, 2020-12, 2023-06 | 0.285   |
| QCEW 518210 California wages (quarterly)                    | 49  | 5.5                                                                                        | 0.007 | 0.000 | 22 [19, 24]          | 11 [9, 13]          | 2019-03      | 2016-12 to 2019-06 | 2/1/1           | 2019-03, 2021-12                   | 0.005   |
| CBRE Silicon Valley MW under construction (semiannual)      | 21  | 0.5                                                                                        | 0.614 | 0.000 | 35 [10, 66]          | 4 [-2, 10]          | 2020-12      | 2020-12 to 2020-12 | 1/0/0           | 2020-12                            | 0.140   |
| Epoch frontier sites, United States cumulative MW (monthly) | 69  | 176.1                                                                                      | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0 [-0, 0]            | 288 [250, 331]      | 2023-01      | 2023-01 to 2023-01 | 2/2/1           | 2023-01, 2024-04                   | 0.005   |
| Epoch frontier sites, California cumulative MW              | 0   | no California observation in the Epoch snapshot (0 of 87 sites): a coverage limit of the h |       |       |                      |                     |              |                    |                 |                                    |         |

**Employment and establishments.** The Quarterly Census of Employment and Wages counts private establishments and jobs in NAICS 518210, computing infrastructure, data processing, hosting and related services, by quarter [U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, 2026]. These are labour

indicators of an industry, not counts of buildings or megawatts, and the industry includes hosting and processing firms that do not operate data centers. California employment in the industry rose from 25,000 in 2014 Q1 to 74,000 by the end of 2022, then flattened: 84,000 in 2026 Q1 after a plateau through 2024 and 2025. The Chow test at 2023 Q1 rejects a common trend ( $F = 15$ ,  $p < 0.001$ ), but the break is a deceleration, from 12 percent a year to roughly zero. Establishments show the same shape, 11 percent a year to 0.5 percent ( $F = 11$ ). Data-located breaks in these smooth quarterly series are diffuse: BIC places four in each, the last in 2023 Q3 for employment and 2023 Q2 for establishments, but the single-break bootstrap is significant only for employment ( $p = 0.035$  against 0.285 for establishments) and the sequential procedure keeps no break in either. Wages decelerated from 22 to 11 percent a year ( $p = 0.007$ ) with breaks in 2019 Q1 and 2021 Q4 that reflect the industry’s earlier expansion. The county detail is in the notebook; Santa Clara, Los Angeles and San Francisco account for most of the state total.

**MW under construction.** CBRE’s semiannual market chapters give Silicon Valley colocation capacity under construction from H1 2016 and inventory from H1 2023 [CBRE Research, 2026]. Construction rose from 44 MW in H1 2016 to 142 MW by H2 2022 and has since ranged between 125 and 168 MW, with inventory creeping from 411 to 509 MW. Megawatts under construction are a stock whose change reflects completions as well as starts, and the series covers one colocation market, not California construction spending. The Chow test finds no break at H1 2023 ( $p = 0.61$ ). BIC keeps a single break in H2 2020, when the pipeline stepped up from tens of megawatts to over a hundred, and growth has been 4 percent a year since; LWZ and the sequential procedure keep no break at all (bootstrap  $p = 0.14$ ), which is what a plateau looks like in 21 semiannual points. Cushman & Wakefield’s tables are form-gated and JLL’s report gives a single-period inventory, so the digitized series rests on CBRE; Southern California is available only from H1 2024 and is reported in the notebook.

**Frontier facilities.** Epoch AI’s hub tracks 89 large AI data centers from satellite imagery and permits (snapshot of September 22, 2026), 75 of them in the United States, with per-site power timelines [Epoch AI, 2026b]. Cumulative US power in these sites went from under 0.5 GW at the end of 2023 to 15.2 GW by September 2026, with a break in January 2023; the curve is a reconstruction from sampled sites, and its breaks can reflect the hub’s coverage and retrospective estimates as much as construction. None of the 89 sites in the snapshot is in California. That is a limit of the hub’s coverage, which Epoch itself describes as incomplete and uneven, not evidence that no frontier facility exists or is being built in California; no California series is drawn and no test is possible.

The three proxies agree on a finding that the national series hides: after 2022 California’s data center industry did not accelerate in jobs, establishments or built Silicon Valley colocation capacity, and the largest AI campuses in Epoch’s sample were sited elsewhere. The growth that California records is in requests to connect, which is the subject of the next section, and the divergence between requests and built capacity is exactly what the tiers are meant to measure.

### 3.4 Every vintage of the energization tiers

Table 3.6 and Figure 3.4 assemble every published vintage of the CEC’s data center energization requests, followed by the two utility-level series that carry the record past December 2025. The December 2024 data behind the 2024 IEPR Update are known only as PG&E’s and SCE’s agreements

plus applications, 5,808 and 963 MW, because inquiries were not published [California Energy Commission, 2025]. The summer 2025 data behind the preliminary 2025 forecast are published as totals by utility, 21,756 MW across seven utilities; for PG&E and SCE the deck also gives agreements plus applications, 10,080 and 143 MW, so their inquiries were 1,588 and 5,685 MW [California Energy Commission, 2025]. The copy of that deck filed for the November 12, 2025 workshop labelled SCE at 2,492 MW and SVP at 1,382 MW; the published deck corrects these to 143 and 1,375 MW, and the corrected figures are used here. The December 2025 data behind the adopted forecast are the first complete vintage: 5,086 MW signed, 9,587 MW in application and 8,604 MW in inquiry, 23,277 MW in all, with PG&E accounting for 14,747 MW and SCE for 4,624 MW by the memo’s tier rows [California Energy Commission, 2026d,b]. The memo’s footnote states that VEA’s 2,600 MW of applications are for locations in Nevada, inside the CAISO footprint but outside California, and the CEC excludes them from statewide consumption; the pipeline located in California is therefore 20,677 MW (5,086 signed, 6,987 in application, 8,604 in inquiry), and the summer 2025 total contains the same 2,600 MW, leaving 19,156 MW in California. The published marginal totals and the utility rows differ by 1 MW (23,277 against 23,278); both are kept and the marginal totals are used. The August 2026 workshop restated the December 2025 figures and showed June 2026 known-load data only as charts [Smith, 2026]. SCE’s public project database provides the only vintages with cancellations: between its August 2025 and January 2026 versions, inquiries fell from 5,934 to 1,772 MW as about 3,100 MW moved into the application stage, canceled requests rose from 709 to 3,137 MW, and the active total fell from 6,201 to 5,162 MW [Southern California Edison, 2026]. The growth in SCE’s total records between the two snapshots is cancellations, not pipeline; thirty-eight percent of everything SCE had ever logged was canceled within five months, the first direct California evidence on attrition. PG&E’s pipeline table from its second-quarter 2026 earnings, reproduced in its August 2026 presentation to the CEC, uses PG&E’s own stages and excludes inquiries: 5,090 MW in March 2026 and 12,710 MW in June 2026, of which 3,880 MW had a signed work performance agreement, 490 MW an interconnection construction agreement and 140 MW was in construction [Pacific Gas and Electric Company, 2026b]. The jump of almost 8,000 MW in one quarter came from the 2026 cluster study. The Public Advocates Office observes that PG&E had filed agreements covering only about 650 MW with the CPUC for approval [Public Advocates Office, California Public Utilities Commission, 2026], so even the most committed tier has layers of certainty inside it. The three source families of Figure 3.4, the CEC’s statewide vintages, SCE’s database and PG&E’s earnings pipeline, differ in utility coverage, stage definitions and dates, so their bar heights are not one growth series, and signed agreements are commitments to connect, not operating capacity.

Table 3.6: Vintages of the CEC energization tiers found in the record (MW of requested capacity). SCE rows are that utility’s public project database. PG&E rows use PG&E’s own pipeline stages from its Q2 2026 earnings, where WPA+ means a signed work performance agreement or a later stage, and exclude inquiries.

| Vintage                                                  | Signed     | Applications | Inquiries | Agr.+appl. only | Unsplit total  | Total active (MW) |
|----------------------------------------------------------|------------|--------------|-----------|-----------------|----------------|-------------------|
| Dec 2024 (2024 IEPH Update)                              | 0          | 0            | 0         | 6,771           | 0              | 6,771             |
| Summer 2025 (2025 IEPH preliminary)                      | 0          | 0            | 7,273     | 10,223          | 4,260          | 21,756            |
| Dec 2025 (2025 IEPH final)                               | 5,086      | 9,587        | 8,605     | 0               | 0              | 23,278            |
| Aug 2026 workshop (restates Dec 2025)                    | 0          | 0            | 0         | 0               | 23,278         | 23,278            |
| SCE database Aug 29 2025 (SCE only)                      | 51         | 216          | 5,934     | –               | canceled 709   | 6,201             |
| SCE database Jan 29 2026 (SCE only)                      | 76         | 3,313        | 1,772     | –               | canceled 3,137 | 5,162             |
| PG&E earnings pipeline Jun 2026 (PG&E only, PG&E stages) | WPA+ 4,510 | 8,200        | n/a       | 12,710          | –              | 12,710            |
| PG&E earnings pipeline Mar 2026 (PG&E only, PG&E stages) | WPA+ 3,390 | 1,700        | n/a       | 5,090           | –              | 5,090             |

Totals are as reported by the utilities and include VEA’s 2,600 MW (summer 2025) and 2,600 MW (December 2025) of requests located in Nevada; California-only totals are 19,156 and 20,678 MW by utility rows (the CEC’s marginal totals are 1 MW lower: 23,277 and 20,677 MW). SCE active totals exclude canceled requests.

Table 3.7: Every utility-by-tier figure behind the December 2024 and summer 2025 vintages in Table 3.6, with its source: the transcription record for the megawatt figures quoted in this section.

| Vintage | Source vintage                      | Utility   | Tier or stage                            | MW     | Source (manifest id, page)  | Note                                                                             |
|---------|-------------------------------------|-----------|------------------------------------------|--------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024-12 | Dec 2024 (2024 IEPH Update)         | PG&E      | Agreements + applications (no inquiries) | 5,808  | cec_prelim_dc_forecast_2025 | p.7                                                                              |
| 2024-12 | Dec 2024 (2024 IEPH Update)         | SCE       | Agreements + applications (no inquiries) | 963    | cec_prelim_dc_forecast_2025 | p.7                                                                              |
| 2024-12 | Dec 2024 (2024 IEPH Update)         | all       | total (all rows)                         | 6,771  | sum of the rows above       |                                                                                  |
| 2025-08 | Summer 2025 (2025 IEPH preliminary) | Burbank   | All tiers                                | 100    | cec_prelim_dc_forecast_2025 | p.6                                                                              |
| 2025-08 | Summer 2025 (2025 IEPH preliminary) | PG&E      | Agreements + applications (no inquiries) | 10,080 | cec_prelim_dc_forecast_2025 | p.7                                                                              |
| 2025-08 | Summer 2025 (2025 IEPH preliminary) | PG&E      | Inquiry                                  | 1,588  | cec_prelim_dc_forecast_2025 | p.6 minus p.7; residual: utility total minus agreements + applications           |
| 2025-08 | Summer 2025 (2025 IEPH preliminary) | Palo Alto | All tiers                                | 85     | cec_prelim_dc_forecast_2025 | p.6                                                                              |
| 2025-08 | Summer 2025 (2025 IEPH preliminary) | SCE       | Agreements + applications (no inquiries) | 143    | cec_prelim_dc_forecast_2025 | p.7; workshop copy TN267165 p.8 labelled SCE 2025 as 2,492 MW; published deck sa |
| 2025-08 | Summer 2025 (2025 IEPH preliminary) | SCE       | Inquiry                                  | 5,685  | cec_prelim_dc_forecast_2025 | p.6 minus p.7; residual: utility total minus agreements + applications           |
| 2025-08 | Summer 2025 (2025 IEPH preliminary) | SDG&E     | All tiers                                | 100    | cec_prelim_dc_forecast_2025 | p.6                                                                              |
| 2025-08 | Summer 2025 (2025 IEPH preliminary) | SVP       | All tiers                                | 1,375  | cec_prelim_dc_forecast_2025 | p.6; workshop copy TN267165 p.7 labelled SVP as 1,382 MW; published deck says 1, |
| 2025-08 | Summer 2025 (2025 IEPH preliminary) | VEA       | All tiers                                | 2,600  | cec_prelim_dc_forecast_2025 | p.6                                                                              |
| 2025-08 | Summer 2025 (2025 IEPH preliminary) | PG&E      | utility total                            | 11,668 | sum of the rows above       |                                                                                  |
| 2025-08 | Summer 2025 (2025 IEPH preliminary) | SCE       | utility total                            | 5,828  | sum of the rows above       |                                                                                  |
| 2025-08 | Summer 2025 (2025 IEPH preliminary) | all       | total (all rows)                         | 21,756 | sum of the rows above       |                                                                                  |

Table 3.8: The December 2025 vintage by utility and tier (memo Table 1), with utility totals.

| Vintage | Source vintage                         | Utility   | Tier or stage      | MW     | Source (manifest id, page)   | Note        |
|---------|----------------------------------------|-----------|--------------------|--------|------------------------------|-------------|
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | Burbank   | Active application | 0      | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | Burbank   | Inquiry            | 100    | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | Burbank   | Signed agreement   | 0      | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | PG&E      | Active application | 3,617  | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | PG&E      | Inquiry            | 6,774  | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | PG&E      | Signed agreement   | 4,356  | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | Palo Alto | Active application | 0      | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | Palo Alto | Inquiry            | 55     | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | Palo Alto | Signed agreement   | 14     | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | SCE       | Active application | 3,174  | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | SCE       | Inquiry            | 1,378  | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | SCE       | Signed agreement   | 72     | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | SDG&E     | Active application | 0      | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | SDG&E     | Inquiry            | 100    | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | SDG&E     | Signed agreement   | 0      | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | SVP       | Active application | 196    | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | SVP       | Inquiry            | 198    | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | SVP       | Signed agreement   | 644    | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | VEA       | Active application | 2,600  | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | VEA       | Inquiry            | 0      | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | VEA       | Signed agreement   | 0      | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 | Table 1 p.5 |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | Burbank   | utility total      | 100    | sum of the rows above        |             |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | PG&E      | utility total      | 14,747 | sum of the rows above        |             |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | Palo Alto | utility total      | 69     | sum of the rows above        |             |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | SCE       | utility total      | 4,624  | sum of the rows above        |             |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | SDG&E     | utility total      | 100    | sum of the rows above        |             |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | SVP       | utility total      | 1,038  | sum of the rows above        |             |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | VEA       | utility total      | 2,600  | sum of the rows above        |             |
| 2025-12 | Dec 2025 (2025 IEPR final)             | all       | total (all rows)   | 23,278 | sum of the rows above        |             |
| 2026-08 | Aug 2026 workshop (re-states Dec 2025) | all       | Total restated     | 23,278 | cec_tn272026                 | p.5         |
| 2026-08 | Aug 2026 workshop (re-states Dec 2025) | all       | total (all rows)   | 23,278 | sum of the rows above        |             |

Table 3.9: The utility-level series behind Table 3.6: SCE's public project database, PG&E's earnings pipeline, and the Cal Advocates memo figure.

| Vintage | Source vintage                                  | Utility | Tier or stage                                | MW     | Source (manifest id, page) | Note                                                                             |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------|---------|----------------------------------------------|--------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025-08 | SCE database Aug 29 2025                        | SCE     | Active application                           | 216    | cec_tn266008               |                                                                                  |
| 2025-08 | SCE database Aug 29 2025                        | SCE     | Canceled                                     | 709    | cec_tn266008               |                                                                                  |
| 2025-08 | SCE database Aug 29 2025                        | SCE     | Inquiry                                      | 5,934  | cec_tn266008               |                                                                                  |
| 2025-08 | SCE database Aug 29 2025                        | SCE     | Signed agreement                             | 51     | cec_tn266008               |                                                                                  |
| 2025-08 | SCE database Aug 29 2025                        | all     | total (active)                               | 6,201  | sum of the rows above      | excludes canceled                                                                |
| 2025-08 | SCE database Aug 29 2025                        | all     | total, all records including canceled        | 6,910  | sum of the rows above      |                                                                                  |
| 2026-01 | SCE database Jan 29 2026                        | SCE     | Active application                           | 3,313  | cec_tn268459               |                                                                                  |
| 2026-01 | SCE database Jan 29 2026                        | SCE     | Canceled                                     | 3,137  | cec_tn268459               |                                                                                  |
| 2026-01 | SCE database Jan 29 2026                        | SCE     | Inquiry                                      | 1,772  | cec_tn268459               |                                                                                  |
| 2026-01 | SCE database Jan 29 2026                        | SCE     | Signed agreement                             | 76     | cec_tn268459               |                                                                                  |
| 2026-01 | SCE database Jan 29 2026                        | all     | total (active)                               | 5,162  | sum of the rows above      | excludes canceled                                                                |
| 2026-01 | SCE database Jan 29 2026                        | all     | total, all records including canceled        | 8,299  | sum of the rows above      |                                                                                  |
| 2026-03 | PG&E earnings pipeline Mar 2026                 | PG&E    | PG&E: application + preliminary engineering  | 1,700  | cec_tn272065               | p.9 (PG&E Q2 2026 earnin; PG&E stage definitions (PES fee paid and later); no in |
| 2026-03 | PG&E earnings pipeline Mar 2026                 | PG&E    | PG&E: construction                           | 140    | cec_tn272065               | p.9 (PG&E Q2 2026 earnin; PG&E stage definitions (PES fee paid and later); no in |
| 2026-03 | PG&E earnings pipeline Mar 2026                 | PG&E    | PG&E: final engineering (WPA signed)         | 3,110  | cec_tn272065               | p.9 (PG&E Q2 2026 earnin; PG&E stage definitions (PES fee paid and later); no in |
| 2026-03 | PG&E earnings pipeline Mar 2026                 | PG&E    | PG&E: interconnection construction agreement | 140    | cec_tn272065               | p.9 (PG&E Q2 2026 earnin; PG&E stage definitions (PES fee paid and later); no in |
| 2026-03 | PG&E earnings pipeline Mar 2026                 | all     | total (all rows)                             | 5,090  | sum of the rows above      |                                                                                  |
| 2026-06 | PG&E earnings pipeline Jun 2026                 | PG&E    | PG&E: application + preliminary engineering  | 8,200  | cec_tn272065               | p.9 (PG&E Q2 2026 earnin; PG&E stage definitions (PES fee paid and later); no in |
| 2026-06 | PG&E earnings pipeline Jun 2026                 | PG&E    | PG&E: construction                           | 140    | cec_tn272065               | p.9 (PG&E Q2 2026 earnin; PG&E stage definitions (PES fee paid and later); no in |
| 2026-06 | PG&E earnings pipeline Jun 2026                 | PG&E    | PG&E: final engineering (WPA signed)         | 3,880  | cec_tn272065               | p.9 (PG&E Q2 2026 earnin; PG&E stage definitions (PES fee paid and later); no in |
| 2026-06 | PG&E earnings pipeline Jun 2026                 | PG&E    | PG&E: interconnection construction agreement | 490    | cec_tn272065               | p.9 (PG&E Q2 2026 earnin; PG&E stage definitions (PES fee paid and later); no in |
| 2026-06 | PG&E earnings pipeline Jun 2026                 | all     | total (all rows)                             | 12,710 | sum of the rows above      |                                                                                  |
| 2026-09 | Cal Advocates comments on the Aug 2026 workshop | PG&E    | memo: WPAs filed at the CPUC                 | 650    | cec_tn272807 p.3-4         | about 650 MW filed; 3,880 MW stated as signed                                    |

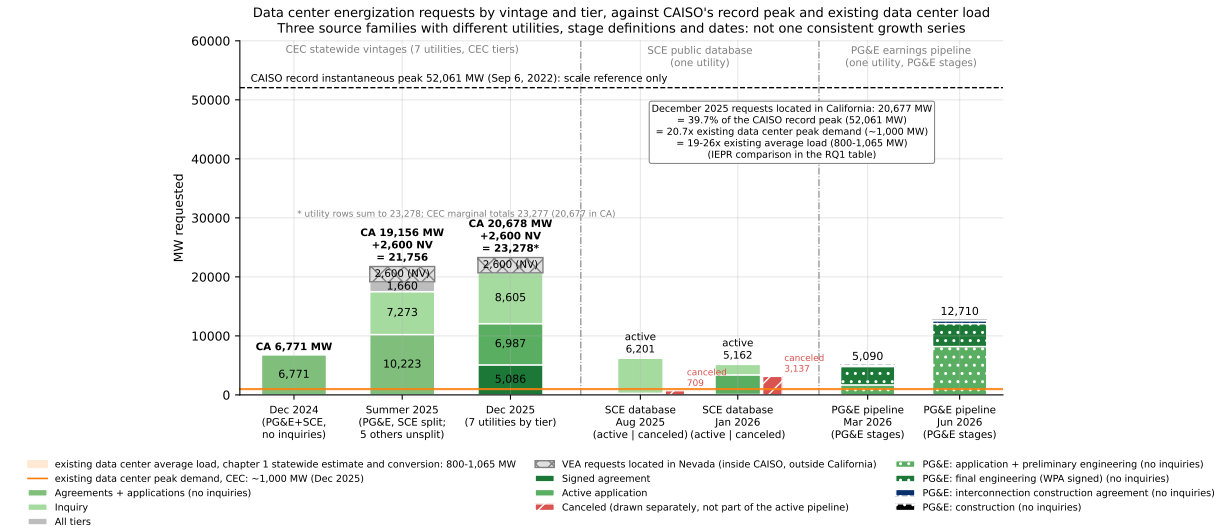


Figure 3.4: Energization requests by vintage and tier against CAISO’s record peak and the existing data center average load from Chapter 2. VEA’s requests in Nevada are hatched and California-only totals are labelled; SCE’s canceled requests are drawn beside, not on top of, its active pipeline; the three source families are divided because they differ in utilities, stages and dates.

Source line: fig2\_04. Data: ch2\_tier\_vintages.csv; ch2\_rq1\_denominators.json; ch1\_dc\_load\_estimates.csv. Sources (manifest ids): cec\_dc\_forecast\_2024iepr; cec\_prelim\_dc\_forecast\_2025; cec\_dc\_methodology\_memo\_2026; cec\_assembly\_hearing\_2026\_01\_28; cec\_tn266008; cec\_tn268459; cec\_tn272026; cec\_tn272065; cec\_tn272807; caiso\_key\_statistics\_2026\_08. Code: ch2\_growth.tier\_vintages; run\_chapter2 steps 4 and 5. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

The sums and ratios are stated explicitly. The three December 2025 tiers total 23,277 MW as reported and 20,677 MW located in California. Against CAISO’s record instantaneous peak of 52,061 MW on September 6, 2022 [California Independent System Operator, 2026b], the California pipeline is 40 percent (40 percent against the hourly EIA-930 peak of 51,104 MW, and 45 percent for the reported total including Nevada). This is a scale comparison, not a coincident-peak ratio and not a measure of usable headroom. Against the roughly 1,000 MW of existing data center peak demand that the CEC reports for December 2025, it is 21 times; against the 800 to 1,065 MW of existing average load implied by the chapter 1 statewide estimate and assumed conversion, 19 to 26 times. Finland’s ratio of registered to installed capacity was 27 [Manner, 2026]; California’s is of the same order.

### 3.5 RQ1: planned capacity by stage

Table 3.10: RQ1: California’s planned data center capacity by stage (December 2025, requests located in California) relative to the grid, to existing data center load, and to the adopted forecast’s peak and energy growth to 2030; VEA’s Nevada requests and the CEC’s reported total are memo rows.

| Stage (Dec 2025)                         | MW     | % of CAISO record peak | % of 2025 peak | × existing DC peak | × existing DC avg. load | % of IEPR peak growth | % of IEPR growth at 67% util. | Energy equiv. (TWh/yr) | % of IEPR energy growth |
|------------------------------------------|--------|------------------------|----------------|--------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------|
| Signed agreements                        | 5,086  | 9.8                    | 11.6           | 5.1x               | 4.8-6.4x                | 127                   | 85                            | 26                     | 75                      |
| Active applications, California          | 6,987  | 13.4                   | 15.9           | 7.0x               | 6.6-8.7x                | 174                   | 116                           | 36                     | 103                     |
| Inquiries                                | 8,604  | 16.5                   | 19.6           | 8.6x               | 8.1-10.8x               | 214                   | 143                           | 44                     | 127                     |
| Total, three tiers, California only      | 20,677 | 39.7                   | 47.1           | 20.7x              | 19.4-25.8x              | 514                   | 345                           | 107                    | 305                     |
| Memo: VEA applications located in Nevada | 2,600  | 5.0                    | 5.9            | 2.6x               | 2.4-3.2x                | 65                    | 43                            | 13                     | 38                      |
| Memo: CEC statewide total including VEA  | 23,277 | 44.7                   | 53.1           | 23.3x              | 21.9-29.1x              | 579                   | 388                           | 120                    | 344                     |

Denominators: CAISO record peak 52,061 MW (Sept. 6, 2022) and hourly EIA-930 peak 51,104 MW; 2025 hourly peak 43,860 MW; existing data center peak  $\approx$ 1,000 MW (CEC); existing average load 800–1,065 MW (chapter 1 range); IEPR planning-scenario CAISO managed net peak 46,479 MW (2025) to 50,498 MW (2030), growth 4,019 MW; IEPR statewide energy 263 to 298 TWh (growth 35 TWh); IEPR data center deliveries 12.1 TWh and data center contribution at the CAISO peak 1,743 MW in 2030 (planning scenario; 4,377 MW in the local-reliability scenario). Energy equivalent = MW  $\times$  0.67 utilization  $\times$  0.88 load factor  $\times$  8760 h.

Table 3.10 answers RQ1. The denominators come from the sources of the preceding chapters: the CAISO record and 2025 peaks, the CEC’s existing-load figure and the chapter 1 range, and the adopted 2025 IEPR planning forecast, whose hourly CAISO forecast gives a managed net peak of 46,479 MW in 2025 and 50,498 MW in 2030, a growth of 4,019 MW, and whose statewide energy to serve load grows from 263 to 298 TWh [California Energy Commission, 2026e]. Signed agreements alone, 5,086 MW, exceed the forecast’s entire five-year peak growth (127 percent of it); the three California tiers together are 5.1 times that growth (5.8 times including the Nevada requests), 3.4 times it even at the CEC’s 67 percent utilization factor, and their energy equivalent at that utilization and a 0.88 load factor, about 107 TWh a year, is 3.1 times the forecast’s statewide energy growth to 2030. Requests are not simultaneous demand: signed agreements are not operating capacity, and the forecast’s confidence and utilization factors exist to discount exactly this. The forecast is not blind to data centers: its planning scenario carries a data center contribution at the CAISO peak that rises from 96 MW in 2025 to 1,743 MW in 2030 (4,377 MW in the local-reliability scenario), and data-center-only deliveries of 12.1 TWh in 2030, roughly a third of projected statewide energy growth. What the forecast does is discount the requests, by the confidence levels and utilization of Chapter 2, to about a tenth of their face value at the peak by 2030. Whether that discount is right is the question the remaining chapters take up with the supply side, the attrition evidence and the adequacy framing.

### 3.6 Statistics of the projects in the workshop format

The Finnish slides reduce the registry to three numbers: what operates today, what is planned by stage, and how many electric cars the largest project would equal [Manner, 2026]. Figures 3.5 and 3.6 give the California counterparts from the sources of this chapter and Chapter 2; Table 3.11 lists every value with its source.

**Current capacity.** About 1,000 MW of data center peak demand operated in California in December 2025 by the CEC’s count, 800 to 1,065 MW of average load by the chapter 2 range, and 9.33 TWh of energy in 2023 by EPRI’s estimate. Of that energy the Silicon Valley Power cluster

of 58 data centers in Santa Clara used 2.46 TWh, 26 percent of the statewide estimate (25 to 29 percent across the 53 to 60 percent statements of SVP's share). Where Finland's 285 MW is half Google, California's existing load is a quarter Santa Clara.

**Statistics of the projects.** The December 2025 requests located in California are 5,086 MW with signed agreements, 6,987 MW in active applications and 8,604 MW of inquiries, 20,677 MW in all, which is 20.7 times the existing data center peak, 19 to 26 times the existing average load and 39.7 percent of CAISO's record instantaneous peak of 52,061 MW; VEA's 2,600 MW in Nevada stay outside (Section 3.5). The largest single request in SCE's public database is an active application of 1,000 MW in Mojave with requested energization in 2026, on its own equal to everything that operates in the state today; the next largest are an inquiry of 400 MW in Huntington Beach and an application of 313 MW in Whittier. The Finnish ratio was 7,777 to 285 MW, or 27 times, against a national consumption of about 10,000 MW; California's is 20,677 to about 1,000 MW, or 21 times, against a record peak of 52,061 MW.

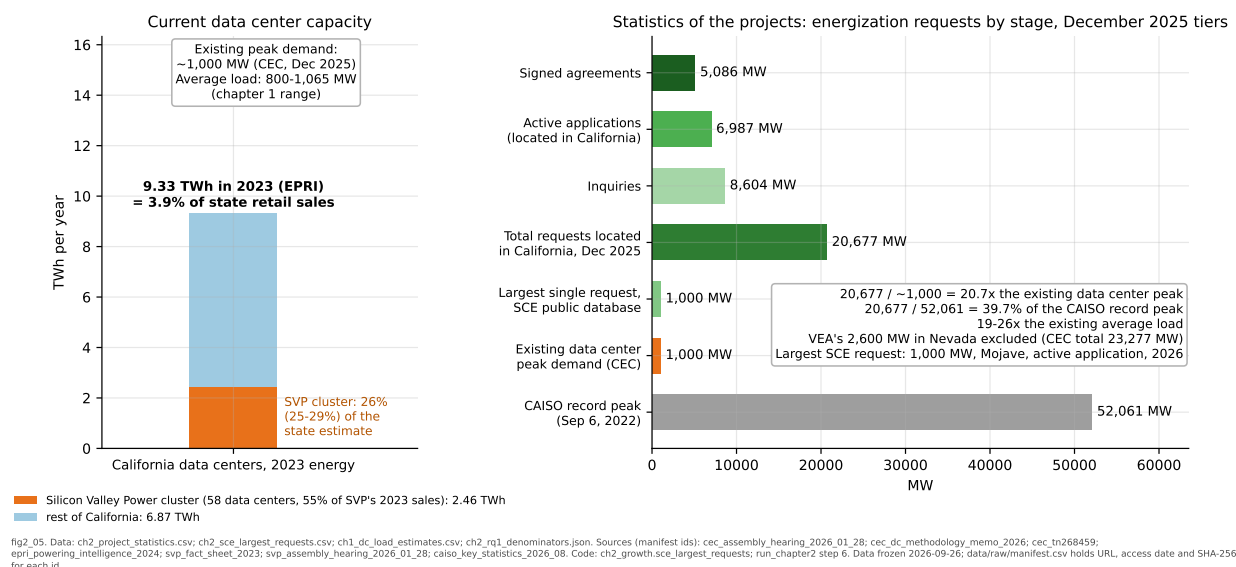


Figure 3.5: Left: existing data center electricity use in California in 2023 with the Silicon Valley Power cluster's share, and the CEC's existing peak demand. Right: the December 2025 requests by stage against the existing peak and the CAISO record peak, with the largest single request in SCE's public database.

*Source line:* fig2\_05. Data: ch2\_project\_statistics.csv; ch2\_sce\_largest\_requests.csv; ch1\_dc\_load\_estimates.csv; ch2\_rq1\_denominators.json. Sources (manifest ids): cec\_assembly\_hearing\_2026\_01\_28; cec\_dc\_methodology\_memo\_2026; cec\_tn268459; epri\_powering\_intelligence\_2024; svp\_fact\_sheet\_2023; svp\_assembly\_hearing\_2026\_01\_28; caiso\_key\_statistics\_2026\_08. Code: ch2\_growth.sce\_largest\_requests; run\_chapter2 step 6. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Table 3.11: Values behind Figure 3.5 with their sources.

| Item                                                                                         | Value  | Unit | Source                                                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Existing data center peak demand, CEC (Dec 2025)                                             | 1,000  | MW   | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 pp. 2, 18                                                         |
| Existing data center average load, chapter 1 range (low)                                     | 800    | MW   | ch1_dc_load_estimates.csv (A and B)                                                            |
| Existing data center average load, chapter 1 range (high)                                    | 1,065  | MW   | ch1_dc_load_estimates.csv (A and B)                                                            |
| Statewide data center electricity use 2023, EPRI Silicon Valley Power cluster 2023 (central) | 9.33   | TWh  | epri_powering_intelligence_2024                                                                |
|                                                                                              | 2.46   | TWh  | svp_fact_sheet_2023; svp_assembly_hearing_2026_01_28                                           |
| SVP cluster share of the statewide 2023 estimate (central)                                   | 26.4   | %    | ratio of the two rows above                                                                    |
| SVP cluster share of the statewide 2023 estimate (low)                                       | 25.4   | %    | ratio                                                                                          |
| SVP cluster share of the statewide 2023 estimate (high)                                      | 28.8   | %    | ratio                                                                                          |
| Signed agreements, Dec 2025                                                                  | 5,086  | MW   | cec_assembly_hearing_2026_01_28 p. 7                                                           |
| Active applications located in California, Dec 2025                                          | 6,987  | MW   | cec_assembly_hearing_2026_01_28 p. 7 minus VEA 2,600 MW (cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 Table 1) |
| Inquiries, Dec 2025                                                                          | 8,604  | MW   | cec_assembly_hearing_2026_01_28 p. 7                                                           |
| Total requests located in California, Dec 2025                                               | 20,677 | MW   | sum                                                                                            |
| VEA applications located in Nevada (memo line)                                               | 2,600  | MW   | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 Table 1                                                           |
| CAISO record instantaneous peak (Sep 6 2022)                                                 | 52,061 | MW   | caiso_key_statistics_2026_08                                                                   |
| Total requests / existing data center peak                                                   | 20.7   | x    | ratio                                                                                          |
| Total requests / CAISO record peak                                                           | 39.7   | %    | ratio                                                                                          |
| Total requests / existing average load (low)                                                 | 19.4   | x    | ratio                                                                                          |
| Total requests / existing average load (high)                                                | 25.8   | x    | ratio                                                                                          |
| Largest single request in the SCE public database (Jan 2026)                                 | 1,000  | MW   | cec_tn268459: active application, Active Application, Mojave, requested energization 2026      |

**Data centers against electric cars.** Manner converted Finland’s largest planned project, 560 MW, into 4.9 TWh a year at a flat load and 1.6 million electric cars at 3 MWh per car per year, 20 kWh per 100 km over 15,000 km [Manner, 2026]. No California per-vehicle figure is in the record, so Table 3.12 and Figure 3.6 keep his 3 MWh as a stated assumption. The 1,000 MW Mojave request is 8.8 TWh a year at a flat load, or 2.9 million cars; the signed agreements are 44.6 TWh or 14.9 million cars; all 20,677 MW are 181.1 TWh or 60.4 million cars, nineteen times the 9.3 TWh that every existing California data center used in 2023. At the CEC’s utilization factor of 0.67 and the load factor of 0.88 used in Chapter 5 the same three are 5.2, 26.3 and 106.8 TWh, or 1.7, 8.8 and 35.6 million cars.

Table 3.12: Annual energy of the requests at a flat load and at the CEC’s utilization, in TWh and in electric-car years.

| Requests                                                | MW     | Flat load |              | CEC case (0.67 x 0.88) |              |
|---------------------------------------------------------|--------|-----------|--------------|------------------------|--------------|
|                                                         |        | TWh/y     | million cars | TWh/y                  | million cars |
| Largest single SCE request (Mojave, active application) | 1,000  | 8.8       | 2.9          | 5.2                    | 1.7          |
| Signed agreements, California                           | 5,086  | 44.6      | 14.9         | 26.3                   | 8.8          |
| All December 2025 tiers, California                     | 20,677 | 181.1     | 60.4         | 106.8                  | 35.6         |

flat: MW x 8,760 h; CEC case: MW x 0.67 utilization x 0.88 load factor x 8,760 h; 3 MWh per electric car per year (Manner 2026: 20 kWh/100 km, 15,000 km/y; assumption).

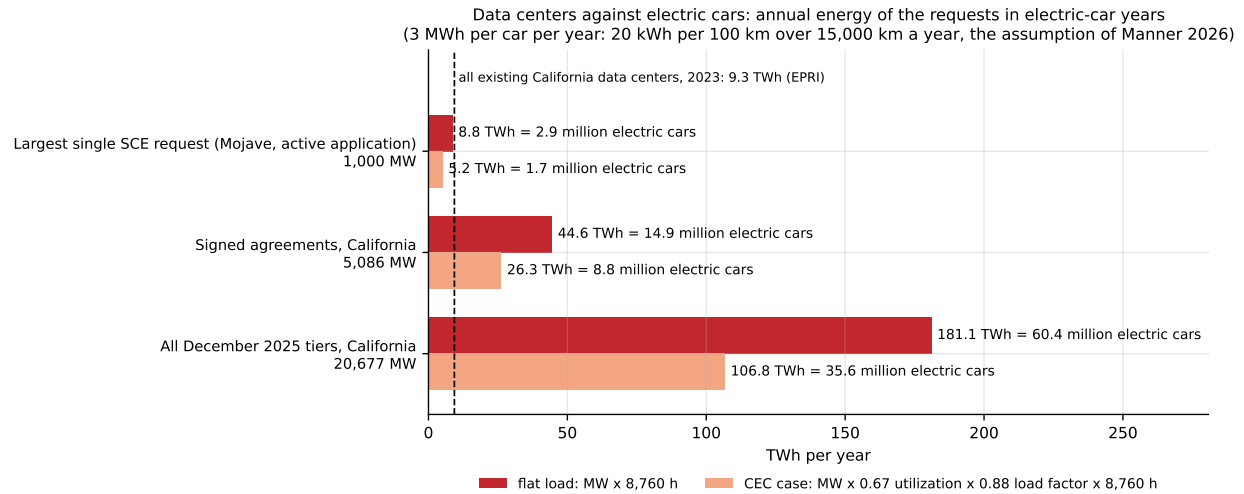


fig2\_06. Data: ch2\_ev\_equivalents.csv; ch2\_sce\_largest\_requests.csv; ch1\_dc\_load\_estimates.csv. Sources (manifest ids): cec\_assembly\_hearing\_2026\_01\_28; cec\_dc\_methodology\_memo\_2026; cec\_tn268459; epri\_powering\_intelligence\_2024. Code: run\_chapter2 step 6 (3 MWh per car-year assumption from Manner 2026). Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 3.6: Annual energy of the largest SCE request, the signed agreements and all December 2025 tiers at a flat load and at the CEC's utilization, expressed in electric-car years at 3 MWh per car; the dashed line is the 2023 use of every existing California data center.

*Source line:* fig2\_06. Data: ch2\_ev\_equivalents.csv; ch2\_sce\_largest\_requests.csv; ch1\_dc\_load\_estimates.csv. Sources (manifest ids): cec\_assembly\_hearing\_2026\_01\_28; cec\_dc\_methodology\_memo\_2026; cec\_tn268459; epri\_powering\_intelligence\_2024. Code: run\_chapter2 step 6 (3 MWh per car-year assumption from Manner 2026). Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

## Chapter 4

# Energy Production Growth in California

This chapter builds the supply side of RQ2, which the proposal left thin. It records what California’s generating fleet produced and imported from 2010 to 2025, what capacity it holds and is scheduled to lose, and, from the state’s own planning record, how much of what is planned actually gets built and how late. The last section applies that empirical attrition to the current planned list to give probability-weighted supply for 2030 in three cases, symmetric with the confidence weighting the CEC applies to data center requests. Code is in `src/ch3_supply.py` and `notebooks/03_supply_growth.ipynb`; the pipeline parses sixteen EIA-923 and sixteen EIA-860 annual files and eighteen EIA-860M monthly files directly from the raw archives.

### 4.1 Generation by resource and imports, 2010–2025

In-state generation comes from the EIA-923 plant-level schedule, with each California plant’s reported fuel and prime mover classified into twelve resource classes [U.S. Energy Information Administration, 2026c]. The EIA-923 totals match the CEC’s in-state totals to within one percent in every year for which both exist. Net imports come from the CEC’s total-system series, which is statewide and includes the utilities outside CAISO [California Energy Commission, 2026a]; the CEC has not yet published 2025 imports, and its 2021 page repeats the 2020 table, so the multi-year table is used for the import series and the CAISO-only net interchange from Chapter 2 is shown as a footprint-limited proxy for 2019 to 2025.

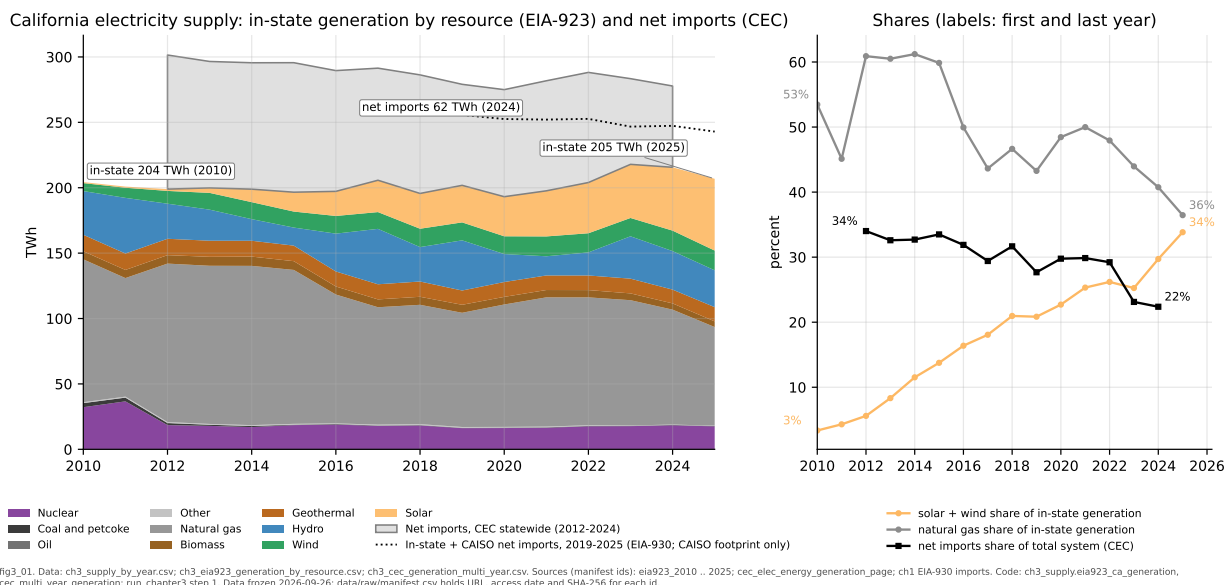


Figure 4.1: California electricity supply, 2010–2025: in-state generation by resource (EIA-923) stacked with CEC statewide net imports (2012–2024), the CAISO-only net imports of Chapter 2 as a proxy, and the shares of solar plus wind, natural gas and imports.

Source line: fig3\_01. Data: ch3\_supply\_by\_year.csv; ch3\_eia923\_generation\_by\_resource.csv; ch3\_cec\_generation\_multi\_year.csv. Sources (manifest ids): eia923\_2010 .. 2025; cec\_elec\_energy\_generation\_page; ch1 EIA-930 imports. Code: ch3\_supply\_eia923\_ca\_generation, cec\_multi\_year\_generation; run\_chapter3 step 1. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Table 4.1: In-state generation by resource and net imports, selected years (TWh). Batteries and pumped storage are net of charging. Source: EIA-923, CEC Energy Almanac, EIA-930.

| Resource (TWh)                    | 2010  | 2015  | 2020  | 2023  | 2024  | 2025  |
|-----------------------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| Natural gas                       | 109.2 | 117.7 | 93.6  | 95.8  | 87.9  | 75.4  |
| Nuclear                           | 32.2  | 18.5  | 16.3  | 17.7  | 18.4  | 17.6  |
| Hydro                             | 33.4  | 13.8  | 21.4  | 32.4  | 29.5  | 28.1  |
| Geothermal                        | 12.6  | 11.9  | 11.4  | 11.3  | 10.5  | 10.9  |
| Biomass                           | 6.2   | 6.7   | 5.8   | 5.2   | 4.8   | 4.3   |
| Wind                              | 6.1   | 12.2  | 13.6  | 14.0  | 15.6  | 15.1  |
| Solar                             | 0.8   | 14.8  | 30.3  | 41.0  | 48.4  | 54.9  |
| Coal and petcoke                  | 3.1   | 0.3   | 0.3   | 0.2   | 0.2   | 0.2   |
| Oil                               | 0.1   | 0.1   | 0.0   | 0.0   | 0.0   | 0.0   |
| Other                             | 0.7   | 0.6   | 0.6   | 0.3   | 0.2   | 0.3   |
| Batteries                         | 0.0   | -0.0  | -0.0  | -0.9  | -1.4  | -1.9  |
| Pumped storage                    | -0.2  | 0.1   | -0.0  | -0.4  | -0.0  | 0.2   |
| Total in-state                    | 204.1 | 196.7 | 193.1 | 216.6 | 214.2 | 205.1 |
| Net imports, CEC statewide        | –     | 99.0  | 81.9  | 65.5  | 62.2  | –     |
| Net imports, CAISO only (EIA-930) | –     | –     | 59.4  | 28.8  | 31.7  | 36.1  |

In-state generation was 204 TWh in 2010 and 205 TWh in 2025, but its composition inverted (Figure 4.1, Table 4.1). Natural gas fell from 109 to 75 TWh, from 53 to 36 percent of in-state generation, and solar rose from under 1 to 55 TWh, so solar and wind together went from 3 to 34 percent. Nuclear halved with the closure of San Onofre, and hydro swung between 14 TWh in the

2015 drought and 42 TWh in 2017. Statewide net imports fell from 103 TWh in 2012, a third of the total system, to 62 TWh in 2024, 22 percent. The total system therefore shrank from 302 to 278 TWh between 2012 and 2024 while in-state generation grew, which is the same flat-demand picture that Chapter 2 found at the CAISO level, now with the import share falling.

## 4.2 Capacity, storage and curtailment

Operable nameplate capacity by technology comes from the EIA-860 annual generator files, classified the same way [U.S. Energy Information Administration, 2026a]; battery energy capacity comes from the EIA-860 energy storage file, which begins in 2016; curtailment is CAISO’s monthly wind and solar curtailment series [California Independent System Operator, 2026a].

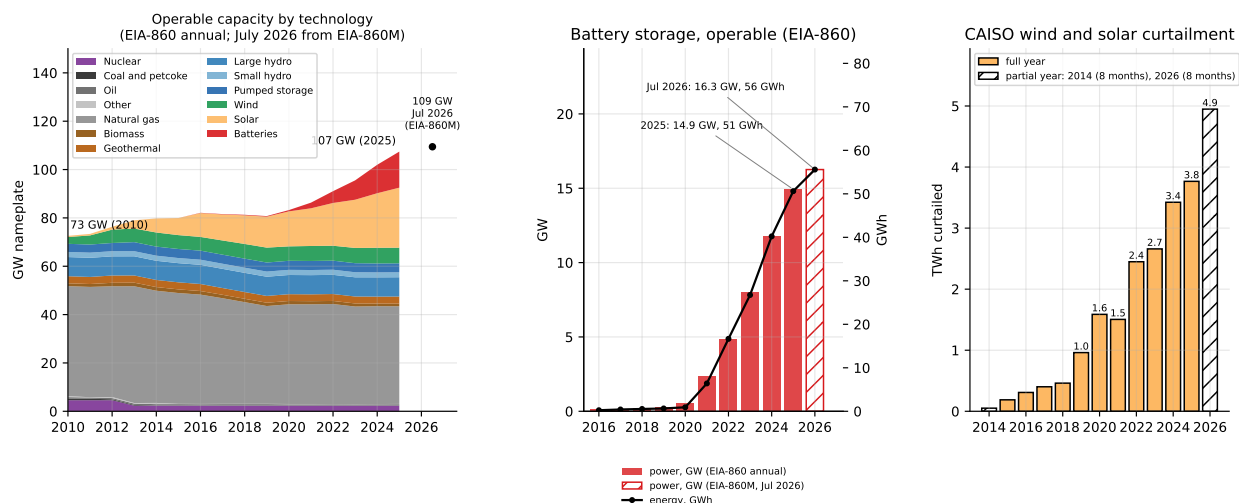


fig3\_02. Data: ch3\_eia860\_capacity\_by\_resource.csv; ch3\_battery\_capacity.csv; ch3\_caiso\_curtailment\_annual.csv; ch3\_capacity\_snapshot\_2026\_07.json. Sources (manifest ids): eia860\_2010 .. 2025; eia860m\_2026\_07; caiso\_curtailments\_monthly\_csv. Code: ch3\_supply.eia860\_ca\_capacity, eia860\_ca\_battery\_energy, caiso\_curtailment\_annual, eia860m\_capacity\_snapshot; run\_chapter3 step 1. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 4.2: Operable capacity by technology in California (EIA-860, left), battery power and energy capacity (EIA-860 energy storage file, middle) and CAISO wind and solar curtailment by year (right; 2026 covers January to August).

Source line: fig3\_02. Data: ch3\_eia860\_capacity\_by\_resource.csv; ch3\_battery\_capacity.csv; ch3\_caiso\_curtailment\_annual.csv; ch3\_capacity\_snapshot\_2026\_07.json. Sources (manifest ids): eia860\_2010 .. 2025; eia860m\_2026\_07; caiso\_curtailments\_monthly\_csv. Code: ch3\_supply.eia860\_ca\_capacity, eia860\_ca\_battery\_energy, caiso\_curtailment\_annual, eia860m\_capacity\_snapshot; run\_chapter3 step 1. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Table 4.2: Operable nameplate capacity by technology, battery energy capacity and CAISO curtailment, selected years and the July 2026 inventory. Source: EIA-860, EIA-860M, CAISO.

| Technology (GW nameplate)              | 2010 | 2015 | 2020 | 2023 | 2024  | 2025  | Jul 2026       |
|----------------------------------------|------|------|------|------|-------|-------|----------------|
| Natural gas                            | 45.5 | 45.8 | 41.2 | 40.4 | 40.5  | 40.4  | 40.4           |
| Nuclear                                | 4.6  | 2.3  | 2.3  | 2.3  | 2.3   | 2.3   | 2.3            |
| Large hydro                            | 7.9  | 7.9  | 7.9  | 7.9  | 8.0   | 8.0   | 8.0            |
| Small hydro                            | 2.1  | 2.1  | 2.1  | 2.1  | 2.0   | 2.0   | 2.0            |
| Pumped storage                         | 3.4  | 3.8  | 3.7  | 3.7  | 3.7   | 3.7   | 3.7            |
| Geothermal                             | 2.9  | 2.9  | 2.8  | 2.9  | 2.9   | 2.9   | 2.9            |
| Biomass                                | 1.2  | 1.5  | 1.4  | 1.3  | 1.1   | 1.1   | 1.1            |
| Wind                                   | 2.8  | 5.7  | 6.0  | 6.3  | 6.5   | 6.5   | 6.5            |
| Solar                                  | 0.5  | 7.1  | 14.5 | 19.9 | 22.6  | 24.8  | 25.5           |
| Batteries                              | –    | 0.0  | 0.5  | 8.0  | 11.8  | 14.9  | 16.3           |
| Coal and petcoke                       | 0.6  | 0.1  | 0.1  | 0.1  | 0.1   | 0.1   | 0.1            |
| Oil                                    | 0.7  | 0.5  | 0.5  | 0.5  | 0.5   | 0.6   | 0.6            |
| Other                                  | 0.4  | 0.1  | 0.1  | 0.1  | 0.1   | 0.1   | 0.1            |
| Total                                  | 72.6 | 79.9 | 83.2 | 95.5 | 102.0 | 107.4 | 109.4          |
| Battery energy capacity (GWh)          | –    | –    | 0.9  | 26.7 | 40.2  | 50.6  | 55.6           |
| CAISO wind and solar curtailment (TWh) | –    | 0.19 | 1.59 | 2.66 | 3.42  | 3.77  | 4.95 (Jan–Aug) |

The 2010–2025 columns are the EIA-860 annual files; the July 2026 column is the EIA-860M monthly inventory, which is preliminary.

Capacity rose from 73 GW in 2010 to 107 GW in 2025 (Figure 4.2, Table 4.2). Solar added 24 GW and batteries 15 GW, the latter almost entirely since 2020 and holding 51 GWh of energy across 281 units by 2025; gas capacity fell only from 45 to 40 GW and remains the largest block. The battery fleet is what moved the net peak later in the evening in Chapter 2. Curtailment of wind and solar rose from 0.2 TWh in 2015 to 3.8 TWh in 2025, and reached 4.9 TWh in the first eight months of 2026 alone, so the midday surplus that Chapter 2 measured in prices is now also visible as discarded energy of the order of the output of a gigawatt of solar.

**The most recent data.** The CEC has not yet published 2025 statewide imports and the EIA-860 annual file ends in 2025, so the latest observations come from three other files, each preliminary (Table 4.3). The EIA-923 monthly file through June 2026, which includes EIA’s state-level increment rows for the plants that report only annually, puts January to June in-state generation at 89.6 TWh against 97.4 TWh in the same months of 2025, with natural gas down 28 percent, hydro down 9 percent and solar up 6 percent; CAISO net imports over the same months rose from 15.7 to 20.6 TWh. The EIA-860M inventory of July 2026 puts operable capacity at 109 GW, with 16.3 GW and 56 GWh of batteries in 305 units, and CAISO curtailment through August 2026 had already exceeded the whole of 2025. The EIA-860M file for August 2026 had not been published when this chapter was built.

Table 4.3: January to June generation by resource, 2025 final against 2026 preliminary, and CAISO net imports over the same months. Source: EIA-923 annual 2025 and monthly June 2026 files, EIA-930.

| January–June (TWh)                           | 2025 (final) | 2026 (preliminary) | Change (%) |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------------|------------|
| Natural gas                                  | 30.6         | 22.1               | -28        |
| Nuclear                                      | 8.7          | 9.5                | +9         |
| Hydro                                        | 15.1         | 13.7               | -9         |
| Geothermal                                   | 5.4          | 5.2                | -3         |
| Biomass                                      | 2.1          | 2.1                | +2         |
| Wind                                         | 8.6          | 8.8                | +2         |
| Solar                                        | 27.5         | 29.1               | +6         |
| Coal and petcoke                             | 0.1          | 0.0                | -88        |
| Oil                                          | 0.0          | 0.0                | –          |
| Other                                        | 0.1          | 0.1                | +34        |
| Batteries                                    | -0.9         | -1.1               | +15        |
| Pumped storage                               | -0.0         | -0.2               | –          |
| Total in-state                               | 97.4         | 89.6               | -8         |
| of which EIA state-level increment rows      | 0.2          | 24.8               | –          |
| CAISO net imports, EIA-930 (CAISO footprint) | 15.7         | 20.6               | +31        |

### 4.3 Retirement schedule

Planned retirements come from the EIA-860M operating list of July 2026, which carries a planned retirement date for each unit that has reported one [U.S. Energy Information Administration, 2026b], overlaid with the compliance schedule of the State Water Board’s once-through-cooling policy as amended in August 2023 [State Water Resources Control Board, 2023]. The two agree where both exist: Alamitos units 3 to 5 and Huntington Beach unit 2 report December 2026 and the policy requires compliance by December 31, 2026; Ormond Beach reports January 2027 against the same policy date; Scattergood units 1 and 2 report 2029 against December 31, 2029. Three cases carry no EIA date: LADWP’s Haynes units 1, 2 and 8 and Harbor unit 5, which the policy requires to comply by December 31, 2029, and Diablo Canyon, whose compliance date SB 846 extended to October 31, 2030 and whose continued operation beyond that depends on federal licence renewal and further state action. The policy dates are used for those units in case C below, and Diablo Canyon is carried as a scenario.

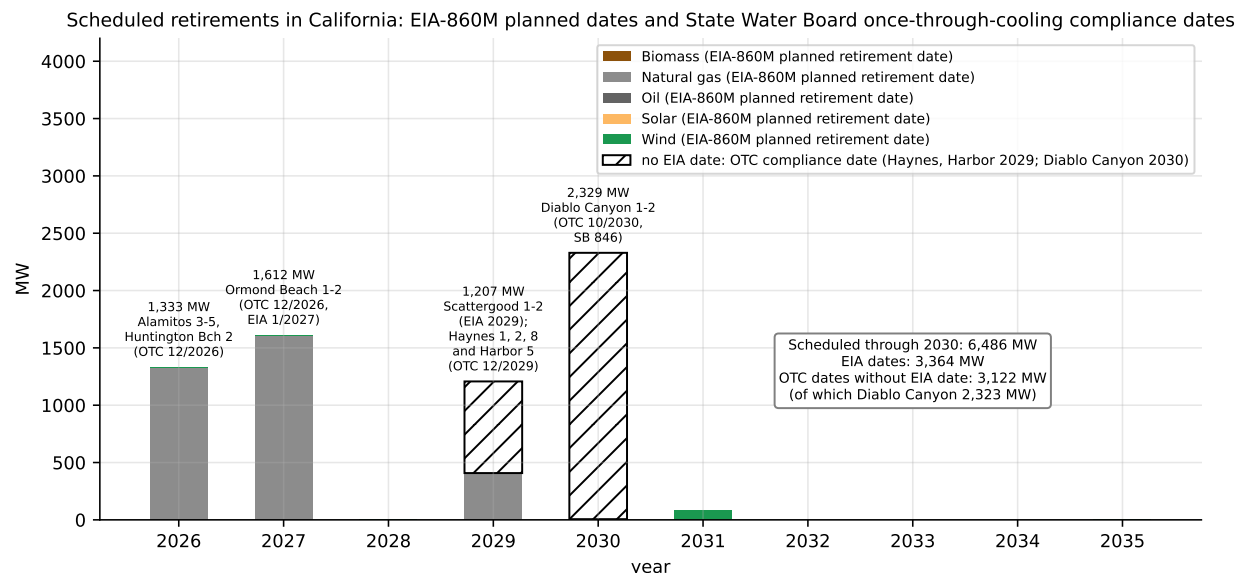


fig3\_03. Data: ch3\_eia860m\_planned\_retirements.csv; ch3\_otc\_units.csv. Sources (manifest ids): eia860m\_2026\_07; swrcb\_otc\_policy\_2023. Code: ch3\_supply.retirement\_schedule; run\_chapter3 step 2. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 4.3: Scheduled retirements in California by year: EIA-860M planned retirement dates by technology, with the once-through-cooling compliance dates hatched for the units that report no EIA date.

Source line: fig3\_03. Data: ch3\_eia860m\_planned\_retirements.csv; ch3\_otc\_units.csv. Sources (manifest ids): eia860m\_2026\_07; swrcb\_otc\_policy\_2023. Code: ch3\_supply.retirement\_schedule; run\_chapter3 step 2. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Table 4.4: Once-through-cooling units and other scheduled retirements through 2030. Source: EIA-860M July 2026, State Water Board OTC Policy Table 1.

| Plant                                     | Units   | Technology                       | MW    | In service | OTC compliance date | EIA-860M planned retirement |
|-------------------------------------------|---------|----------------------------------|-------|------------|---------------------|-----------------------------|
| AES Alamitos LLC                          | 3, 4, 5 | Natural Gas Steam Turbine        | 1,115 | 1961–1964  | 2026-12-31          | 2026                        |
| AES Huntington Beach LLC                  | 2       | Natural Gas Steam Turbine        | 218   | 1958–1958  | 2026-12-31          | 2026                        |
| Ormond Beach                              | 1, 2    | Natural Gas Steam Turbine        | 1,612 | 1971–1973  | 2026-12-31          | 2027                        |
| Haynes                                    | 1, 2, 8 | Natural Gas Steam Turbine        | 724   | 1962–2005  | 2029-12-31          | none                        |
| Harbor                                    | 5       | Natural Gas Fired Combined Cycle | 75    | 1995–1995  | 2029-12-31          | none                        |
| Scattergood                               | 1, 2    | Natural Gas Steam Turbine        | 326   | 1958–1959  | 2029-12-31          | 2029                        |
| Diablo Canyon                             | 1, 2    | Nuclear                          | 2,323 | 1985–1986  | 2030-10-31          | none                        |
| Other units with an EIA date through 2030 | 5 units | mixed                            | 92    | –          | –                   | 2028–2030                   |

Scheduled retirements through 2030 total 6.5 GW: 3.4 GW with EIA dates, almost all of it the coastal gas steam units of 2026, 2027 and 2029, plus 0.8 GW of LADWP units at their policy dates and the 2.3 GW of Diablo Canyon. Beyond 2030 the EIA record holds almost nothing, which reflects how retirement dates are reported rather than the age of the fleet.

## 4.4 A supply-side realization model

The CEC discounts data center requests by a confidence level for each tier. The supply side deserves the same treatment, and the EIA-860M monthly files make it possible to estimate one from California’s own record. For every California unit in the Planned sheet of the January file of each year from 2016 to 2022, the outcome by the December 2025 file is recorded: operating (or operated and since retired), cancelled (the file’s cumulative Canceled or Postponed sheet), still planned, or dropped from the survey without a cancellation record, which is treated as cancelled. Units that appear in more than one January list contribute one observation per vintage, and standard errors are clustered by unit. The sample is 925 unit-vintages of 513 distinct units and 64 GW of planned capacity.

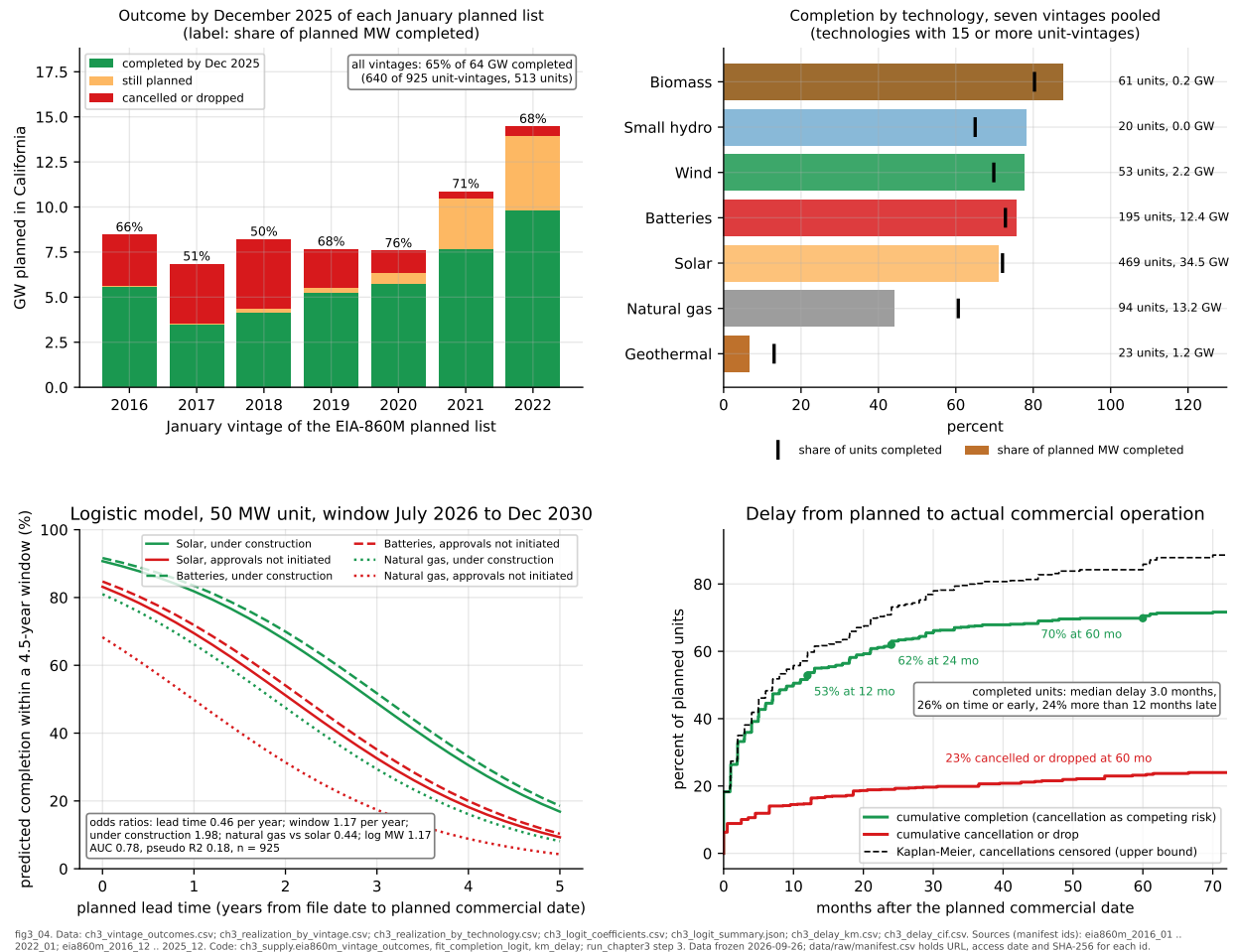


Figure 4.4: The realization model. Top left: outcome by December 2025 of each January planned list, capacity-weighted. Top right: completion by technology, seven vintages pooled. Bottom left: predicted completion within a 4.5-year window from the logistic model for a 50 MW unit. Bottom right: time from the planned to the actual commercial date, as Kaplan-Meier with cancellations censored and as cumulative incidence with cancellation as a competing risk.

Source line: fig3\_04. Data: ch3\_vintage\_outcomes.csv; ch3\_realization\_by\_vintage.csv; ch3\_realization\_by\_technology.csv; ch3\_logit\_coefficients.csv; ch3\_logit\_summary.json; ch3\_delay\_km.csv; ch3\_delay\_cif.csv. Sources (manifest ids): eia860m\_2016\_01 .. 2022\_01; eia860m\_2016\_12 .. 2025\_12. Code: ch3\_supply.eia860m\_vintage\_outcomes, fit\_completion\_logit, km\_delay; run\_chapter3 step 3. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Table 4.5: Outcome by December 2025 of the California planned lists of January 2016 to 2022, by vintage and by construction status at the vintage.

| Vintage or status at the vintage | Unit-vintages | Planned MW | Completed (% units) | Completed (% MW) | Cancelled MW | Still planned MW | Median delay (months) |
|----------------------------------|---------------|------------|---------------------|------------------|--------------|------------------|-----------------------|
| January 2016                     | 145           | 8,454      | 77                  | 66               | 2,842        | 20               | 2                     |
| January 2017                     | 110           | 6,837      | 66                  | 51               | 3,292        | 70               | 1                     |
| January 2018                     | 110           | 8,209      | 61                  | 50               | 3,801        | 270              | 2                     |
| January 2019                     | 115           | 7,660      | 61                  | 68               | 2,145        | 270              | 3                     |
| January 2020                     | 127           | 7,569      | 72                  | 76               | 1,245        | 556              | 6                     |
| January 2021                     | 150           | 10,860     | 74                  | 71               | 372          | 2,828            | 4                     |
| January 2022                     | 168           | 14,466     | 69                  | 68               | 519          | 4,146            | 4                     |
| Status: under construction       | 329           | 20,536     | 85                  | 77               | 4,784        | 5                | 2                     |
| Status: approvals not initiated  | 202           | 16,685     | 55                  | 54               | 2,312        | 5,407            | 15                    |
| Status: approvals pending        | 172           | 14,869     | 63                  | 59               | 5,214        | 927              | 7                     |
| Status: approved, not started    | 150           | 10,582     | 53                  | 66               | 1,798        | 1,817            | 5                     |
| Status: construction complete    | 72            | 1,383      | 81                  | 92               | 108          | 3                | 0                     |

Table 4.6: Outcome by technology, seven vintages pooled (technologies with at least ten unit-vintages).

| Technology  | Unit-vintages | Planned MW | Completed (% units) | Completed (% MW) | Cancelled MW | Still planned MW | Median delay (months) |
|-------------|---------------|------------|---------------------|------------------|--------------|------------------|-----------------------|
| Solar       | 469           | 34,524     | 72                  | 71               | 5,130        | 4,878            | 3                     |
| Natural gas | 94            | 13,164     | 61                  | 44               | 7,379        | 0                | 1                     |
| Batteries   | 195           | 12,434     | 73                  | 76               | 343          | 2,678            | 4                     |
| Wind        | 53            | 2,204      | 70                  | 78               | 195          | 298              | 5                     |
| Geothermal  | 23            | 1,158      | 13                  | 6                | 1,083        | 0                | 7                     |
| Biomass     | 61            | 164        | 80                  | 88               | 15           | 5                | 2                     |
| Small hydro | 20            | 45         | 65                  | 78               | 10           | 0                | 28                    |

Across the seven vintages, 69 percent of units and 65 percent of planned megawatts were operating by December 2025 (Table 4.5); by vintage the capacity-weighted completion rate ranges from 50 percent for January 2018 to 76 percent for January 2020, with the 2021 and 2022 lists still carrying 3 to 4 GW of unresolved projects. Technology matters less than one might expect among the resources that dominate the list: solar completed 71 percent of its planned megawatts, batteries 76 and wind 78 (Table 4.6). Natural gas completed 44 percent and geothermal 6 percent, the latter on 23 unit-vintages. Construction status at the vintage is the strongest single signal: units already under construction completed 77 percent of their megawatts, units whose approvals had not been initiated 54 percent.

Table 4.7: Logistic model of completion by December 2025 (unit-vintage observations; standard errors clustered by unit; reference categories solar and approvals not initiated).

| Term                                       | Coefficient                   | Cluster SE | Odds ratio | <i>p</i> |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------|------------|----------|
| Intercept (solar, approvals not initiated) | 0.290                         | 0.554      | 1.34       | 0.601    |
| Technology: Batteries                      | 0.116                         | 0.348      | 1.12       | 0.739    |
| Technology: Biomass                        | -0.172                        | 0.654      | 0.84       | 0.793    |
| Technology: Geothermal                     | -2.180                        | 1.122      | 0.11       | 0.052    |
| Technology: Natural gas                    | -0.830                        | 0.466      | 0.44       | 0.075    |
| Technology: Other                          | -2.489                        | 1.169      | 0.08       | 0.033    |
| Technology: Small hydro                    | -0.034                        | 0.961      | 0.97       | 0.972    |
| Technology: Wind                           | -0.094                        | 0.899      | 0.91       | 0.917    |
| Status: approvals pending                  | 0.087                         | 0.416      | 1.09       | 0.834    |
| Status: approved, not started              | -0.273                        | 0.344      | 0.76       | 0.429    |
| Status: construction complete              | 0.257                         | 0.491      | 1.29       | 0.601    |
| Status: under construction                 | 0.682                         | 0.355      | 1.98       | 0.055    |
| log nameplate MW                           | 0.154                         | 0.092      | 1.17       | 0.094    |
| Planned lead time (years)                  | -0.775                        | 0.189      | 0.46       | <0.001   |
| Observation window (years)                 | 0.158                         | 0.056      | 1.17       | 0.005    |
| Observations                               | 925 unit-vintages (513 units) |            |            |          |
| Pseudo $R^2$ / in-sample AUC               | 0.178 / 0.778                 |            |            |          |

Table 4.8: Three specifications of the completion model: the main model, the model without construction status, and the literal specification with planned year and vintage fixed effects.

| Specification                                    | <i>n</i> | Pseudo $R^2$ | AUC   | OR: lead time (A, B) or planned year (C), per year | OR: under construction | OR: gas vs solar | OR: log MW |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------|--------------|-------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------|------------------|------------|
| A. lead time + window + status (main)            | 925      | 0.178        | 0.778 | 0.46                                               | 1.98                   | 0.44             | 1.17       |
| B. lead time + window, no status                 | 925      | 0.166        | 0.774 | 0.40                                               | –                      | 0.56             | 1.18       |
| C. planned year + vintage fixed effects + status | 925      | 0.162        | 0.764 | 0.55                                               | 2.60                   | 0.45             | 1.11       |

Table 4.9: Delay from the planned to the actual commercial date, seven vintages pooled.

| Statistic                                                                                  | Value      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Completed unit-vintages                                                                    | 640        |
| Median delay, planned to actual commercial date                                            | 3.0 months |
| Mean delay                                                                                 | 7.4 months |
| On time or early                                                                           | 26%        |
| More than 12 months late                                                                   | 24%        |
| 90th percentile delay                                                                      | 24 months  |
| Cumulative completion by 12 months after the planned date (cancellation as competing risk) | 53%        |
| Cumulative completion by 24 months after the planned date (cancellation as competing risk) | 62%        |
| Cumulative completion by 36 months after the planned date (cancellation as competing risk) | 68%        |
| Cumulative completion by 60 months after the planned date (cancellation as competing risk) | 70%        |
| Cumulative cancellation or drop by 60 months                                               | 23%        |

The logistic model (Table 4.7) puts numbers on these patterns while holding the others fixed. Each additional year of planned lead time cuts the odds of completion within the window by more than half (odds ratio 0.46,  $p < 0.001$ ); each additional year of observation raises them by 17

percent ( $p = 0.005$ ), which is the mechanical effect of giving late projects time to finish; being under construction at the vintage doubles the odds ( $p = 0.055$ ); gas and geothermal have lower odds than solar at conventional or near-conventional significance, and size adds a little (odds ratio 1.17 per log-unit of megawatts,  $p = 0.09$ ). The in-sample AUC is 0.78. Lead time and observation window are a reparametrisation of the planned year and the vintage; the literal specification with planned year and vintage fixed effects (Table 4.8) gives the same ranking of technologies and construction status. The delay curves (Table 4.9) describe the projects that do finish and the ones that do not: among completed units the median delay from the planned to the actual commercial date is 3 months, a quarter are on time or early and a quarter are more than a year late. Treating cancellation as a competing risk, 53 percent of planned units are operating within 12 months of their planned date, 62 percent within 24 and 70 percent within 60, while 23 percent have been cancelled or dropped by then; the Kaplan-Meier curve with cancellations censored, an upper bound, reaches about 88 percent at six years.

## 4.5 Probability-weighted supply for 2030

The July 2026 EIA-860M planned list for California holds 229 units and 20.1 GW with planned commercial dates through 2030: 9.9 GW of batteries, 7.9 GW of solar, 1.6 GW in two pumped-storage projects whose approvals have not been initiated, 0.3 GW of wind and 0.2 GW of gas engines. Each unit is weighted by the model’s completion probability for a window ending December 2030, given its technology, size, lead time and construction status. The weighted list is 13.2 GW, two thirds of the nominal one: 71 percent of the battery and solar megawatts survive, 78 percent of wind, 31 percent of gas and 13 percent of the pumped storage. By status, 88 percent of the megawatts already under construction survive against 36 percent of those whose approvals have not been initiated.

Table 4.10: ELCC values and derates used for peak contribution, with realised 2023–2025 capacity factors used for energy. Source: CPUC/E3-Astrape 2023 MTR ELCC study, EIA-923 and EIA-860; assumptions as stated.

| Technology       | ELCC or derate | Capacity factor 2023–2025 | Basis                                                                                                                    |
|------------------|----------------|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Natural gas      | 0.950          | 0.244                     | assumption: firm resource net of forced-outage and ambient derate                                                        |
| Nuclear          | 0.950          | 0.879                     | assumption: firm resource net of forced-outage and ambient derate                                                        |
| Large hydro      | 0.550          | 0.342                     | assumption: summer-peak availability of hydro (CAISO NQC uses historical exceedance)                                     |
| Small hydro      | 0.450          | 0.342                     | assumption: summer-peak availability of hydro (CAISO NQC uses historical exceedance)                                     |
| Geothermal       | 0.950          | 0.430                     | assumption: firm resource net of forced-outage and ambient derate                                                        |
| Biomass          | 0.900          | 0.470                     | assumption: firm resource net of forced-outage and ambient derate                                                        |
| Wind             | 0.147          | 0.265                     | CPUC/E3-Astrape 2023 MTR ELCC study, Table 1, Tranche 6 (2028): 4-hour battery, 8-hour PSH, utility solar, in-state wind |
| Solar            | 0.088          | 0.244                     | CPUC/E3-Astrape 2023 MTR ELCC study, Table 1, Tranche 6 (2028): 4-hour battery, 8-hour PSH, utility solar, in-state wind |
| Batteries        | 0.765          | -0.014                    | CPUC/E3-Astrape 2023 MTR ELCC study, Table 1, Tranche 6 (2028): 4-hour battery, 8-hour PSH, utility solar, in-state wind |
| Pumped storage   | 0.887          | -0.002                    | CPUC/E3-Astrape 2023 MTR ELCC study, Table 1, Tranche 6 (2028): 4-hour battery, 8-hour PSH, utility solar, in-state wind |
| Coal and petcoke | 0.950          | 0.419                     | assumption: firm resource net of forced-outage and ambient derate                                                        |
| Oil              | 0.900          | 0.009                     | assumption: firm resource net of forced-outage and ambient derate                                                        |
| Other            | 0.800          | 0.298                     | assumption: firm resource net of forced-outage and ambient derate                                                        |

Energy is capacity times the realised 2023 to 2025 capacity factor of each class (batteries and pumped storage contribute no net energy, and for gas the fleet-average factor overstates the energy of the peaking units that retire). Peak contribution uses effective load carrying capability: the CPUC’s 2028 tranche values from the E3 and Astrape mid-term reliability study for solar (8.8 percent), in-state wind (14.7), four-hour batteries (76.5) and pumped storage (88.7) [Energy and Environmental Economics and Astrapé Consulting, 2023, California Public Utilities Commission, Energy Division, 2023], and stated derates for firm resources and hydro (Table 4.10). Three cases are reported (Figure 4.5, Table 4.11): everything on the list builds; the model-weighted list; and the model-weighted list minus the retirements of Section 4.3, with Diablo Canyon at its October 2030 policy date and a sensitivity in which it continues.

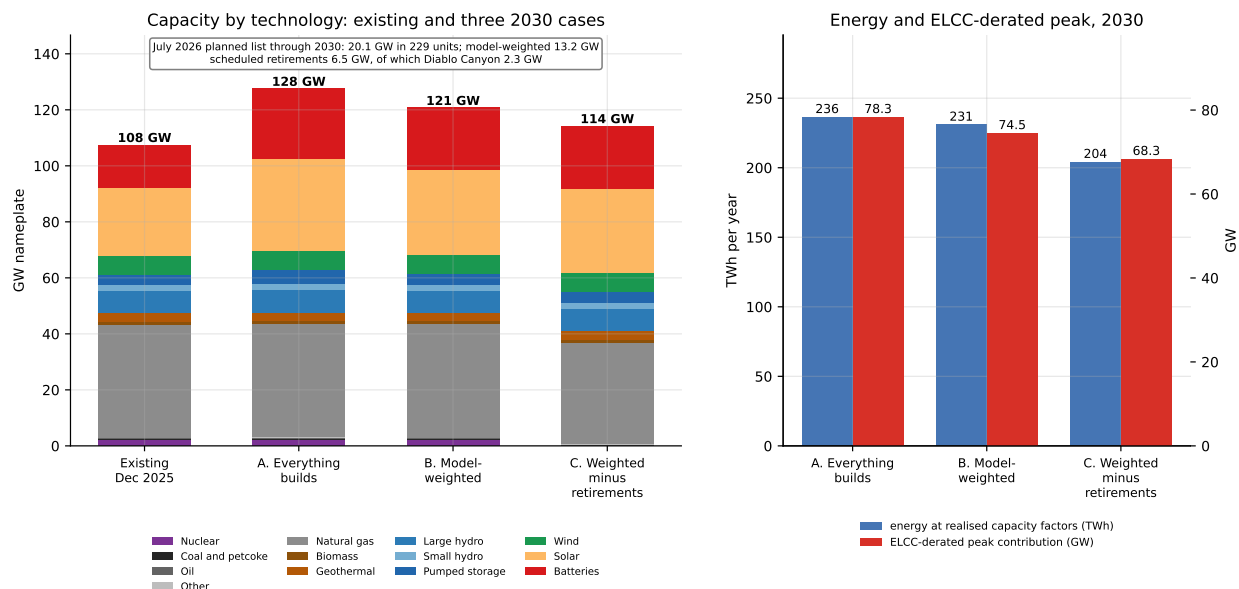


fig3\_05. Data: ch3\_cases\_2030.csv; ch3\_cases\_2030\_summary.json; ch3\_planned\_current\_weighted.csv; ch3\_existing\_capacity\_2025.csv; ch3\_capacity\_factors.csv; ch3\_elcc\_values.csv. Sources (manifest ids): eia860m\_2026\_07; eia860m\_2025\_12; cpuc\_e3\_astrape\_incremental\_elcc\_2023. Code: ch3\_supply.current\_planned, cases\_2030, capacity\_factors, elcc\_table; run\_chapter3 step 4. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 4.5: Capacity by technology for the existing fleet and the three 2030 cases (left), and energy at realised capacity factors and ELCC-derated peak contribution by case (right).

Source line: fig3\_05. Data: ch3\_cases\_2030.csv; ch3\_cases\_2030\_summary.json; ch3\_planned\_current\_weighted.csv; ch3\_existing\_capacity\_2025.csv; ch3\_capacity\_factors.csv; ch3\_elcc\_values.csv. Sources (manifest ids): eia860m\_2026\_07; eia860m\_2025\_12; cpuc\_e3\_astrape\_incremental\_elcc\_2023. Code: ch3\_supply.current\_planned, cases\_2030, capacity\_factors, elcc\_table; run\_chapter3 step 4. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Table 4.11: Planned supply for 2030 in three cases: capacity by technology (MW), energy at realised capacity factors and ELCC-derated peak contribution.

| Technology                                                     | Existing Dec 2025 | A. Everything builds | B. Model-weighted | C. Weighted minus retirements    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|----------------------|-------------------|----------------------------------|
| Natural gas                                                    | 40,414            | 40,585               | 40,467            | 36,308                           |
| Nuclear                                                        | 2,323             | 2,323                | 2,323             | 0                                |
| Large hydro                                                    | 7,979             | 7,979                | 7,979             | 7,979                            |
| Small hydro                                                    | 2,041             | 2,050                | 2,047             | 2,047                            |
| Pumped storage                                                 | 3,704             | 5,304                | 3,917             | 3,917                            |
| Geothermal                                                     | 2,868             | 2,868                | 2,868             | 2,868                            |
| Biomass                                                        | 1,107             | 1,136                | 1,127             | 1,124                            |
| Wind                                                           | 6,530             | 6,874                | 6,799             | 6,799                            |
| Solar                                                          | 24,625            | 32,556               | 30,274            | 30,274                           |
| Batteries                                                      | 15,216            | 25,137               | 22,225            | 22,225                           |
| Coal and petcoke                                               | 62                | 62                   | 62                | 62                               |
| Oil                                                            | 540               | 540                  | 540               | 538                              |
| Other                                                          | 103               | 153                  | 104               | 104                              |
| Total capacity (MW)                                            | 107,512           | 127,566              | 120,732           | 114,246                          |
| Energy at realised capacity factors (TWh)                      | —                 | 236                  | 231               | 204                              |
| ELCC-derated peak contribution (MW)                            | —                 | 78,297               | 74,467            | 68,306                           |
| Case C with Diablo Canyon continuing: capacity / energy / peak | —                 | —                    | —                 | 116,569 MW / 222 TWh / 70,512 MW |

If everything builds, California's nameplate capacity reaches 128 GW in 2030, 236 TWh a year at realised capacity factors and 78 GW of ELCC-derated peak contribution. The model-weighted case gives 121 GW, 231 TWh and 74 GW. Subtracting 6.5 GW of retirements leaves 114 GW, 204 TWh and 68 GW, or 117 GW, 222 TWh and 71 GW if Diablo Canyon continues. Net of retirements, the supply side therefore adds about 7 to 9 GW of nameplate and 0 to 3 GW of ELCC-derated peak contribution by 2030 relative to the December 2025 fleet, and its energy falls if Diablo Canyon closes, because almost everything being added is solar and batteries whose peak

value is a fraction of nameplate. Against that stand the 4 GW of managed net peak growth in the adopted forecast and the 20.7 GW of data center requests located in California from Chapter 3. Setting the two probability-weighted sides against each other is the subject of the next chapter.

## 4.6 The supply cases in the workshop format

The Finnish study closed its supply side with Fingrid’s stacked projection of production by technology: 83 TWh in 2025 rising to 108 or 122 TWh in 2030 and 120 or 169 TWh in 2035, almost entirely through wind [Manner, 2026]. Figure 4.6 and Table 4.12 give the California counterpart from this chapter: EIA-923 in-state generation in 2025 as filed, and the three 2030 cases of Table 4.11 at realised capacity factors, grouped into eight technologies. California produced 207.1 TWh in state in 2025, of which natural gas 75.4, solar 54.9, hydro 28.4, nuclear 17.6, wind 15.1, geothermal 10.9 and biomass 4.3 TWh; batteries returned  $-1.9$  TWh net, the charging losses, and are left out of the stack, as are the 36.1 TWh of net imports of Chapter 2, which are not production. If everything builds, in-state production reaches 236.3 TWh in 2030 with solar at 69.6 and gas at 86.7 TWh; the model-weighted case gives 230.8 TWh with solar at 64.7; subtracting the scheduled retirements leaves 204.1 TWh, below 2025, with nuclear at zero and gas at 77.6 TWh. Where Finland’s projection adds 25 to 40 TWh of production by 2030 to a base of 83, California’s cases add between  $-3$  and  $+29$  TWh to a base of 207; the growth in the Finnish chart is wind, in California’s it is solar.

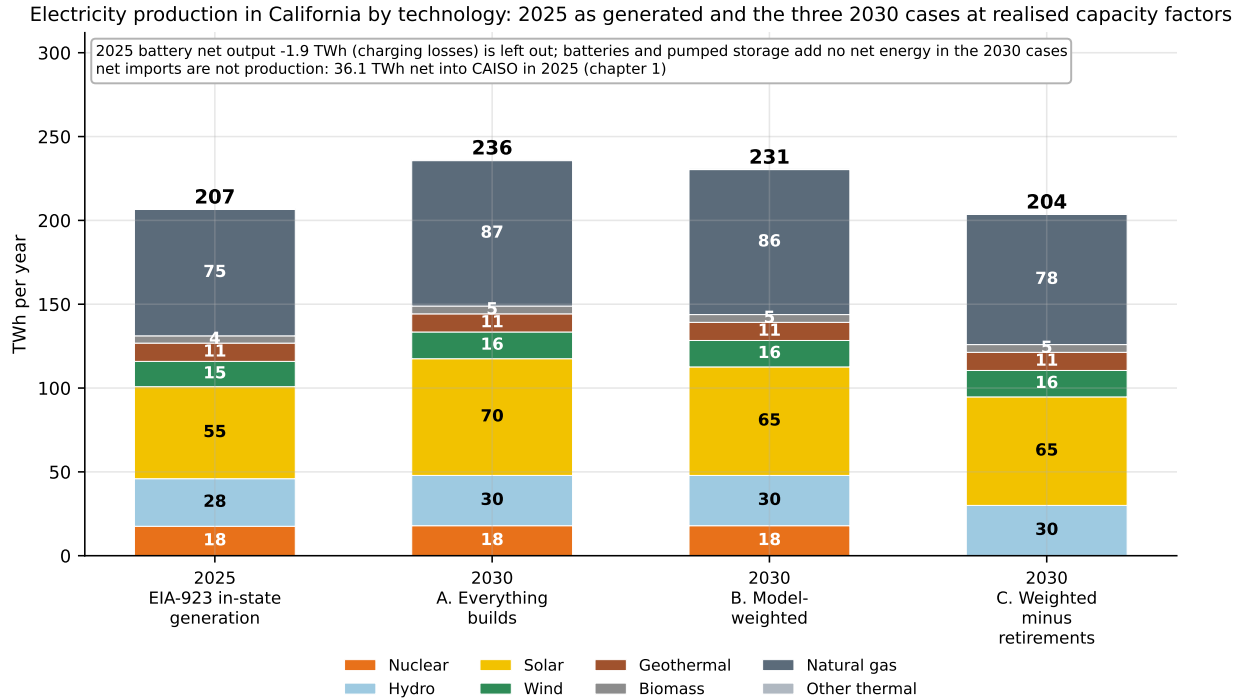


fig3\_06. Data: ch3\_production\_projection.csv; ch3\_eia923\_generation\_by\_resource.csv; ch3\_cases\_2030.csv; ch1\_ciso\_annual\_summary.csv. Sources (manifest ids): eia923\_2010 .. 2025; eia860m\_2026\_07; cpuc\_e3\_astrape\_incremental\_elcc\_2023; eia930\_balance\_2019\_jan\_jun .. 2025\_jul\_dec. Code: run\_chapter3 step 5 (groups the chapter 3 case table and the EIA-923 2025 generation). Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 4.6: Electricity production in California by technology: EIA-923 in-state generation in 2025 and the three 2030 cases at realised capacity factors. Batteries and pumped storage add no net energy; net imports are not production.

Source line: fig3\_06. Data: ch3\_production\_projection.csv; ch3\_eia923\_generation\_by\_resource.csv; ch3\_cases\_2030.csv; ch1\_ciso\_annual\_summary.csv. Sources (manifest ids): eia923\_2010 .. 2025; eia860m\_2026\_07; cpuc\_e3\_astrape\_incremental\_elcc\_2023; eia930\_balance\_2019\_jan\_jun .. 2025\_jul\_dec. Code: run\_chapter3 step 5 (groups the chapter 3 case table and the EIA-923 2025 generation). Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Table 4.12: Production by technology (TWh): 2025 as generated and the three 2030 cases. Hydro includes pumped storage's net output in 2025; other thermal is coal, petroleum coke, oil and other fuels.

| Technology (TWh) | 2025 (EIA-923) | 2030 A. Everything builds | 2030 B. Model-weighted | 2030 C. Model-weighted minus retirements |
|------------------|----------------|---------------------------|------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Nuclear          | 17.6           | 17.9                      | 17.9                   | 0.0                                      |
| Hydro            | 28.4           | 30.0                      | 30.0                   | 30.0                                     |
| Solar            | 54.9           | 69.6                      | 64.7                   | 64.7                                     |
| Wind             | 15.1           | 16.0                      | 15.8                   | 15.8                                     |
| Geothermal       | 10.9           | 10.8                      | 10.8                   | 10.8                                     |
| Biomass          | 4.3            | 4.7                       | 4.6                    | 4.6                                      |
| Natural gas      | 75.4           | 86.7                      | 86.5                   | 77.6                                     |
| Other thermal    | 0.5            | 0.7                       | 0.5                    | 0.5                                      |
| Total            | 207.1          | 236.3                     | 230.8                  | 204.1                                    |

## Chapter 5

# Putting It Together

This chapter answers RQ2, RQ4 and RQ3 with the pieces built so far. Section 5.1 turns the December 2025 tiers of Chapter 3 into 2030 demand under four counting rules, on top of the IEPR’s own low, mid and high forecast of everything that is not a data center. Section 5.2 draws 10,000 joint scenarios of that demand and of the probability-weighted supply of Chapter 4 and reports the distribution of the 2030 gap in energy and at the net peak, with the proposal’s upper bound carried in every table. Section 5.3 ranks the inputs by one-at-a-time swings and Sobol indices. Section 5.4 replicates the Duke Nicholas Institute’s curtailment-enabled headroom on CAISO hourly load and sets it against the gap (RQ4). Section 5.5 compares the six data and measurement regimes and restates California’s headline number under each of their counting rules (RQ3), and Section 5.6 adds the emissions of a flat against a curtailable load. Code is in `src/ch4_gap.py`, `src/ch4_regimes.py`, `scripts/run_chapter4.py` and `notebooks/04_gap_model.ipynb` and `05_regimes_flexibility.ipynb`; `make ch4` rebuilds everything in about a minute.

### 5.1 Demand scenarios for 2030

**The tiers and the non-data-center baseline.** The starting point is the CEC’s December 2025 request data: 5,086 MW with signed agreements, 9,587 MW in active applications and 8,604 MW of inquiries statewide, of which the 2,600 MW application reported by Valley Electric Association sits in Nevada, so the California-only total is 20,677 MW (Table 5.1). Everything that is not a data center comes from the adopted CED 2025 forms: statewide energy to serve load and the 1-in-2 coincident peak for the Planning forecast, the Baseline (the Planning forecast before additional achievable efficiency and fuel substitution), the Local Reliability scenario and the Local Reliability scenario with known loads [California Energy Commission, 2026c], minus the CEC’s own data center component, which is published as a line of the peak workbook and as the data center allocations of the Planning forecast [California Energy Commission, 2026e,d]. The three cases are labelled low (Planning), mid (Baseline) and high (Local Reliability); the fourth, which adds the utilities’ known loads through a separate adjustment line, is shown for reference. Between 2025 and 2030 non-data-center energy grows by 23.6, 40.5 and 45.3 TWh and the non-data-center statewide peak by 3,625, 4,988 and 5,792 MW in the three cases (Table 5.2). The CEC’s own data center component in 2030 is 1,743 MW at the CAISO peak in the Planning forecast and 4,377 MW in the Local Reliability scenario, of which 160 and 242 MW are VEA’s Nevada load, with 12.1 TWh of deliveries in the Planning forecast.

Table 5.1: Requested capacity by tier, December 2025 vintage. Source: CEC Assembly hearing deck (statewide totals) and the methodology memo’s Table 1 (VEA row).

| Tier (December 2025) | All reporting utilities (MW) | VEA, Nevada (MW) | California (MW) |
|----------------------|------------------------------|------------------|-----------------|
| Signed agreement     | 5,086                        | 0                | 5,086           |
| Active application   | 9,587                        | 2,600            | 6,987           |
| Inquiry              | 8,604                        | 0                | 8,604           |
| Total                | 23,277                       | 2,600            | 20,677          |

Table 5.2: Non-data-center demand in 2025 and 2030 by IEPR case: statewide energy to serve load and coincident peak minus the CEC’s data center component. Source: CED 2025 forms (TN 268722, 268727, 268725, 268726), peak components (TN 268124), data center allocations (TN 268824).

| Case                  | CED 2025 scenario            | Energy 2025 (TWh) | Energy 2030 | Growth | Peak 2025 (MW) | Peak 2030 | Growth | CEC DC peak 2030 (MW) | CEC DC energy 2030 (TWh) |
|-----------------------|------------------------------|-------------------|-------------|--------|----------------|-----------|--------|-----------------------|--------------------------|
| low                   | Planning                     | 262.5             | 286.1       | 23.6   | 57,464         | 61,089    | 3,625  | 1,743                 | 12.1                     |
| mid                   | Baseline                     | 263.3             | 303.7       | 40.5   | 57,464         | 62,452    | 4,988  | 1,743                 | 12.1                     |
| high                  | Local Reliability            | 262.5             | 307.8       | 45.3   | 57,440         | 63,233    | 5,792  | 4,377                 | 30.3                     |
| high plus known loads | Local Reliability plus known | 262.5             | 327.0       | 64.5   | 57,440         | 67,014    | 9,573  | 4,382                 | 30.4                     |

**Four counting rules.** Table 5.3 and Figure 5.1 apply four rules to the same 20,677 MW. The proposal’s upper bound lets every requested megawatt operate flat by 2030: 20,677 MW and 181.1 TWh, or 13,854 MW and 106.8 TWh at the CEC’s utilization factor. The CEC central case is the Commission’s published Planning forecast, 1,583 MW at the CAISO peak once VEA is removed, with 12.1 TWh of deliveries; the Local Reliability scenario gives 4,135 MW and 30.3 TWh. Both are rebuilt from the CEC’s published parameters in Table 5.4: confidence levels of 70/33/0 or 100/50/10 percent times 67 percent utilization, with SVP’s requests exempt from the confidence levels as the methodology memo states [California Energy Commission, 2026d], reproduce the memo’s 2040 endpoints of 4,855 and 7,381 MW to within 1 MW, so the effective tier probabilities are 0.74/0.35/0.02 in the Planning forecast and 1.00/0.51/0.12 in the Local Reliability scenario. The CEC’s own ramp, read as the share of the 2040 CAISO component reached in each year (Table 5.5), puts 36 percent of that demand on line by 2030 in the Planning forecast and 60 percent in the Local Reliability scenario, which gives 1,549 and 3,896 MW for California against the published 1,583 and 4,135 MW, within 2 and 6 percent; the residual is the utility-supplied schedules the CEC uses where they exist. The published values are used as the central and high cases and the replication rows are carried as the check. The ERCOT-calibrated case is described below. The PJM-style case follows the rules PJM applied in its 2026 forecast: only projects with an electric service obligation or construction commitment count before 2030, at 70 percent utilization and a ramp of at least 36 months, and from 2030 half of non-firm requests are added before a national scaling [Mooney, 2025, PJM Interconnection, 2026]; on California’s tiers that is 3,560 MW for the firm-only rule and 9,017 MW with half of the applications and inquiries.

Table 5.3: Data center demand added by 2030 under each counting rule (California-only tiers). Energy uses a 0.88 load factor except where the CEC’s published deliveries are used. Ramps are the share of realized capacity on line by the end of 2030.

| Case                                            | P(agreement) | P(application) | P(inquiry) | Utilization | Ramp agr. | Ramp app./inq. | Load factor | Peak 2030 (MW) | Energy 2030 (TWh) |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------------|------------|-------------|-----------|----------------|-------------|----------------|-------------------|
| Upper bound: every MW builds, flat load         | 1.00         | 1.00           | 1.00       | 1.00        | 1.00      | 1.00           | 1.00        | 20,677         | 181.1             |
| Upper bound at CEC utilization                  | 1.00         | 1.00           | 1.00       | 0.67        | 1.00      | 1.00           | 0.88        | 13,854         | 106.8             |
| CEC central (Planning forecast, published)      | 0.70         | 0.33           | 0.00       | 0.67        | –         | –              | –           | 1,583          | 12.1              |
| CEC central, replicated from parameters         | 0.74         | 0.35           | 0.02       | 0.67        | 0.36      | 0.36           | 0.88        | 1,549          | 11.9              |
| CEC high (Local Reliability, published)         | 1.00         | 0.50           | 0.10       | 0.67        | –         | –              | –           | 4,135          | 30.3              |
| CEC high, replicated from parameters            | 1.00         | 0.51           | 0.12       | 0.67        | 0.60      | 0.60           | 0.88        | 3,896          | 30.0              |
| ERCOT-calibrated stock-flow                     | 0.37         | 0.06           | 0.02       | 0.67        | 1.00      | 1.00           | 0.88        | 1,622          | 12.5              |
| ERCOT-calibrated, ERCOT observed utilization    | 0.37         | 0.06           | 0.02       | 0.64        | 1.00      | 1.00           | 0.88        | 1,545          | 11.9              |
| PJM-style: firm only (signed agreements)        | 1.00         | 0.00           | 0.00       | 0.70        | 1.00      | 1.00           | 0.88        | 3,560          | 27.4              |
| PJM-style: firm plus half of non-firm from 2030 | 1.00         | 0.50           | 0.50       | 0.70        | 1.00      | 1.00           | 0.88        | 9,017          | 69.5              |

Table 5.4: The CEC forecast rebuilt from its published parameters: full-ramp demand with SVP exempt from the confidence levels against the memo’s 2040 endpoints, the effective tier probabilities, the CEC’s 2030 ramp share and the replicated against the published 2030 components.

| Scenario          | Full-ramp statewide (MW) | Memo 2040 endpoint | Full-ramp California | Effective P (agr. / app. / inq.) | CEC ramp share 2030 (%) | Replicated 2030 California (MW) | Published CAISO 2030 | of which VEA | Published California 2030 |
|-------------------|--------------------------|--------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------|--------------|---------------------------|
| Planning          | 4,855                    | 4,855              | 4,280                | 0.74 / 0.35 / 0.02               | 36                      | 1,549                           | 1,743                | 160          | 1,583                     |
| Local Reliability | 7,381                    | 7,381              | 6,510                | 1.00 / 0.51 / 0.12               | 60                      | 3,896                           | 4,377                | 242          | 4,135                     |

Table 5.5: The CEC’s ramp profile: CAISO data center component by year and its share of the 2040 value (TN 268124 annual peaks).

| CEC ramp profile                                    | 2025 | 2026 | 2027 | 2028  | 2029  | 2030  | 2032  | 2035  | 2040  |
|-----------------------------------------------------|------|------|------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| Planning: CAISO data center component (MW)          | 96   | 288  | 417  | 806   | 1,245 | 1,743 | 2,979 | 4,564 | 4,817 |
| Planning: share of 2040 (%)                         | 2    | 6    | 9    | 17    | 26    | 36    | 62    | 95    | 100   |
| Local Reliability: CAISO data center component (MW) | 122  | 374  | 684  | 1,882 | 3,238 | 4,377 | 5,879 | 7,191 | 7,314 |
| Local Reliability: share of 2040 (%)                | 2    | 5    | 9    | 26    | 44    | 60    | 80    | 98    | 100   |

Table 5.6 adds each of the data center cases to each of the three IEPR cases: the 2030 statewide coincident peak runs from 62.7 GW (Planning growth with the CEC central case) to 83.9 GW (Local Reliability growth with the upper bound), and the growth from 2025 from 5.2 to 26.5 GW and from 36 to 226 TWh.

Table 5.6: Each demand case on top of each IEPR non-data-center case: 2030 statewide coincident peak and energy to serve load, and their growth from 2025.

| Demand case                                | IEPR case | Non-DC peak 2030 (MW) | DC peak | Total peak | Growth from 2025 | Non-DC energy 2030 (TWh) | DC energy | Total energy | Growth from 2025 |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------------------|---------|------------|------------------|--------------------------|-----------|--------------|------------------|
| Upper bound: every MW builds, flat load    | low       | 61,089                | 20,677  | 81,766     | 24,302           | 286.1                    | 181.1     | 467.2        | 204.8            |
| Upper bound: every MW builds, flat load    | mid       | 62,452                | 20,677  | 83,129     | 25,665           | 303.7                    | 181.1     | 484.9        | 221.6            |
| Upper bound: every MW builds, flat load    | high      | 63,233                | 20,677  | 83,910     | 26,469           | 307.8                    | 181.1     | 488.9        | 226.4            |
| Upper bound at CEC utilization             | low       | 61,089                | 13,854  | 74,943     | 17,479           | 286.1                    | 106.8     | 392.9        | 130.4            |
| Upper bound at CEC utilization             | mid       | 62,452                | 13,854  | 76,305     | 18,841           | 303.7                    | 106.8     | 410.5        | 147.3            |
| Upper bound at CEC utilization             | high      | 63,233                | 13,854  | 77,086     | 19,646           | 307.8                    | 106.8     | 414.6        | 152.1            |
| CEC central (Planning forecast, published) | low       | 61,089                | 1,583   | 62,672     | 5,208            | 286.1                    | 12.1      | 298.2        | 35.7             |
| CEC central (Planning forecast, published) | mid       | 62,452                | 1,583   | 64,035     | 6,571            | 303.7                    | 12.1      | 315.8        | 52.6             |
| CEC central (Planning forecast, published) | high      | 63,233                | 1,583   | 64,816     | 7,375            | 307.8                    | 12.1      | 319.9        | 57.4             |
| CEC high (Local Reliability, published)    | low       | 61,089                | 4,135   | 65,224     | 7,760            | 286.1                    | 30.3      | 316.4        | 54.0             |
| CEC high (Local Reliability, published)    | mid       | 62,452                | 4,135   | 66,587     | 9,123            | 303.7                    | 30.3      | 334.1        | 70.8             |
| CEC high (Local Reliability, published)    | high      | 63,233                | 4,135   | 67,368     | 9,927            | 307.8                    | 30.3      | 338.1        | 75.6             |
| ERCOT-calibrated stock-flow                | low       | 61,089                | 1,622   | 62,711     | 5,247            | 286.1                    | 12.5      | 298.6        | 36.1             |
| ERCOT-calibrated stock-flow                | mid       | 62,452                | 1,622   | 64,074     | 6,610            | 303.7                    | 12.5      | 316.2        | 53.0             |
| ERCOT-calibrated stock-flow                | high      | 63,233                | 1,622   | 64,855     | 7,414            | 307.8                    | 12.5      | 320.3        | 57.8             |
| PJM-style: firm only (signed agreements)   | low       | 61,089                | 3,560   | 64,649     | 7,185            | 286.1                    | 27.4      | 313.5        | 51.1             |
| PJM-style: firm only (signed agreements)   | mid       | 62,452                | 3,560   | 66,012     | 8,548            | 303.7                    | 27.4      | 331.2        | 67.9             |
| PJM-style: firm only (signed agreements)   | high      | 63,233                | 3,560   | 66,793     | 9,352            | 307.8                    | 27.4      | 335.2        | 72.7             |

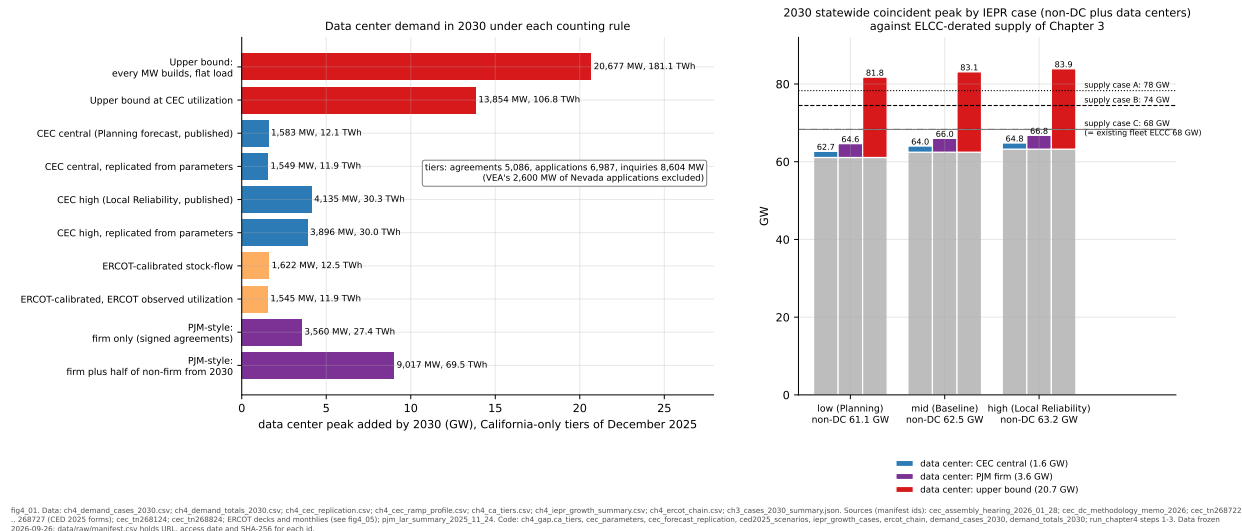


Figure 5.1: Left: data center peak and energy added by 2030 under each counting rule. Right: the 2030 statewide coincident peak by IEPR case, non-data-center demand plus three of the data center cases, against the ELCC-derated supply of Chapter 4 (cases A, B and C) and the existing fleet.

*Source line:* fig4\_01. Data: ch4\_demand\_cases\_2030.csv; ch4\_demand\_totals\_2030.csv; ch4\_cec\_replication.csv; ch4\_cec\_ramp\_profile.csv; ch4\_ca\_tiers.csv; ch4\_iepr\_growth\_summary.csv; ch4\_ercot\_chain.csv; ch3\_cases\_2030\_summary.json. Sources (manifest ids): cec\_assembly\_hearing\_2026\_01\_28; cec\_dc\_methodology\_memo\_2026; cec\_tn268722 .. 268727 (CED 2025 forms); cec\_tn268124; cec\_tn268824; ERCOT decks and monthlies (see fig4\_05); pjmlar\_summary\_2025\_11\_24. Code: ch4\_gap.ca\_tiers, cec\_parameters, cec\_forecast\_replication, ced2025\_scenarios, iepr\_growth\_cases, ercot\_chain, demand\_cases\_2030, demand\_totals\_2030; run\_chapter4 steps 1-3. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

**The ERCOT-calibrated stock-flow case.** ERCOT publishes the stock of large-load requests in each phase of its interconnection process, which makes it possible to estimate how fast projects actually move from one phase to the next. Monthly totals from January 2025 to March 2026, the monthly stocks of projects with approved planning studies and with approval to energize from May 2025 to March 2026, and six snapshots of the queue by status between March and July 2026 were transcribed from ERCOT’s newsletters, its March 2026 TAC report, its December 2025 and June 2026 board decks, its April 2026 legislative decks and its April, June, July and August 2026 operational overviews (Figure 5.6, Section 5.5) [ERCOT Large Load Integration Team, 2026, ERCOT, 2026a, Billo and Hobbs, 2026, ERCOT, 2026b]. Approvals to energize reached 9,456 MW by July 2026, of which 4,370 MW was observed operating that month and 4,316 MW in August. From these, four monthly hazards are estimated (Table 5.7): 2.1 percent a month from no studies submitted to under review, an upper bound because cancellations leave the same stock; 0.75 percent from under review to studies approved; 1.6 percent from studies approved to approval to energize; and 3.1 percent from approval to energize to observed energization. A Markov chain with those hazards gives the probability that a project starting in each phase is energized within 60 months, the distance from the December 2025 vintage to December 2030: 37 percent for a project whose studies are approved, 6 percent for one under review and 2 percent for one without studies (Table 5.8). Mapping inquiries to no studies submitted, applications to under review and signed agreements to approved studies, and applying the CEC’s utilization factor, gives 1,622 MW and 12.5 TWh in 2030, almost the same as the CEC central case. Doubling every hazard, which is what ERCOT’s

move to a batch process is meant to achieve, raises the three probabilities to 72, 25 and 12 percent; a 0.5 percent monthly cancellation hazard lowers them slightly. The rates were measured while ERCOT’s queue quadrupled and its studies fell behind, so they describe study throughput as much as project viability, which is why the Monte Carlo treats the tier probabilities as uncertain over the CEC and ERCOT values rather than fixing them.

Table 5.7: Monthly phase-transition hazards estimated from the ERCOT large-load queue. Source: ERCOT TAC report March 2026 (slide 4), ERCOT Monthly November 2025, TAC snapshot of March 13 2026.

| Transition                                                  | Flow (MW) | Months | Pool (MW) | Monthly hazard (%) | Annual (%) | Window                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|--------|-----------|--------------------|------------|--------------------------|
| Planning studies approved → approved to energize            | 2,168     | 10.0   | 13,860    | 1.56               | 17.2       | 2025-05 to 2026-03       |
| Under ERCOT review → planning studies approved              | 5,878     | 10.0   | 77,982    | 0.75               | 8.7        | 2025-05 to 2026-03       |
| No studies submitted → under ERCOT review (or cancellation) | 10,327    | 3.8    | 129,152   | 2.12               | 22.6       | 2025-11-18 to 2026-03-13 |
| Approved to energize → observed energized                   | 923       | 12.0   | 2,524     | 3.05               | 31.0       | calendar 2025            |

Table 5.8: Probability (percent) of energization within 60 months by starting phase, from the Markov chain with the estimated hazards, with every hazard scaled 1, 2 and 3 times and with a monthly cancellation hazard of 0 or 0.5 percent in the pre-approval phases.

| Start phase (California tier)                | 1x, cancel 0% | 1x, cancel 0.5% | 2x, cancel 0% | 2x, cancel 0.5% | 3x, cancel 0% | 3x, cancel 0.5% |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------|-----------------|---------------|-----------------|---------------|-----------------|
| No studies submitted (inquiry)               | 1.6           | 1.4             | 12.2          | 10.3            | 30.2          | 25.6            |
| Under ERCOT review (application)             | 5.9           | 5.1             | 24.5          | 21.2            | 45.6          | 39.6            |
| Planning studies approved (signed agreement) | 36.7          | 33.4            | 71.9          | 65.9            | 88.8          | 82.2            |
| Approved to energize                         | 84.4          | 84.4            | 97.7          | 97.7            | 99.7          | 99.7            |

## 5.2 The Monte Carlo gap model

**Definitions.** The energy gap in 2030 is the growth of demand from 2025 to 2030, non-data-center growth in the drawn IEPR case plus the data center energy of the drawn case, minus the growth of supply, the energy of the planned units that complete at recent capacity factors, minus the energy of the units that retire, plus the change in net imports. The net-peak gap is the growth of the statewide coincident peak times one plus the planning reserve margin, minus the change in ELCC-weighted capacity. Both are increments, so the accounting boundaries of the CEC forecast and of the EIA generation data cancel, and a positive value means that demand grows faster than the resources the weighted pipeline delivers at recent operating patterns; it has to be met by running the existing fleet harder, by importing more, or by resources not yet in the planned list. The absolute balances, which compare 2030 levels directly, are reported alongside; they use in-state ELCC only and so leave out the peak contribution of imports, which in 2025 sat on top of an in-state surplus of about 1.5 GW over the statewide peak with a 16 percent margin.

**Inputs.** Table 5.9 lists the thirteen inputs and the evidence behind their ranges: the tier probabilities span the CEC’s Planning and Local Reliability confidence levels with lower bounds near the ERCOT chain; utilization runs from ERCOT’s observed 46 percent (the August 2026 monthly peak of approved loads over the approved total) to PJM’s 70 percent with the CEC’s 67 percent as the mode; the share of realized capacity on line by 2030 spans the CEC’s own ramp profile (36 and 60 percent by 2030) and PJM’s 36-month rule; the load factor is the range of Chapter 2; each of the 229 planned generating units completes with its Chapter 4 probability; the hydro capacity factor spans 2010–2025; solar and wind output moves within 10 percent; 2030 net imports span the

CEC’s 2012–2024 statewide series; the IEPR case is drawn with equal weights; Diablo Canyon operates or retires with equal probability, because the Nuclear Regulatory Commission renewed both licences on April 2, 2026 while SB 846 authorises operation only through 2030 and any extension needs an act of the Legislature [Office of the Governor of California, 2026, U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission, 2026]; and the reserve margin is uniform between 15 and 17 percent.

Table 5.9: Monte Carlo inputs, distributions and their basis (10,000 draws, seed 20260922).

| Input            | Distribution       | Low   | Mode  | High  | Basis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------|--------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| p_agreement      | triangular         | 0.50  | 0.70  | 1.00  | CEC 70% (Planning) to 100% (Local Reliability); lower bound above the ERCOT chain value for studies-approved projects (0.37)                                                                                                                                                  |
| p_application    | triangular         | 0.10  | 0.33  | 0.50  | CEC 33% to 50%; lower bound above the ERCOT chain value for projects under review (0.06)                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| p_inquiry        | triangular         | 0.00  | 0.03  | 0.10  | CEC 0% to 10% (0.02 effective in the Planning forecast with SVP exempt); mode above the ERCOT chain value for projects without studies (0.02)                                                                                                                                 |
| utilization      | triangular         | 0.46  | 0.67  | 0.70  | ERCOT monthly observed peak over approved (4,316 of 9,456 MW, Aug 2026) to PJM’s 70%; mode CEC 67%                                                                                                                                                                            |
| ramp_2030        | triangular         | 0.30  | 0.55  | 1.00  | share of realized capacity on line by end-2030: the CEC’s own ramp profile reaches 36% (Planning) and 60% (Local Reliability) of full demand by 2030; PJM’s 36-month ramp gives 1.0                                                                                           |
| load_factor      | triangular         | 0.80  | 0.88  | 0.95  | chapter 1 assumption range; CEC observed 85-90% (memo p. 11)                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| gen_realization  | per-unit Bernoulli | –     | –     | –     | each planned unit completes with its chapter 3 logit probability p_2030 (229 units, 20.1 GW)                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| hydro_cf         | triangular         | 0.16  | 0.34  | 0.48  | hydro capacity factor 2010-2025 range 0.16-0.48, mode 2023-2025 mean                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| vre_scale        | triangular         | 0.90  | 1.00  | 1.10  | solar and wind capacity factors within 10% of their 2023-2025 means                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| imports_twh      | triangular         | 62.16 | 62.16 | 99.21 | CEC statewide net imports: 2019-2024 minimum 62, 2024 value 62, 2012-2024 maximum 99 TWh                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| iepr_case        | categorical        | 0.00  | 1.00  | 2.00  | low = Planning, mid = Baseline, high = Local Reliability, equal weights                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| diablo_continues | Bernoulli(0.5)     | 0.00  | –     | 1.00  | Diablo Canyon operating in 2030 or retired as in chapter 3 case C: the NRC renewed both licences on April 2 2026, but SB 846 authorises operation only through 2030 and any extension needs legislative action (gov_ca_diablo_license_2026_04_02, nrc_diablo_canyon_rod_2026) |
| prm              | uniform            | 0.15  | 0.16  | 0.17  | planning reserve margin applied to the peak: CPUC resource adequacy range 15-17%                                                                                                                                                                                              |

**Results.** The median 2030 energy gap is 50 TWh, with a 5th to 95th percentile range of 19 to 78 TWh, and the median net-peak gap is 7.2 GW (4.2 to 10.1 GW); both are positive in every draw (Table 5.10, Figure 5.2). The data center contribution is 2.3 GW and 18 TWh at the median and 1.4 to 3.6 GW across the 5th to 95th percentiles. The gap is dominated by what is not a data center: non-data-center growth alone is 24 to 45 TWh and 3.6 to 5.8 GW, while the weighted pipeline adds on average only 5 TWh and 1.1 GW of ELCC once retirements are netted, and it removes 18 TWh and 2.2 GW in the half of the draws where Diablo Canyon retires (median gaps of 59 TWh and 8.4 GW with it retired against 42 TWh and 6.2 GW with it operating). Closing the median energy gap with the existing gas fleet would require raising its capacity factor from the 0.24 of 2023–2025 to 0.40, and the 95th percentile to 0.49. The proposal’s upper bound, every requested megawatt operating flat in 2030 with the central supply, gives an energy gap of 202 to 242 TWh and a peak gap of 25.5 to 30.2 GW across the three IEPR cases and both Diablo Canyon settings, four to five times the probability-weighted 95th percentile; those rows appear in every results table.

Table 5.10: Monte Carlo results for 2030: energy gap, net-peak gap and the data center contribution, all draws and by IEPR case, with the proposal's upper bound (every MW builds, flat load; range over the three IEPR cases and Diablo Canyon on or off).

| Metric                              | IEPR case                     | Mean   | P5     | P25   | P50   | P75   | P95    | Share > 0 (%) |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------|--------|-------|-------|-------|--------|---------------|
| Energy gap (TWh)                    | all cases                     | 49.4   | 19.2   | 37.3  | 49.7  | 62.0  | 78.1   | 100           |
| Energy gap (TWh)                    | low                           | 36.3   | 11.3   | 26.0  | 36.7  | 46.6  | 60.6   | 99            |
| Energy gap (TWh)                    | mid                           | 53.5   | 28.3   | 43.0  | 53.6  | 64.5  | 78.8   | 100           |
| Energy gap (TWh)                    | high                          | 58.0   | 33.1   | 47.7  | 58.2  | 68.6  | 81.7   | 100           |
| upper bound (every MW builds, flat) | low to high, Diablo on or off | 224.2  | 202.4  | —     | —     | —     | 242.0  | 100           |
| Net-peak gap (MW)                   | all cases                     | 7,182  | 4,160  | 5,976 | 7,169 | 8,499 | 10,068 | 100           |
| Net-peak gap (MW)                   | low                           | 5,794  | 3,546  | 4,630 | 5,800 | 6,905 | 8,143  | 100           |
| Net-peak gap (MW)                   | mid                           | 7,426  | 5,124  | 6,237 | 7,444 | 8,568 | 9,793  | 100           |
| Net-peak gap (MW)                   | high                          | 8,291  | 6,084  | 7,144 | 8,282 | 9,366 | 10,620 | 100           |
| upper bound (every MW builds, flat) | low to high, Diablo on or off | 27,979 | 25,511 | —     | —     | —     | 30,231 | 100           |
| Data center peak (MW)               | all cases                     | 2,358  | 1,387  | 1,862 | 2,292 | 2,784 | 3,556  | 100           |
| Data center peak (MW)               | low                           | 2,356  | 1,383  | 1,859 | 2,293 | 2,786 | 3,545  | 100           |
| Data center peak (MW)               | mid                           | 2,365  | 1,391  | 1,866 | 2,301 | 2,796 | 3,572  | 100           |
| Data center peak (MW)               | high                          | 2,353  | 1,388  | 1,860 | 2,281 | 2,768 | 3,559  | 100           |
| upper bound (every MW builds, flat) | low to high, Diablo on or off | 20,677 | 20,677 | —     | —     | —     | 20,677 | 100           |
| Data center energy (TWh)            | all cases                     | 18.1   | 10.6   | 14.3  | 17.6  | 21.4  | 27.4   | 100           |
| Data center energy (TWh)            | low                           | 18.1   | 10.5   | 14.3  | 17.6  | 21.4  | 27.3   | 100           |
| Data center energy (TWh)            | mid                           | 18.2   | 10.7   | 14.4  | 17.6  | 21.5  | 27.5   | 100           |
| Data center energy (TWh)            | high                          | 18.1   | 10.6   | 14.3  | 17.6  | 21.3  | 27.4   | 100           |
| upper bound (every MW builds, flat) | low to high, Diablo on or off | 181.1  | 181.1  | —     | —     | —     | 181.1  | 100           |

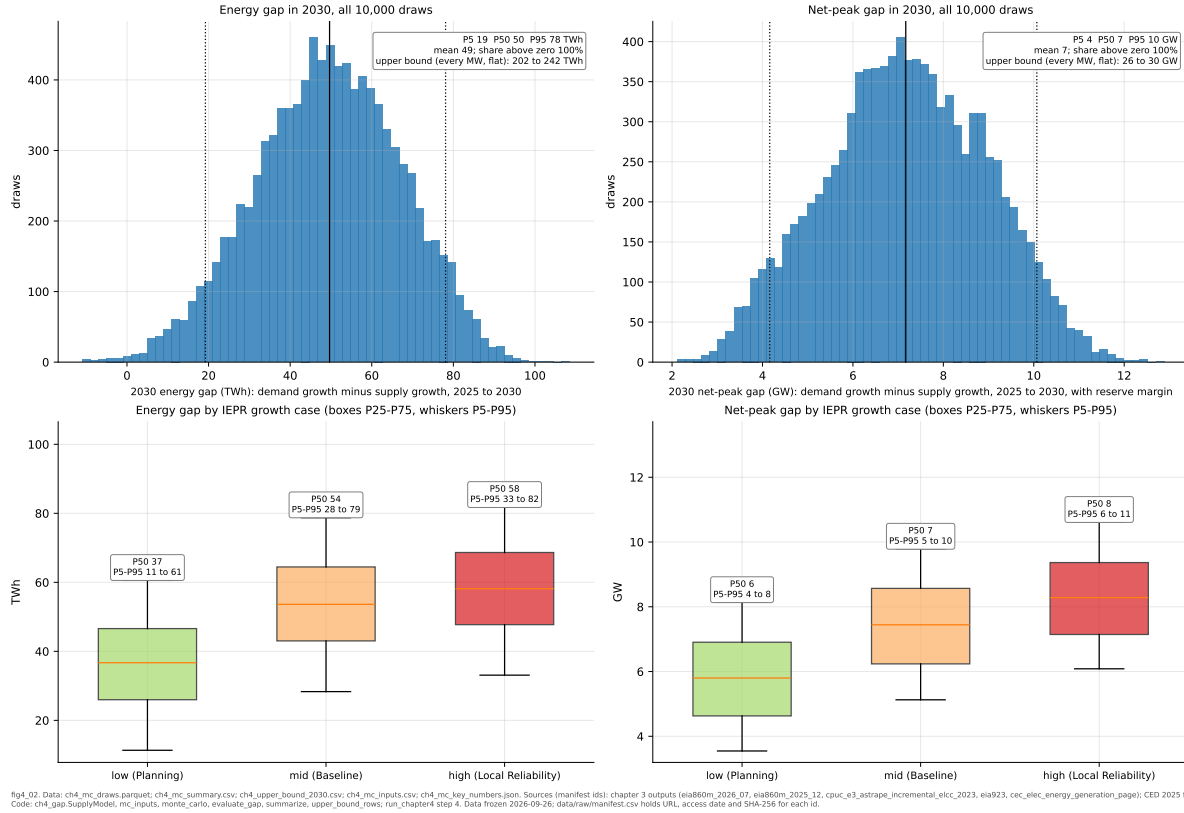


Figure 5.2: Distribution of the 2030 energy gap (left) and net-peak gap (right) over 10,000 draws, with the 5th, 50th and 95th percentiles and the upper-bound range, and by IEPR non-data-center growth case (bottom).

Source line: fig4\_02. Data: ch4\_mc\_draws.parquet; ch4\_mc\_summary.csv; ch4\_upper\_bound\_2030.csv; ch4\_mc\_inputs.csv; ch4\_mc\_key\_numbers.json. Sources (manifest ids): chapter 3 outputs (eia860m\_2026\_07, eia860m\_2025\_12, cpuc\_e3\_astrape\_incremental\_elcc\_2023, eia923, cec\_elec\_energy\_generation\_page); CED 2025 forms as above. Code: ch4\_gap.SupplyModel, mc\_inputs, monte\_carlo, evaluate\_gap, summarize, upper\_bound\_rows; run\_chapter4 step 4. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

### 5.3 Sensitivity

Table 5.11 moves one input at a time between its 5th and 95th percentiles (low and high case for the IEPR case, retired and operating for Diablo Canyon) with every other input at its median, and Table 5.12 gives the Sobol first-order and total indices from a 15,360-evaluation Sobol design computed with SALib [Herman and Usher, 2017, Sobol', 2001]; both are drawn in Figure 5.3. For the energy gap the supply side and the non-data-center forecast dominate: net imports swing the gap by 28 TWh, the IEPR case by 22, the hydro capacity factor by 20 and Diablo Canyon by 18, while the three tier probabilities, utilization and the load factor together move it by 5 TWh or less each; the three tier probabilities carry about 2 percent of the variance of the energy gap and 4 percent of the peak gap. For the peak gap the ranking is Diablo Canyon (total index 0.39), the IEPR case (0.35), the data center ramp (0.14) and generation completion (0.07). The first-order indices sum to about one in both cases, so the model is close to additive and the one-at-a-time ranking is reliable.

Table 5.11: One-at-a-time swings of the 2030 gaps (all other inputs at their medians).

| Input                                              | Low    | High   | Energy gap at low (TWh) | at high | Swing | Peak gap at low (MW) | at high | Swing |
|----------------------------------------------------|--------|--------|-------------------------|---------|-------|----------------------|---------|-------|
| imports_twh                                        | 63.1   | 91     | 65                      | 37      | 28    | 6,913                | 6,913   | 0     |
| iepr_case                                          | 0      | 2      | 38                      | 60      | 22    | 5,332                | 7,846   | 2,514 |
| hydro_cf                                           | 0.21   | 0.436  | 66                      | 46      | 20    | 6,913                | 6,913   | 0     |
| diablo_continues                                   | 0      | 1      | 64                      | 46      | 18    | 8,016                | 5,809   | 2,207 |
| ramp_2030                                          | 0.393  | 0.877  | 49                      | 63      | 14    | 5,962                | 8,127   | 2,164 |
| vre_scale                                          | 0.932  | 1.07   | 61                      | 50      | 11    | 6,913                | 6,913   | 0     |
| p_application                                      | 0.167  | 0.441  | 52                      | 58      | 6     | 6,467                | 7,300   | 833   |
| p_agreement                                        | 0.572  | 0.914  | 53                      | 58      | 5     | 6,571                | 7,326   | 755   |
| utilization                                        | 0.51   | 0.681  | 52                      | 57      | 5     | 6,439                | 7,185   | 746   |
| gen_realization                                    | 0.576  | 0.728  | 57                      | 54      | 3     | 7,705                | 6,166   | 1,539 |
| load_factor                                        | 0.824  | 0.927  | 54                      | 56      | 2     | 6,913                | 6,913   | 0     |
| p_inquiry                                          | 0.0128 | 0.0811 | 55                      | 56      | 2     | 6,808                | 7,063   | 256   |
| prm                                                | 0.151  | 0.169  | 55                      | 55      | 0     | 6,847                | 6,979   | 132   |
| base (all inputs at their medians)                 |        |        | 55                      |         |       | 6,913                |         |       |
| upper bound (every MW builds, flat; deterministic) |        |        | 202                     | 242     |       | 25,511               | 30,231  |       |

Table 5.12: Sobol first-order (S1, with bootstrap confidence half-width) and total (ST) indices of the 2030 gaps.

| Input            | S1 energy | $\pm$ | ST energy | S1 peak | $\pm$ | ST peak |
|------------------|-----------|-------|-----------|---------|-------|---------|
| iepr_case        | 0.276     | 0.039 | 0.278     | 0.343   | 0.044 | 0.349   |
| diablo_continues | 0.255     | 0.040 | 0.254     | 0.391   | 0.047 | 0.391   |
| imports_twh      | 0.240     | 0.042 | 0.242     | 0.000   | 0.000 | 0.000   |
| hydro_cf         | 0.114     | 0.030 | 0.110     | 0.000   | 0.000 | 0.000   |
| ramp_2030        | 0.059     | 0.022 | 0.059     | 0.130   | 0.034 | 0.136   |
| vre_scale        | 0.034     | 0.015 | 0.033     | 0.000   | 0.000 | 0.000   |
| p_application    | 0.008     | 0.009 | 0.009     | 0.018   | 0.012 | 0.021   |
| utilization      | 0.008     | 0.009 | 0.009     | 0.018   | 0.013 | 0.020   |
| p_agreement      | 0.008     | 0.007 | 0.008     | 0.018   | 0.011 | 0.018   |
| gen_realization  | 0.002     | 0.004 | 0.002     | 0.072   | 0.023 | 0.069   |
| load_factor      | 0.002     | 0.003 | 0.001     | 0.000   | 0.000 | 0.000   |
| p_inquiry        | 0.001     | 0.002 | 0.001     | 0.002   | 0.004 | 0.002   |
| prm              | 0.000     | 0.000 | 0.000     | 0.000   | 0.002 | 0.001   |

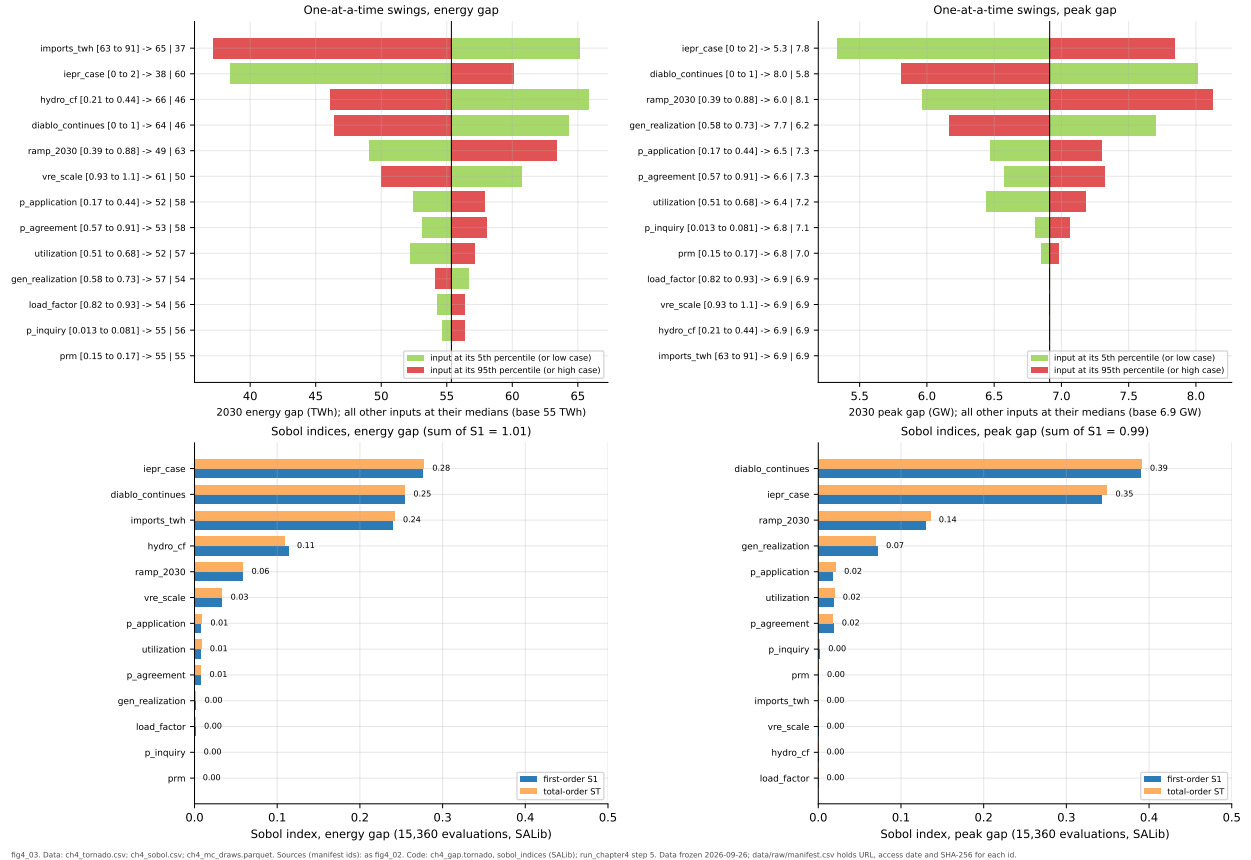


Figure 5.3: Sensitivity of the 2030 energy gap (left) and net-peak gap (right): one-at-a-time swings (top) and Sobol indices (bottom).

Source line: fig4\_03. Data: ch4\_tornado.csv; ch4\_sobol.csv; ch4\_mc\_draws.parquet. Sources (manifest ids): as fig4\_02.

Code: ch4\_gap.tornado, sobol\_indices (SALib); run\_chapter4 step 5. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

## 5.4 Headroom from load flexibility (RQ4)

**Method.** The Duke Nicholas Institute asked how much constant new load a balancing authority could absorb without exceeding the demand its planners already serve, provided the new load accepts a small amount of curtailment [Norris et al., 2025]. Their method is replicated on the cleaned CAISO hourly demand of Chapter 2 for 2019–2025: a constant load  $L$  is added to every hour, the excess of demand plus  $L$  over the seasonal peak threshold is counted as curtailment, the thresholds are the maximum winter and non-winter demand across all years with winter defined as November to February for Pacific-coast balancing authorities, the annual curtailment rate is averaged over the years, and  $L$  is solved for curtailment limits of 0.25, 0.5, 1 and 5 percent. Missing hours are interpolated as in Duke’s cleaning. Three variants test the definition: a December-to-February winter, the 2022–2025 subsample, and a single annual threshold. The headroom is also solved year by year for 2019 to 2025 under two criteria: Duke’s, curtailed energy under 0.25, 0.5, 1 or 5 percent of the load’s potential energy, and the stricter one in the phase plan, the hours in which demand plus the addition exceeds the historical peak threshold kept under the same shares of the year’s hours, which has a closed form from the sorted margins to the threshold.

**Results.** The headroom is 3.1 GW at 0.25 percent curtailment, 3.8 GW at 0.5 percent, 4.6 GW at 1 percent and 8.0 GW at 5 percent (Table 5.13, Figure 5.4), against Duke’s 4.2, 5.0 and 5.9 GW for CAISO on 2016–2024 data. The shortfall against Duke comes from the sample of years and from the winter threshold, 31,226 MW here: 97 to 99 percent of the curtailment falls in November to February, when winter evening demand sits close to the winter peak, and the 2022–2025 subsample gives 2.7 to 4.1 GW. With a single annual threshold of 51,104 MW the headroom would be 11.6 to 16.0 GW, which shows how much of the answer is a definition of season. At the 0.5 percent headroom the new load is curtailed in about 197 hours a year, in 134 of which less than 90 percent of it is available and in 18 less than half, and in the worst hour of the seven years the whole 3.8 GW is cut (Table 5.14). Solved year by year (Table 5.15), the energy criterion gives 3.3 to 4.2 GW at 0.5 percent, 2.4 to 3.7 GW at 0.25 percent and 4.2 to 4.9 GW at 1 percent, lowest in 2025 and highest in 2023 and 2024; the hours criterion is stricter, 2.0 to 2.9 GW at 0.5 percent and 2.6 to 3.3 GW at 1 percent, because it charges a full hour for any excess however small. With a single historical peak instead of seasonal thresholds the same criteria give 7.0 to 11.7 GW and 11.4 to 16.2 GW at 0.5 percent (Table 5.16).

**Against the gap.** The 0.5 percent headroom is 2.4 times the CEC’s central data center addition and 2.3 times the ERCOT-calibrated one, about equal to the PJM firm-only case, 92 percent of the CEC’s high case, and 18 percent of the upper bound (Table 5.17). Set against the Monte Carlo net-peak gap, which includes everything else that grows, it covers 53 percent of the median and 38 percent of the 95th percentile, and 13 percent of the upper-bound peak gap; the 1 percent headroom covers 65 percent of the median gap. Flexibility is therefore enough to place the probability-weighted data center load, and about half of the whole probability-weighted peak gap, without new capacity, but not the upper bound. On the energy side the argument is stronger (Table 5.18): the SCE load-aggregation point had 877 hours of negative day-ahead prices in 2025 and 1,131 in 2024, 78 percent of them between 10 and 16 h (77 to 94 percent across the three load-aggregation points), and CAISO curtailed 3.8 TWh of wind and solar in 2025 and 4.9 TWh in January to August 2026 alone, the equivalent of a 430 MW load running flat all year, so a load that can follow the midday surplus adds energy the system is already discarding.

Table 5.13: Curtailment-enabled headroom (MW) on CAISO hourly demand by variant and curtailment limit, with Duke’s CAISO values.

| Variant                                  | 0.25%  | 0.5%   | 1%     | 5%     |
|------------------------------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Duke seasons (Nov-Feb winter), 2019-2025 | 3,112  | 3,798  | 4,641  | 8,031  |
| Dec-Feb winter, 2019-2025                | 3,244  | 4,023  | 4,977  | 9,001  |
| Duke seasons, 2022-2025 only             | 2,684  | 3,322  | 4,093  | 7,187  |
| single annual threshold, 2019-2025       | 11,593 | 13,578 | 16,033 | 24,334 |
| Duke (2016-2024, EIA-930 CISO)           | 4,200  | 5,000  | 5,900  | —      |

Table 5.14: What the headroom means for the new load, Duke seasons 2019–2025, averages over the seven years.

| Limit (%) | Headroom (MW) | Hours curtailed per year | Share in Nov-Feb (%) | Hours below 90% available | below 75% | below 50% | Largest hourly cut (MW) |
|-----------|---------------|--------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------|-----------|-----------|-------------------------|
| 0.25      | 3,112         | 95                       | 97                   | 65                        | 34        | 11        | 2,227                   |
| 0.5       | 3,798         | 197                      | 98                   | 134                       | 68        | 18        | 2,912                   |
| 1         | 4,641         | 383                      | 99                   | 272                       | 144       | 34        | 3,756                   |
| 5         | 8,031         | 1511                     | 99                   | 1225                      | 796       | 236       | 7,145                   |

Table 5.15: Headroom solved year by year on CAISO demand with the Duke seasonal thresholds (MW): hours above the peak under the limit (left) and curtailed energy under the limit (right).

| Year  | Hours above the peak under 0.25 / 0.5 / 1 / 5% of the year (MW) |             |             |             | Curtailed energy under 0.25 / 0.5 / 1 / 5% (Duke, MW) |             |             |             |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|
| 2019  | 1,945                                                           | 2,315       | 2,870       | 5,040       | 2,954                                                 | 3,657       | 4,585       | 8,299       |
| 2020  | 2,223                                                           | 2,508       | 3,102       | 5,156       | 3,316                                                 | 3,916       | 4,784       | 8,535       |
| 2021  | 1,561                                                           | 2,071       | 2,834       | 5,067       | 2,523                                                 | 3,466       | 4,545       | 8,347       |
| 2022  | 2,001                                                           | 2,534       | 3,140       | 4,885       | 3,193                                                 | 3,845       | 4,660       | 8,029       |
| 2023  | 2,619                                                           | 2,873       | 3,315       | 4,850       | 3,657                                                 | 4,196       | 4,898       | 7,974       |
| 2024  | 2,635                                                           | 2,945       | 3,330       | 4,815       | 3,650                                                 | 4,173       | 4,867       | 7,849       |
| 2025  | 1,345                                                           | 1,985       | 2,641       | 4,438       | 2,433                                                 | 3,264       | 4,152       | 7,331       |
| range | 1,345–2,635                                                     | 1,985–2,945 | 2,641–3,330 | 4,438–5,156 | 2,433–3,657                                           | 3,264–4,196 | 4,152–4,898 | 7,331–8,535 |

Table 5.16: The same, with a single historical peak threshold of 51,104 MW in every month (MW).

| Year  | Hours above the peak under 0.25 / 0.5 / 1 / 5% of the year (MW) |              |              |               | Curtailed energy under 0.25 / 0.5 / 1 / 5% (Duke, MW) |               |               |               |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
| 2019  | 8,995                                                           | 9,602        | 10,806       | 16,353        | 12,128                                                | 13,784        | 16,122        | 24,933        |
| 2020  | 6,559                                                           | 8,056        | 9,811        | 15,770        | 10,318                                                | 12,492        | 15,355        | 24,088        |
| 2021  | 9,630                                                           | 10,438       | 11,314       | 15,757        | 12,745                                                | 14,255        | 16,306        | 24,410        |
| 2022  | 4,992                                                           | 6,962        | 9,428        | 14,719        | 8,401                                                 | 11,354        | 14,149        | 23,037        |
| 2023  | 9,107                                                           | 10,416       | 12,041       | 17,377        | 13,160                                                | 15,141        | 17,666        | 25,561        |
| 2024  | 7,425                                                           | 8,506        | 10,145       | 15,199        | 10,752                                                | 12,705        | 15,035        | 23,450        |
| 2025  | 10,454                                                          | 11,738       | 13,084       | 17,324        | 14,436                                                | 16,219        | 18,286        | 24,577        |
| range | 4,992–10,454                                                    | 6,962–11,738 | 9,428–13,084 | 14,719–17,377 | 8,401–14,436                                          | 11,354–16,219 | 14,149–18,286 | 23,037–25,561 |

Table 5.17: Headroom as a share of the data center cases and of the Monte Carlo net-peak gap (percent).

| Limit (%) | Headroom (MW) | of CEC central DC (%) | of ERCOT-calibrated | of PJM firm | of CEC high | of upper-bound DC | of peak gap P50 | of peak gap P95 | of upper-bound peak gap |
|-----------|---------------|-----------------------|---------------------|-------------|-------------|-------------------|-----------------|-----------------|-------------------------|
| 0.25      | 3,112         | 197                   | 192                 | 87          | 75          | 15                | 43              | 31              | 10                      |
| 0.5       | 3,798         | 240                   | 234                 | 107         | 92          | 18                | 53              | 38              | 13                      |
| 1         | 4,641         | 293                   | 286                 | 130         | 112         | 22                | 65              | 46              | 15                      |
| 5         | 8,031         | 507                   | 495                 | 226         | 194         | 39                | 112             | 80              | 27                      |

Table 5.18: The energy-side argument: negative-price hours and curtailed energy. Source: Chapter 2 day-ahead prices, Chapter 4 curtailment.

| Item                                                     | Value | Unit  | Share in 10–16 h (%) | Energy a 1 GW flexible load could absorb (GWh) | Source                       |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-------|-------|----------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| PG&E DLAP hours with negative day-ahead price, 2024      | 190   | hours | 88                   | 190                                            | ch1_price_stats              |
| PG&E DLAP hours with negative day-ahead price, 2025      | 218   | hours | 94                   | 218                                            | ch1_price_stats              |
| SCE DLAP hours with negative day-ahead price, 2024       | 1,131 | hours | 77                   | 1,131                                          | ch1_price_stats              |
| SCE DLAP hours with negative day-ahead price, 2025       | 877   | hours | 78                   | 877                                            | ch1_price_stats              |
| SDG&E DLAP hours with negative day-ahead price, 2024     | 989   | hours | 77                   | 989                                            | ch1_price_stats              |
| SDG&E DLAP hours with negative day-ahead price, 2025     | 748   | hours | 80                   | 748                                            | ch1_price_stats              |
| NP15 hours with negative day-ahead price, 2024           | 271   | hours | 86                   | 271                                            | ch1_price_stats              |
| NP15 hours with negative day-ahead price, 2025           | 288   | hours | 94                   | 288                                            | ch1_price_stats              |
| SP15 hours with negative day-ahead price, 2024           | 1,169 | hours | 76                   | 1,169                                          | ch1_price_stats              |
| SP15 hours with negative day-ahead price, 2025           | 976   | hours | 78                   | 976                                            | ch1_price_stats              |
| ZP26 hours with negative day-ahead price, 2024           | 1,151 | hours | 78                   | 1,151                                          | ch1_price_stats              |
| ZP26 hours with negative day-ahead price, 2025           | 952   | hours | 80                   | 952                                            | ch1_price_stats              |
| CAISO wind and solar curtailment, 2024                   | 3,423 | GWh   | –                    | –                                              | ch3_caiso_curtailment_annual |
| CAISO wind and solar curtailment, 2025                   | 3,766 | GWh   | –                    | –                                              | ch3_caiso_curtailment_annual |
| CAISO wind and solar curtailment, Jan-Aug 2026           | 4,949 | GWh   | –                    | –                                              | ch3_caiso_curtailment_annual |
| flat load equivalent of 2025 curtailment (GWh / 8,760 h) | 430   | MW    | –                    | –                                              | derived                      |

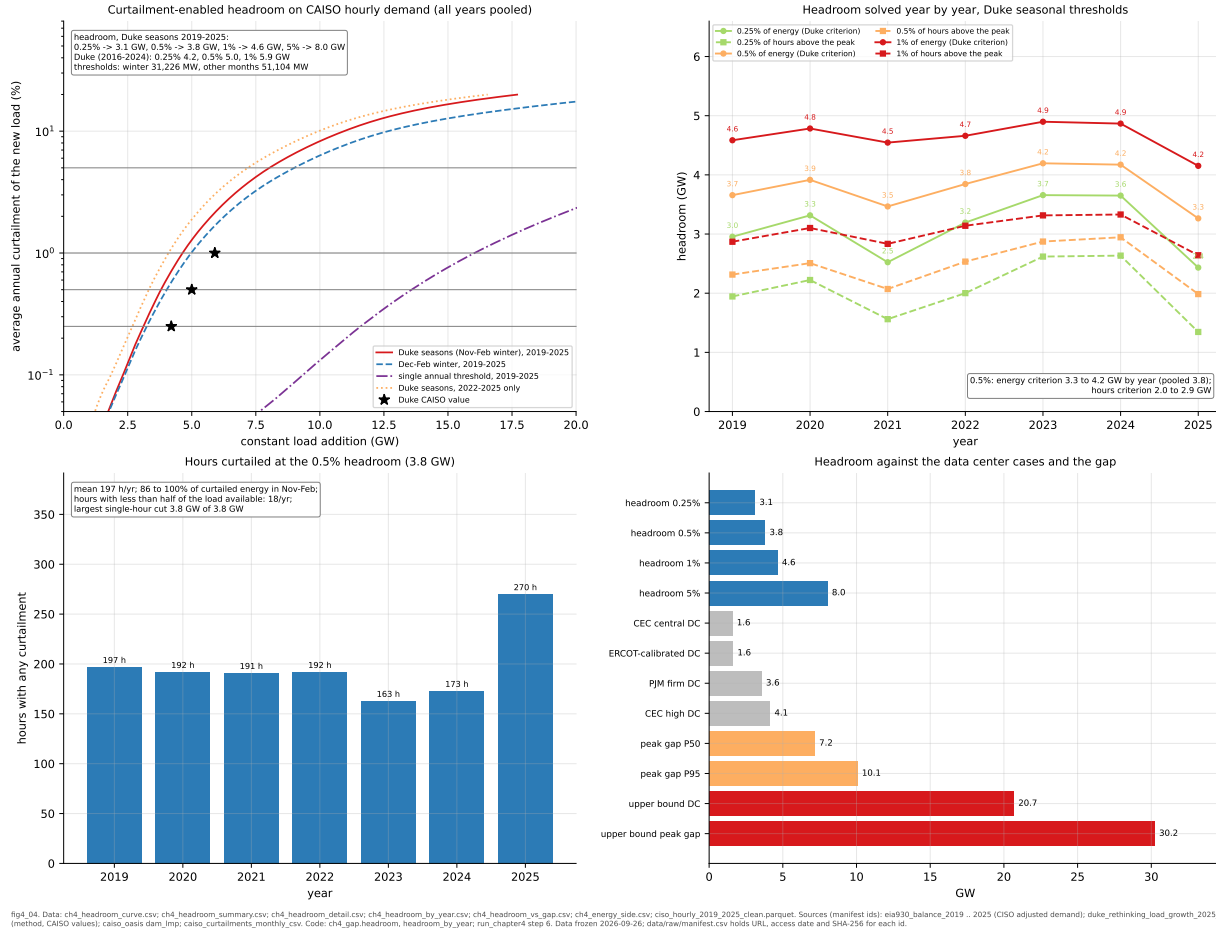


Figure 5.4: Top left: average annual curtailment of a constant load addition on CAISO demand 2019–2025 under four definitions, with Duke’s CAISO values. Top right: the headroom solved year by year under the energy and the hours criteria. Bottom left: hours curtailed each year at the 0.5 percent headroom. Bottom right: the headroom against the data center cases and the net-peak gap.

*Source line:* fig4\_04. Data: ch4\_headroom\_curve.csv; ch4\_headroom\_summary.csv; ch4\_headroom\_detail.csv; ch4\_headroom\_by\_year.csv; ch4\_headroom\_vs\_gap.csv; ch4\_energy\_side.csv; ciso\_hourly\_2019\_2025\_clean.parquet. Sources (manifest ids): eia930\_balance\_2019 .. 2025 (CISO adjusted demand); duke\_rethinking\_load\_growth\_2025\_mirror (method, CAISO values); caiso\_oasis\_dam\_lmp; caiso\_curtailments\_monthly\_csv. Code: ch4\_gap.headroom, headroom\_by\_year; run\_chapter4 step 6. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

**Flexible service in practice.** The headroom is usable only if a service exists to buy it. EPRI’s DCFlex initiative organizes utilities and operators around exactly that, with workstreams on data center design, programs, interconnection and planning readiness, field demonstrations, and a published “headroom framework” for assessing how much data center load a grid can integrate under its real constraints [Electric Power Research Institute, 2025]; the replication above is the California instance of that assessment. Finland has reached for the other lever. Manner reports its Parliament pushing data centers toward bringing their own power, and a hyperscaler answering, when asked whether it could drop consumption if the national grid ran short, that it had no incentive to do so [Manner, 2026]. The two levers are not exclusive: a load that arrives with its own generation

reduces the gap directly, and a load that accepts curtailment in a few hundred winter evening hours releases the 3.8 GW of Table 5.13 without new steel. The CEC’s utilization factor already assumes the first kind of restraint; no California tariff yet pays for the second.

## 5.5 Data and measurement regimes (RQ3)

**Crosswalk.** Table 5.19 compares seven regimes on granularity, stage taxonomy, verification, timeliness, coverage and public access: the CEC’s energization tiers [California Energy Commission, 2026d, Smith, 2026, Southern California Edison, 2026], ERCOT’s large-load interconnection reporting [ERCOT Large Load Integration Team, 2026, ERCOT, 2026b], PJM’s load forecast adjustments [Mooney, 2025, PJM Interconnection, 2026], EIA’s pilot data center surveys [U.S. Energy Information Administration, 2026f], Texas SB 6 with the PUCT rules that implement it [Texas Legislature, 2025, Vegas, 2026], and FERC Docket RM26-4 [Federal Energy Regulatory Commission, 2026a, California Independent System Operator, 2025, North American Electric Reliability Corporation, 2026a, Federal Energy Regulatory Commission, 2026b]. Only ERCOT reports monthly and by phase; only PJM publishes a firm and non-firm split with the discounts it applies; only EIA measures consumption rather than requests, and it has not yet published; Texas and the FERC docket set thresholds (75 and 20 MW) and verification duties (fees, security, disclosure) rather than data; and California’s tiers have no size threshold, no public deposit or site-control test, and project-level detail only where SCE chose to publish it. Table 5.20 and Figure 5.5 score each cell from 0 to 3 under a stated rubric: the EK registry scores highest (14 of 18) on granularity, taxonomy, coverage and access while scoring zero on verification, ERCOT 13 on the strength of its monthly, phase-by-phase reporting, the CEC tiers 10 with full coverage but weak verification and annual timing, PJM 8, Texas SB 6 and the FERC docket 7 each because they set duties rather than publish data, and the EIA pilot 4 because it is facility-level but unpublished and one-off. Table 5.21 maps the five stages that every regime distinguishes in some form, and Figure 5.6 draws the ERCOT time series that the stock-flow case was estimated from: 63 GW of tracked requests in December 2024, 239 GW in March 2026 before that month’s submissions, 411 GW two weeks later and 467 GW by July 2026, against approvals to energize that rose from 6.9 to 9.5 GW and observed load that stayed near 4 GW. PJM’s Table B-9 adds 33.7 GW of large-load adjustments above the embedded load to its 2030 summer peak (38.8 GW of total load associated with adjustments) against requests of roughly 60 GW in its preliminary November 2025 summary, of which about 35 GW were firm (Table 5.23).

Table 5.19: Crosswalk of seven large-load data and measurement regimes.

| Regime                                          | Granularity                                                                                                                                        | Stage taxonomy                                                                                                                                                         | Verification                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Timeliness                                                                                                                      | Coverage                                                                                                                                                                                          | Public access                                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>EK green-investment registry (Finland)</b>   | project level: company, municipality, technology, phase and MW on a public dashboard (Power BI); data centers are one of about twenty technologies | five phases: feasibility study, planning, investment decision, start of operations, discontinued                                                                       | compiled by the Confederation of Finnish Industries from company announcements and public plans; no deposit, study or agreement gating                                                                                                | continuously updated dashboard; Manner's snapshot is dated June 15 2026 (no archived vintages published)                        | nationwide, all announced projects regardless of size; data centers 7,777 MW registered on June 15 2026 (Manner) and 9,276 MW on September 15 2026 (the workbook), against about 285 MW operating | full project-level detail on the public dashboard and in a downloadable workbook (investor, municipality, phase, completion year, MW, source link)        |
| <b>CEC energization tiers (California)</b>      | MW by utility and tier, published as aggregates; project level only in SCE's public database (TN 266008, 268459)                                   | three groups: signed agreement, active application, inquiry (2026 IEPR proposes a longer milestone list from inquiry to ramp)                                          | utility-reported; no deposit or site-control test in the public record; confidence levels 70/33/0 or 100/50/10 applied by CEC staff                                                                                                   | annual IEPR data request (December 2024, summer 2025, December 2025 vintages); SCE database twice a year                        | no size threshold; seven utilities reported for the 2025 IEPR (VEA's 2,600 MW are in Nevada)                                                                                                      | docket documents and workshop decks; project-level detail confidential except SCE                                                                         |
| <b>ERCOT large load interconnection (Texas)</b> | MW by status, load zone, TSP, project type, size class and in-service year; monthly snapshots                                                      | no studies submitted; under ERCOT review; planning studies approved (Section 9.4/9.5 requirements met); approved to energize but not operational; observed energized   | TSP planning studies reviewed by ERCOT; observed energization measured from telemetry (non-simultaneous peak); Batch Zero (July 2026) adds attestations and a load information form; PUCT rule 25.194 proposes USD 50,000/MW security | monthly (ERCOT Monthly, operational overview, NPRR1267 status report approved July 2025); board and legislative decks quarterly | loads of 75 MW or more at a point of interconnection (SB 6 threshold); 20 MW co-located with a resource                                                                                           | aggregated public reports; customer identities confidential                                                                                               |
| <b>PJM load forecast adjustments</b>            | MW by zone and year 2026-2046 (Tables B-9, B-9b); firm and non-firm by zone in the LAS summary                                                     | firm (electric service obligation or construction commitment) versus non-firm (letters of authorization, feasibility studies, other agreements)                        | utility submissions reviewed by PJM: 70% utilization unless supported, ramps of at least 36 months, non-firm zero before 2030 and 50% from 2030 with national scaling                                                                 | annual cycle (requests July, review September to November, forecast January)                                                    | large load adjustments submitted by transmission owners; no MW threshold stated in the summary                                                                                                    | load report, tables and the Load Analysis Subcommittee decks are public; project lists are not                                                            |
| <b>EIA pilot data center surveys (federal)</b>  | facility-level consumption for at least one data center per company (196 companies identified)                                                     | operating facilities only; measures energy use, energy sources, site characteristics, servers and cooling                                                              | voluntary web survey (Texas, Washington) and interviews (Northern Virginia and DC)                                                                                                                                                    | pilot launched March 25 2026; no publication schedule yet                                                                       | three regions; California not included                                                                                                                                                            | results not yet published; EIA states the aim of faster cycles and finer detail                                                                           |
| <b>Texas SB 6 (2025)</b>                        | statute: disclosure duties per large load customer to the utility and ERCOT                                                                        | interconnection standards to be set by the PUCT; PUCT rule 25.370 (March 2026) counts only loads with an executed interconnection agreement in the forecast after 2026 | disclosure of similar requests elsewhere in the state and of on-site backup generation; flat study fee of at least USD 100,000; proposed USD 50,000/MW financial security (rule 25.194)                                               | standards and forecast rule in force from 2026; monthly ERCOT reporting continues                                               | demand of 75 MW or more (the PUCT may lower it); curtailment service for loads of at least 75 MW during emergencies                                                                               | utilities barred from selling or sharing customer submissions except to the PUCT and ERCOT                                                                |
| <b>FERC Docket RM26-4 (federal)</b>             | no data collection yet; the ANOPR (Oct 23 2025) proposes interconnection procedures for loads above 20 MW                                          | study, agreement and transition provisions modelled on Order No. 2023 (CAISO comments); June 18 2026 show cause orders name five categories of reform                  | to be set in each RTO/ISO tariff; the orders give the six RTOs/ISOs 60 days to justify or file revisions (CAISO Docket EL26-71-000)                                                                                                   | ANOPR Oct 2025; comments Nov 2025; FERC committed to act by June 2026 (Apr 16 2026) and issued the orders Jun 18 2026           | transmission-connected loads above 20 MW in the six RTO/ISO regions, about two-thirds of jurisdictional load                                                                                      | docket filings public through eLibrary (ferc.gov rejects non-browser clients, so only the CAISO and NERC filings and two news pages are in the raw store) |

Table 5.20: Scores 0 to 3 per criterion under the rubric below; the cells of Table 5.19 are the evidence.

| Regime                                   | Granularity | Stage taxonomy | Verification | Timeliness | Coverage | Public access | Total (of 18) |
|------------------------------------------|-------------|----------------|--------------|------------|----------|---------------|---------------|
| EK green-investment registry (Finland)   | 3           | 3              | 0            | 2          | 3        | 3             | 14            |
| CEC energization tiers (California)      | 1           | 2              | 1            | 1          | 3        | 2             | 10            |
| ERCOT large load interconnection (Texas) | 2           | 3              | 2            | 3          | 2        | 1             | 13            |
| PJM load forecast adjustments            | 2           | 1              | 2            | 1          | 1        | 1             | 8             |
| EIA pilot data center surveys (federal)  | 3           | 0              | 0            | 0          | 1        | 0             | 4             |
| Texas SB 6 (2025)                        | 0           | 1              | 3            | 1          | 2        | 0             | 7             |
| FERC Docket RM26-4 (federal)             | 0           | 1              | 1            | 1          | 2        | 2             | 7             |

Rubric: *granularity*: 0 no data product; 1 aggregates by utility, zone or tier; 2 aggregates by phase, zone, size class and year; 3 project or facility level; *stage taxonomy*: 0 operating facilities only; 1 one split (firm/non-firm or agreement/no agreement); 2 three groups; 3 five or more phases; *verification*: 0 none or voluntary self-report; 1 utility or staff review without money at risk; 2 study or agreement gating; 3 fees, financial security, disclosure duties and curtailment obligations; *timeliness*: 0 none or one-off pilot; 1 annual; 2 twice a year or quarterly; 3 monthly; *coverage*: 0 none; 1 partial (three regions or submitted adjustments only); 2 all loads above a threshold in the jurisdiction; 3 all requests regardless of size; *public access*: 0 not published or confidential; 1 aggregates only; 2 aggregates plus some project-level or docket detail; 3 full project-level detail.

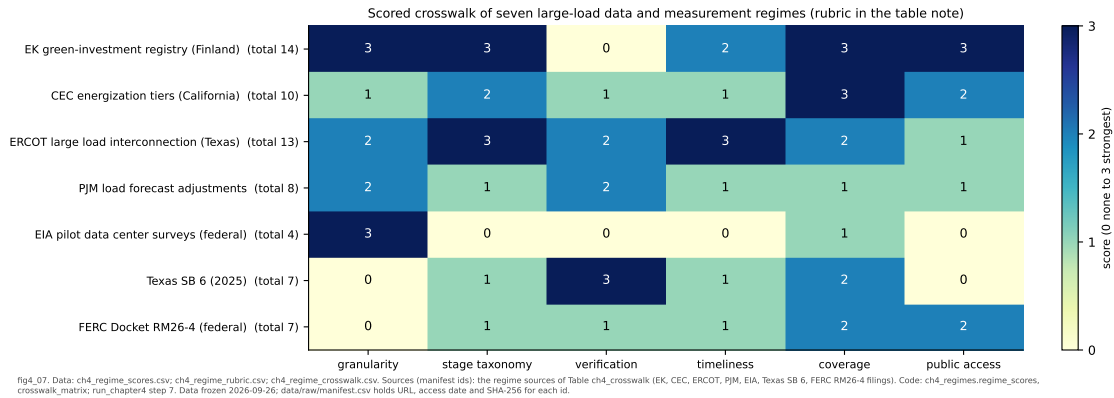


Figure 5.5: The scored crosswalk.

Source line: fig4\_07. Data: ch4\_regime\_scores.csv; ch4\_regime\_rubric.csv; ch4\_regime\_crosswalk.csv. Sources (manifest ids): the regime sources of Table ch4\_crosswalk (EK, CEC, ERCOT, PJM, EIA, Texas SB 6, FERC RM26-4 filings). Code: ch4\_regimes.regime\_scores, crosswalk\_matrix; run\_chapter4 step 7. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Table 5.21: A common taxonomy of pipeline stages and how each regime names them.

| common_stage                                 | EK registry (Finland)                                                  | CEC tiers                                                                            | ERCOT phases                                                | PJM firm / non-firm                                          | EIA pilot survey                                       | Texas SB 6 / PUCT                                                                                       | FERC RM26-4                                                 |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Inquiry or screening                       | Feasibility study (2,020 MW)                                           | Inquiry (Group 3)                                                                    | No studies submitted                                        | not counted (no adjustment without an agreement)             | not applicable (operating facilities)                  | screening study after the flat study fee                                                                | request submitted; study queue                              |
| 2 Application and study                      | Planning (3,310 MW)                                                    | Active application (Group 2)                                                         | Under ERCOT review                                          | non-firm: feasibility study, letter of authorization         | not applicable                                         | interconnection standards; intermediate agreement with site control and security (proposed rule 25.194) | study process (60-day study proposed for flexible loads)    |
| 3 Agreement or financial commitment          | Investment decision (within the 2,446 MW decided or dated by end-2027) | Signed agreement (Group 1)                                                           | Planning studies approved; 9.4/9.5 Section requirements met | firm: electric service obligation or construction commitment | not applicable                                         | interconnection agreement; USD 50,000/MW fee converts to non-refundable                                 | interconnection agreement; cost responsibility for upgrades |
| 4 Approved to energize or under construction | Start of operations known (within the 2,446 MW)                        | not distinguished (construction and initial energization in the 2026 milestone list) | Approved to energize but not operational                    | firm with ramp of at least 36 months                         | not applicable                                         | curtailment protocol before interconnection                                                             | transition provisions for loads already under study         |
| 5 Energized and observed                     | operating capacity, about 285 MW (half of it one Google site)          | existing load (about 1,000 MW peak, Dec 2025)                                        | Observed energized (all-time non-simultaneous peak)         | embedded in the historical load                              | surveyed consumption, energy sources, servers, cooling | curtailment during emergencies; telemetry to ERCOT                                                      | flexible service options                                    |

**The Finnish registry as a regime.** The EK registry that motivated the proposal is the seventh row of Tables 5.19 and 5.20 and the first column of Table 5.21. It is the only regime that publishes every project with its investor, municipality, phase, completion year and capacity, and it does so in a downloadable workbook as well as on a dashboard [Confederation of Finnish Industries (EK), 2026]; it scores 14 of 18, above ERCOT, and it does so with no verification at all, because it is compiled from company announcements with no deposit, study or agreement behind a phase. Its five phases map onto the common taxonomy directly: feasibility study to inquiry, planning to application, investment decision to agreement, start of operations to energized. Table 5.22 reads the September 15, 2026 workbook: 9,276 MW of data centers in the three phases before operation, in 127 projects, against the 7,777 MW Manner read from the dashboard three months earlier, and 238 MW that started operation since the registry began in 2021; 2,794 MW carry a completion year of 2027 or earlier and 4,382 MW carry no date at all. The largest single project, 560 MW

in Nurmijärvi, is the one Manner converted into electric cars (Section 3.6). Under the EK rule California's headline is the same 20,677 MW as under the CEC's (Table 5.24), because both count from the first expression of interest; the difference is that Finland's number can be traced project by project and California's cannot.

Table 5.22: Data center projects in the EK green-investment registry by phase, September 15 2026 workbook, with the megawatts dated for completion by 2027 and by 2029 and the values Manner read on June 15 2026 (his 2,446 MW combines investment decisions with dated starts of operation, so the phase rows do not match one to one).

| Phase                                                    | Projects | MW    | of which dated for completion by 2027 | by 2029 | undated | Manner, Jun 15 2026 (MW) |
|----------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------|---------------------------------------|---------|---------|--------------------------|
| 0. Feasibility study                                     | 55       | 2,750 | 0                                     | 490     | 2,260   | 2,020                    |
| 1. Planning                                              | 39       | 3,883 | 511                                   | 1,871   | 2,012   | 3,310                    |
| 2. Investment decision                                   | 33       | 2,642 | 2,282                                 | 2,532   | 110     | 2,446                    |
| 3. Start of operations                                   | 16       | 238   | 238                                   | 238     | 0       | —                        |
| 5. Discontinued                                          | 2        | 0     | 0                                     | 0       | 0       | —                        |
| Registered, all phases before operation                  | 127      | 9,276 | 2,794                                 | 4,894   | 4,382   | 7,777                    |
| Largest single project: DayOne, Nurmijärvi (1. Planning) | 1        | 560   | —                                     | —       | —       | 560                      |

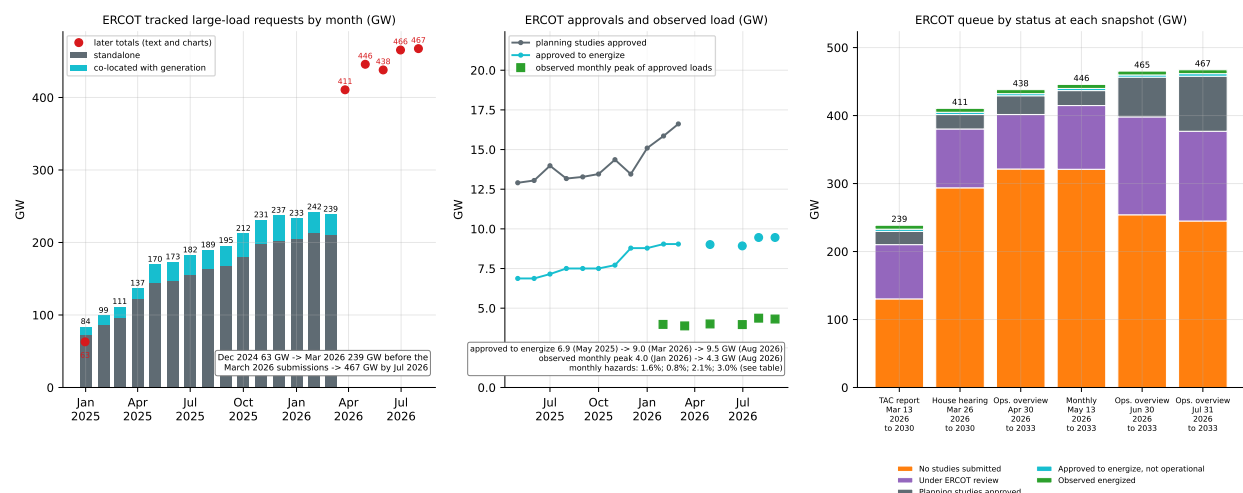


fig4\_05. Data: ch4\_ercot\_queue\_monthly.csv; ch4\_ercot\_approvals\_monthly.csv; ch4\_ercot\_status\_snapshots.csv; ch4\_ercot\_narrative.csv; ch4\_ercot\_transition\_rates.csv. Sources (manifest ids): ercot\_board\_2025\_12\_system\_planning; ercot\_tac\_2026\_03\_large\_load\_status; ercot\_monthly\_2025\_07..2026\_06; ercot\_house\_hearing\_2026\_04\_09; ercot\_board\_2026\_05\_interconnection\_update; ercot\_ops\_overview\_2026\_04..2026\_08. Code: ch4\_gap.ercot\_series, ercot\_transition\_rates; run\_chapter4 steps 2 and 7. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 5.6: ERCOT's large-load queue: tracked requests by month (left), planning studies approved, approvals to energize and observed monthly peaks of approved loads (middle), and the queue by status at each 2026 snapshot (right).

Source line: fig4\_05. Data: ch4\_ercot\_queue\_monthly.csv; ch4\_ercot\_approvals\_monthly.csv; ch4\_ercot\_status\_snapshots.csv; ch4\_ercot\_narrative.csv; ch4\_ercot\_transition\_rates.csv. Sources (manifest ids): ercot\_board\_2025\_12\_system\_planning; ercot\_tac\_2026\_03\_large\_load\_status; ercot\_monthly\_2025\_07..2026\_06; ercot\_house\_hearing\_2026\_04\_09; ercot\_board\_2026\_05\_interconnection\_update; ercot\_ops\_overview\_2026\_04..2026\_08. Code: ch4\_gap.ercot\_series, ercot\_transition\_rates; run\_chapter4 steps 2 and 7. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Table 5.23: PJM RTO large load adjustments to the summer peak (MW): the 2026 load forecast tables and the preliminary November 2025 summary chart.

| PJM RTO large load adjustment (MW)                             | 2026   | 2027   | 2028   | 2029   | 2030   | 2035   | 2040    | 2046    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|---------|---------|
| B-9 adjustments above embedded (RTO, Excel table)              | 6,403  | 10,785 | 16,242 | 22,290 | 33,707 | 63,796 | 77,450  | 81,810  |
| B-9b total load associated with adjustments (RTO, Excel table) | 11,469 | 15,856 | 21,280 | 27,361 | 38,805 | 68,968 | 82,648  | 87,186  |
| Requested (LAS chart, Nov 2025, approximate)                   | 14,000 | 21,000 | 32,000 | 46,000 | 60,000 | 98,000 | 110,000 | 115,000 |
| Firm (LAS chart)                                               | 13,000 | 18,000 | 23,000 | 27,000 | 35,000 | 53,000 | 58,000  | 61,000  |
| Non-firm (LAS chart)                                           | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      | 5,000  | 21,000 | 25,000  | 27,000  |

**California’s headline number under each rule.** Table 5.24 restates the same requests under each regime’s counting rule. The CEC and ERCOT both count every request regardless of study status, so the headline stays at 20,677 MW (23,277 with VEA). The Texas forecast rule that admits only executed interconnection agreements after 2026 and the PJM firm-only rule both give 5,086 MW, or 3,560 MW of demand at PJM’s utilization; ERCOT’s realized phase-transition rates would energize about 2,400 MW by 2030; and a consumption survey of the EIA type would report the roughly 1,000 MW that exists. Size thresholds cannot be applied to the CEC aggregates, but in SCE’s project-level database 76 percent of active requested megawatts are in projects of 75 MW or more and 95 percent in projects of 20 MW or more (Table 5.25), so the Texas and FERC thresholds would leave most of the capacity in scope while removing most of the projects.

Table 5.24: California’s December 2025 requests under each regime’s counting rule.

| Counting rule                                                          | California (MW) | What is counted                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EK-style (Finland): every registered project from feasibility study on | 20,677          | the EK registry lists every announced project regardless of phase, as the CEC tiers do; Finland’s own ratio is 7,777 MW registered (June 2026) or 9,276 MW (September 2026) to about 285 MW operating |
| CEC: all three tiers                                                   | 20,677          | requested capacity, signed agreements plus applications plus inquiries, California-only (Dec 2025)                                                                                                    |
| CEC: all tiers including VEA (Nevada)                                  | 23,277          | the CEC’s published statewide total                                                                                                                                                                   |
| CEC: agreements plus applications                                      | 12,073          | the comparison the CEC used between the 2024 and 2025 IEPR vintages                                                                                                                                   |
| ERCOT-style: every tracked request                                     | 20,677          | ERCOT reports all requests of 75 MW or more regardless of study status; the CEC tiers carry no size split, so the total is the same                                                                   |
| ERCOT-style: energized by 2030 at the ERCOT hazards                    | 2,421           | capacity expected to be energized within 60 months at the monthly phase-transition rates (before utilization)                                                                                         |
| PUCT rule 25.370 (Texas forecast): executed agreements only            | 5,086           | only loads with an executed interconnection agreement enter the forecast after 2026                                                                                                                   |
| PJM-style: firm only                                                   | 5,086           | electric service obligation or construction commitment; non-firm zero before 2030                                                                                                                     |
| PJM-style: firm at 70% utilization (demand)                            | 3,560           | PJM converts requests to demand at 70% utilization                                                                                                                                                    |
| Texas SB 6 threshold (75 MW and over)                                  | –               | not computable from the CEC aggregates; in SCE’s project-level database 76% of active requested MW is in projects of 75 MW or more                                                                    |
| FERC RM26-4 threshold (above 20 MW)                                    | –               | not computable from the CEC aggregates; in SCE’s database 95% of active requested MW is in projects of 20 MW or more                                                                                  |
| EIA pilot-style: measured consumption of existing facilities           | 1,000           | existing data center peak of about 1,000 MW (CEC, Dec 2025); 7.0 to 9.3 TWh a year in chapter 1                                                                                                       |

Table 5.25: Active requests in SCE’s public data center database (January 29 2026) by size class.

| Size class        | Projects | Requested (MW) | Share of active MW (%) |
|-------------------|----------|----------------|------------------------|
| under 20 MW       | 28       | 180            | 3                      |
| 20 to under 75 MW | 23       | 1,009          | 20                     |
| 75 MW and over    | 21       | 3,899          | 76                     |

## 5.6 Emissions of a flat against a curtailable load

The CAISO hourly accounting intensity of Chapter 2 gives the emissions of a 1 MW load that is flat, curtailed to zero in the highest-intensity 5, 10 or 25 percent of hours, or shifted, with the same energy moved from those hours into the lowest-intensity hours (Table 5.26, Figure 5.7). A flat load carried 183 t of CO<sub>2</sub> per GWh in 2025, down from 239 in 2023. Curtailing the highest-intensity quarter of hours lowers the intensity of what the load still consumes by 20 percent; shifting that energy into the lowest-intensity quarter, whose mean accounting intensity was 44 g/kWh in 2025, lowers it by 34 percent to 121 t per GWh. Flexibility therefore buys both the headroom of Section 5.4 and a third of the load’s emissions.

Table 5.26: Emissions intensity (t CO<sub>2</sub> per GWh consumed) of a 1 MW load that is flat, curtailed or shifted, CAISO accounting intensity 2023–2025.

| Strategy | Share of hours (%) | 2023 | 2024 | 2025 | Change vs flat, 2025 (%) |
|----------|--------------------|------|------|------|--------------------------|
| flat     | 0                  | 239  | 195  | 183  | 0                        |
| curtail  | 5                  | 233  | 187  | 175  | 4                        |
| shift    | 5                  | 223  | 176  | 165  | 10                       |
| curtail  | 10                 | 227  | 180  | 168  | 8                        |
| shift    | 10                 | 212  | 162  | 150  | 18                       |
| curtail  | 25                 | 210  | 159  | 146  | 20                       |
| shift    | 25                 | 190  | 133  | 121  | 34                       |

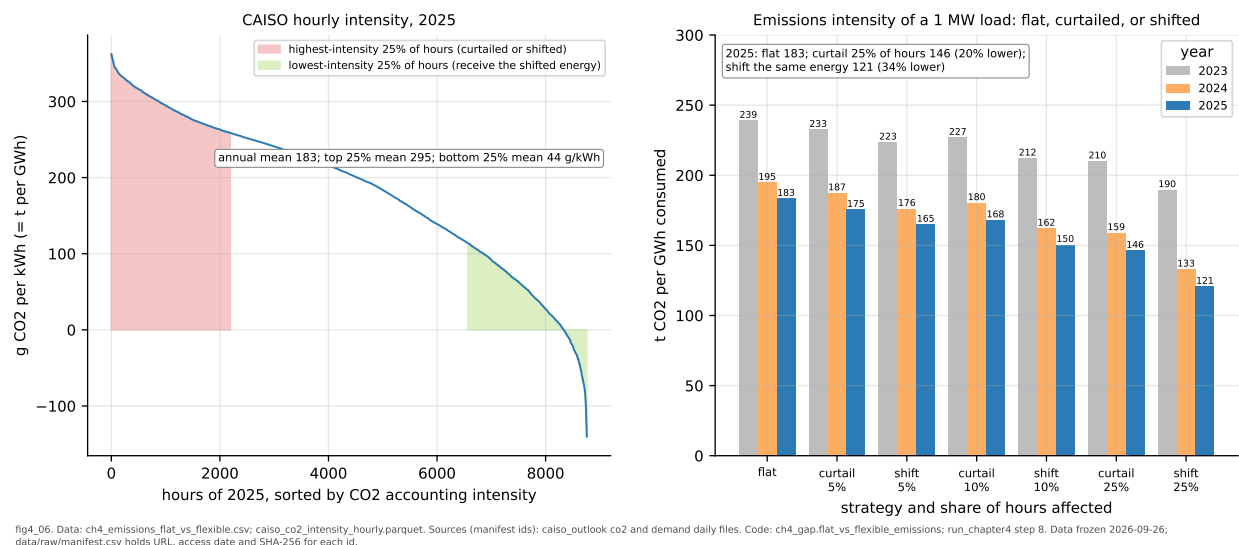


Figure 5.7: Left: CAISO hourly accounting intensity in 2025 sorted from highest to lowest, with the quarter of hours that a flexible load would avoid and the quarter that would receive the shifted energy. Right: emissions intensity of a flat, curtailed or shifted load, 2023–2025.

Source line: fig4\_06. Data: ch4\_emissions\_flat\_vs\_flexible.csv; caiso\_co2\_intensity\_hourly.parquet. Sources (manifest ids): caiso\_outlook co2 and demand daily files. Code: ch4\_gap.flat\_vs\_flexible\_emissions; run\_chapter4 step 8. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

## 5.7 Data centers as a share of California's electricity

The Oregon report that the advisor raised expresses its result as a share: 111 operating data centers used about 23 percent of Oregon's retail electricity sales in 2025 and are expected to reach nearly 25 TWh, 31 to 32 percent of the state's demand, by 2030 [Oregon Public Broadcasting, 2026]. Figure 5.8 and Table 5.27 draw the same trajectory for California from the record of this report. The history is the chapter 2 evidence: 3.9 percent of 2023 retail sales by EPRI's estimate and 2.9 to 3.4 percent of 2024 sales from the CEC's 1,000 MW converted. The forecast lines add the CED 2025 data center deliveries of each scenario, which are increments above the 2025 baseline, to the existing 7.0 to 9.3 TWh, and divide by the scenario's statewide energy to serve load, a denominator that includes the data centers themselves; the band is the width of the existing range. The two 2030 bounds of Section 5.1 are shown as points.

Under the adopted Planning forecast data centers reach 6.6 percent of California's electricity in 2030 (20 of 298 TWh), 10.8 percent in 2035 and 10.1 percent in 2040 (40 of 400 TWh); under the Local Reliability scenario 11.3 percent in 2030 (38 of 338 TWh), 13.5 percent in 2035 and 12.5 percent in 2040 (57 of 457 TWh). If every requested megawatt ran flat by 2030 the share would be 40 percent (189 of 467 TWh), and 29 percent at the CEC's utilization (115 of 393 TWh). Oregon's 23 percent today is above California's 2040 Local Reliability share; California's upper bound is above Oregon's 2030 projection. The denominators differ between the history and the forecast rows (retail sales against energy to serve load, which includes losses), so the 2025 forecast point of 3.2 percent sits slightly below the 2023 history point for the same load; Table 5.27 states the basis of each row.

Table 5.27: Data centers as a share of California’s electricity: history, the CED 2025 scenarios at 2025, 2030, 2035 and 2040, and the 2030 bounds, with the denominator of each row.

| Series                                                       | Year | Added (TWh) | Data centers total (TWh) | Denominator (TWh) | Denominator basis                                             | Share (%) |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|------|-------------|--------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| CED 2025 Planning: existing plus forecast additions          | 2025 | 0.7         | 7.7–10.1                 | 263.2             | statewide energy to serve load, Planning (Form 1.5a)          | 2.9–3.8   |
| CED 2025 Planning: existing plus forecast additions          | 2030 | 12.1        | 19.1–21.4                | 298.2             | statewide energy to serve load, Planning (Form 1.5a)          | 6.4–7.2   |
| CED 2025 Planning: existing plus forecast additions          | 2035 | 30.7        | 37.7–40.0                | 355.8             | statewide energy to serve load, Planning (Form 1.5a)          | 10.6–11.2 |
| CED 2025 Planning: existing plus forecast additions          | 2040 | 32.6        | 39.6–42.0                | 399.9             | statewide energy to serve load, Planning (Form 1.5a)          | 9.9–10.5  |
| CED 2025 Local Reliability: existing plus forecast additions | 2025 | 0.9         | 7.9–10.3                 | 263.4             | statewide energy to serve load, Local Reliability (Form 1.5a) | 3.0–3.9   |
| CED 2025 Local Reliability: existing plus forecast additions | 2030 | 30.3        | 37.3–39.7                | 338.1             | statewide energy to serve load, Local Reliability (Form 1.5a) | 11.0–11.7 |
| CED 2025 Local Reliability: existing plus forecast additions | 2035 | 48.4        | 55.4–57.7                | 415.2             | statewide energy to serve load, Local Reliability (Form 1.5a) | 13.3–13.9 |
| CED 2025 Local Reliability: existing plus forecast additions | 2040 | 49.5        | 56.6–58.9                | 456.6             | statewide energy to serve load, Local Reliability (Form 1.5a) | 12.4–12.9 |
| History: EPRI statewide estimate 2023                        | 2023 | 0.0         | 9.3                      | 239.5             | EIA-861 California retail sales 2023                          | 3.9       |
| History: CEC 1,000 MW converted, 2024 sales                  | 2024 | 0.0         | 7.0–8.3                  | 245.7             | EIA-861 California retail sales 2024                          | 2.9–3.4   |
| Upper bound 2030: every MW builds, flat load                 | 2030 | 181.1       | 188.1–190.5              | 467.2             | Planning 2030 non-data-center energy plus the bound           | 40.3–40.6 |
| Upper bound 2030 at CEC utilization                          | 2030 | 106.8       | 113.8–116.1              | 392.9             | Planning 2030 non-data-center energy plus the bound           | 29.0–29.4 |

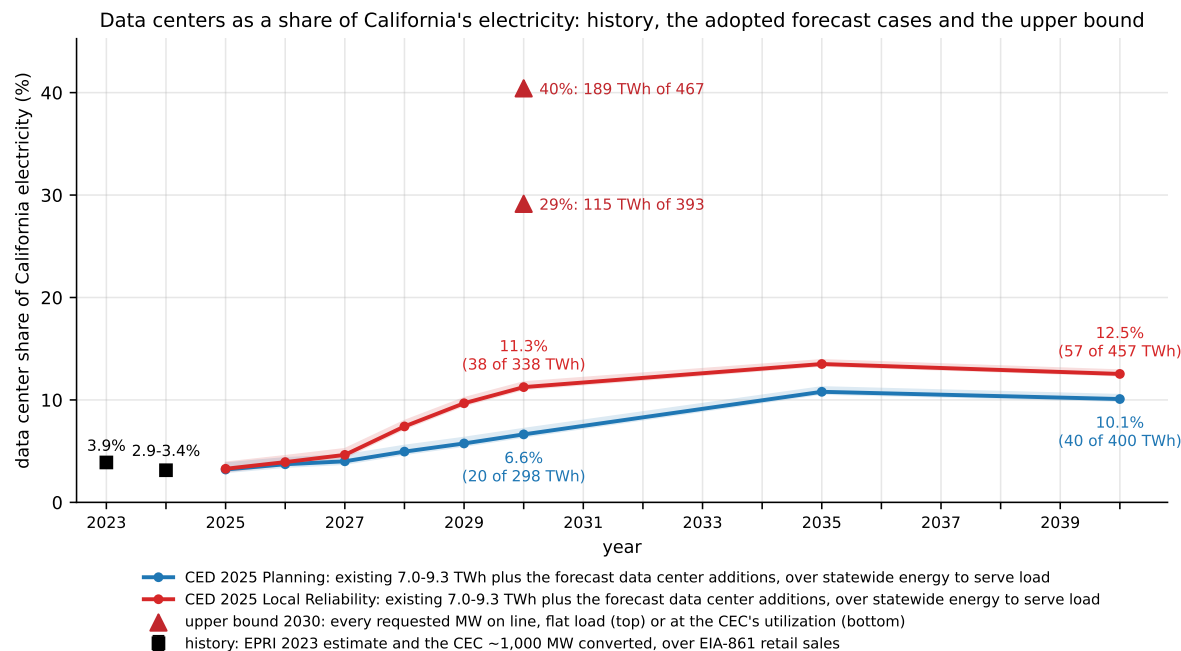


fig4\_08. Data: ch4\_dc\_share\_trajectory.csv; ch1\_dc\_load\_estimates.csv; ch4\_ced2025\_data\_center\_energy.csv; ch4\_ced2025\_scenarios.csv; ch4\_demand\_cases\_2030.csv. Sources (manifest ids): epri\_powering\_intelligence\_2024; cec\_dc\_methodology\_memo\_2026; eia861\_2019 .. 2024; cec\_tn268727; cec\_tn268725; cec\_tn268824; cec\_tn268124; cec\_assembly\_hearing\_2026\_01\_28. Code: run\_chapter4 step 9. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

Figure 5.8: Data centers as a share of California's electricity, 2023 to 2040: the two history points over EIA-861 retail sales, the CED 2025 Planning and Local Reliability trajectories (existing 7.0 to 9.3 TWh plus the forecast additions, over statewide energy to serve load) and the two 2030 upper bounds. Oregon's report gives 23 percent in 2025 and 31 to 32 percent in 2030 for comparison.

Source line: fig4\_08. Data: ch4\_dc\_share\_trajectory.csv; ch1\_dc\_load\_estimates.csv; ch4\_ced2025\_data\_center\_energy.csv; ch4\_ced2025\_scenarios.csv; ch4\_demand\_cases\_2030.csv. Sources (manifest ids): epri\_powering\_intelligence\_2024; cec\_dc\_methodology\_memo\_2026; eia861\_2019 .. 2024; cec\_tn268727; cec\_tn268725; cec\_tn268824; cec\_tn268124; cec\_assembly\_hearing\_2026\_01\_28. Code: run\_chapter4 step 9. Data frozen 2026-09-26; data/raw/manifest.csv holds URL, access date and SHA-256 for each id.

## 5.8 What the chapter answers

RQ2: with the CEC's tiers weighted by realization, utilization and ramp and the supply side weighted by California's own completion record, the 2030 gap is 50 TWh (19 to 78) and 7.2 GW (4.2 to 10.1) at the net peak, of which data centers are 18 TWh and 2.3 GW at the median; the rest is ordinary load growth and the retirements and slow additions of the supply side. The proposal's upper bound of 202 to 242 TWh and 25 to 30 GW is four to five times the weighted 95th percentile. RQ4: curtailment-enabled headroom of 3.8 GW at 0.5 percent (3.3 to 4.2 GW year by year, or 2.0 to 2.9 GW if every hour above the peak counts) is enough to place the probability-weighted data center load two times over and half of the whole weighted peak gap, but 18 percent of the upper bound, and the surplus midday energy that a flexible load could use is real and growing. RQ3: the same requests are 20,677 MW under the CEC's, ERCOT's and the EK registry's rules, 5,086 MW under the PJM and Texas forecast rules, about 2,400 MW at ERCOT's realized transition rates and about 1,000 MW of measured load; the regimes differ most in timeliness (monthly in ERCOT, annual elsewhere), verification (deposits and agreements in Texas and PJM, none in California's public record) and public access (aggregates everywhere, project-level detail only from SCE).

## Chapter 6

# Discussion and Policy

### 6.1 The contribution restated

This report is an independent replication and audit of the California Energy Commission’s data center forecast method, carried out on public data with every assumption written down, varied and tested against outside evidence. It does not propose a competing forecast. It shows what the CEC’s published parameters produce when applied to the CEC’s published request data, where the result matches the Commission’s own numbers and where it does not, what the same discipline does to the supply side, and how much of the resulting gap the assumptions that people argue about actually move.

Three results carry the argument. The CEC’s confidence levels of 70/33/0 and 100/50/10 percent, its 67 percent utilization factor and the exemption of Silicon Valley Power’s requests reproduce the Commission’s 2040 endpoints of 4,855 and 7,381 MW to within 1 MW, and its ramp profile reproduces the 2030 components within 2 and 6 percent (Table 5.4). The forecast is therefore transparent in the strict sense: anyone with the request table and the memo can rebuild it. Second, when the supply side is discounted with a completion model estimated on California’s own planned generators, a third of the 2030 planned list disappears and the weighted fleet adds on average 5 TWh and 1.1 GW of ELCC by 2030 once retirements are netted (Table 5.10), so the gap that opens is mostly not a data center gap. Third, the proposal’s upper bound of every requested megawatt operating flat is four to five times the probability-weighted 95th percentile, which is the quantitative form of the point Manner made for Finland: the registry number and the load that will exist are different quantities, and the difference is the object of study rather than an error to be corrected.

### 6.2 What the audit found about each assumption

Table 6.1 is the register that the phrase “transparent, tested assumptions” refers to: every assumption behind the gap, the headroom and the crosswalk, with its value or range, the document it rests on, the test applied and what the test showed. It is generated from the chapter outputs, so its numbers are the ones in the tables of Chapter 5. The paragraphs that follow read the register.

Table 6.1: Assumption register: value or range, source, test and result for every assumption behind the results. Generated from the chapter outputs.

| Assumption                                                | Value or range                                                                                                                                                                  | Source                                                                                                       | How it was tested and what the test showed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tier confidence levels                                    | Planning 0.70 / 0.33 / 0.00; Local Reliability 1.00 / 0.50 / 0.10 (agreement / application / inquiry); MC triangular 0.50 / 0.70 / 1.00, 0.10 / 0.33 / 0.50, 0.00 / 0.03 / 0.10 | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 Table 2; ERCOT chain and PJM rule as yardsticks                                 | Replication: with SVP exempt the levels reproduce the memo's 2040 endpoints (4,855 vs 4,855 MW; 7,381 vs 7,381). ERCOT chain gives 37 / 6 / 2% over 60 months. One-at-a-time: agreements energy gap 53 to 58 TWh, peak gap 6.6 to 7.3 GW between its 5th and 95th percentiles; Sobol total index 0.01 (energy), 0.02 (peak); applications energy gap 52 to 58 TWh, peak gap 6.5 to 7.3 GW between its 5th and 95th percentiles; Sobol total index 0.01 (energy), 0.02 (peak); inquiries energy gap 55 to 56 TWh, peak gap 6.8 to 7.1 GW between its 5th and 95th percentiles; Sobol total index 0.00 (energy), 0.00 (peak) |
| SVP exemption from the confidence levels                  | SVP's 1,038 MW at full confidence                                                                                                                                               | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 p. 9                                                                            | Without the exemption the parameters give 4,505 MW instead of the memo's 4,855 MW in 2040 (difference 350 MW); with it the endpoints match to within 1 MW                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Utilization factor                                        | 0.67 (CEC); MC triangular 0.46 / 0.67 / 0.70                                                                                                                                    | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 p. 8 (upper end of SVP's observed range); ERCOT observed 0.46 to 0.64; PJM 0.70 | Yardsticks bracket the value; one-at-a-time energy gap 52 to 57 TWh, peak gap 6.4 to 7.2 GW between its 5th and 95th percentiles; Sobol total index 0.01 (energy), 0.02 (peak)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Ramp: share of realized capacity on line by 2030          | CEC profile 36% (Planning), 60% (Local Reliability); PJM 36-month rule 100%; MC triangular 0.30 / 0.55 / 1.00                                                                   | cec_tn268124 annual peaks (component by year); pjm_lar_summary_2025_11_24                                    | Replicated 2030 components 1,549 and 3,896 MW vs published 1,583 and 4,135; one-at-a-time energy gap 49 to 63 TWh, peak gap 6.0 to 8.1 GW between its 5th and 95th percentiles; Sobol total index 0.06 (energy), 0.14 (peak)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Data center load factor (energy per MW of peak)           | 0.88; MC triangular 0.80 / 0.88 / 0.95                                                                                                                                          | chapter 1 range; cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 p. 11 (85 to 90%)                                              | One-at-a-time energy gap 54 to 56 TWh, peak gap 6.9 to 6.9 GW between its 5th and 95th percentiles; Sobol total index 0.00 (energy), 0.00 (peak)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Data center load flat and coincident with the system peak | coincidence 1.0                                                                                                                                                                 | cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026 p. 11 (85 to 90% of annual maximum at the CAISO peak)                           | Not varied in the draws; at the CEC's 85% the median data center peak contribution of 2,292 MW would fall by 344 MW                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 2030 data center energy annualized at the end-2030 level  | energy = end-2030 MW x 8,760 h x load factor                                                                                                                                    | construction of the case                                                                                     | With the CEC ramp profile the calendar-2030 average is 86% of the end-2030 level, so the case overstates calendar-2030 data center energy by about 14%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Generation completion (planned units)                     | per-unit logit probability p_2030 from chapter 3 (229 units, 20.1 GW; weighted 13.2 GW)                                                                                         | eia860m_2016_01 .. 2022_01 vintages, eia860m_2016_12 .. 2025_12 outcomes, eia860m_2026_07 planned list       | Three logit specifications agree on the ranking (Table 4.8); realized fraction 5th to 95th percentile 0.58 to 0.73; one-at-a-time energy gap 57 to 54 TWh, peak gap 7.7 to 6.2 GW between its 5th and 95th percentiles; Sobol total index 0.00 (energy), 0.07 (peak)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

| Assumption                             | Value or range                                                                                                                                                      | Source                                                                                                    | How it was tested and what the test showed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Capacity factors of the existing fleet | 2023-2025 means by resource; hydro drawn from its 2010-2025 range; solar and wind within 10%                                                                        | eia923_2010 .. 2025, eia860_2010 .. 2025                                                                  | Hydro: energy gap 66 to 46 TWh, peak gap 6.9 to 6.9 GW between its 5th and 95th percentiles; Sobol total index 0.11 (energy), 0.00 (peak). Solar and wind: energy gap 61 to 50 TWh, peak gap 6.9 to 6.9 GW between its 5th and 95th percentiles; Sobol total index 0.03 (energy), 0.00 (peak)        |
| ELCC values                            | CPUC/E3-Astrape 2023 Tranche 6 for solar 0.088, wind 0.147, batteries 0.765, pumped storage 0.887; firm resources 0.90 to 0.95 and hydro 0.45 to 0.55 by assumption | cpuc_e3_astrape_incremental_elcc_2023; stated assumptions                                                 | Not drawn; deterministic check on the weighted new capacity: battery ELCC 0.60 or 0.90 instead of 0.765 moves the peak gap by +1.2 or -0.9 GW; a gas derate of 0.90 instead of 0.95 on new gas moves it by +0.00 GW (existing-fleet ELCC cancels in the incremental gap)                             |
| Scheduled retirements                  | 6.5 GW through 2030 at EIA-860M dates and OTC compliance dates, of which Diablo Canyon 2.3 GW                                                                       | eia860m_2026_07; swrcb_otc_policy_2023                                                                    | Diablo Canyon as a Bernoulli(0.5) switch: energy gap 64 to 46 TWh, peak gap 8.0 to 5.8 GW between its 5th and 95th percentiles; Sobol total index 0.25 (energy), 0.39 (peak); NRC licences renewed April 2 2026, SB 846 stops at 2030 (gov_ca_diablo_license_2026_04_02, nrc_diablo_canyon_rod_2026) |
| Net imports in 2030                    | triangular 62.16 / 62.16 / 99.21 TWh                                                                                                                                | cec_elec_energy_generation_page (CEC statewide net imports 2012-2024)                                     | One-at-a-time energy gap 65 to 37 TWh, peak gap 6.9 to 6.9 GW between its 5th and 95th percentiles; Sobol total index 0.24 (energy), 0.00 (peak)                                                                                                                                                     |
| Non-data-center demand growth          | IEPR case drawn with equal weights: low = Planning, mid = Baseline, high = Local Reliability                                                                        | cec_tn268727, cec_tn268722, cec_tn268725 (CED 2025 forms); cec_tn268124; cec_tn268824                     | One-at-a-time energy gap 38 to 60 TWh, peak gap 5.3 to 7.8 GW between its 5th and 95th percentiles; Sobol total index 0.28 (energy), 0.35 (peak); the Local Reliability plus known loads case is reported separately (Table 5.2)                                                                     |
| Planning reserve margin                | uniform 0.15 to 0.17                                                                                                                                                | assumption (CPUC resource adequacy range); no raw file                                                    | One-at-a-time energy gap 55 to 55 TWh, peak gap 6.8 to 7.0 GW between its 5th and 95th percentiles; Sobol total index 0.00 (energy), 0.00 (peak)                                                                                                                                                     |
| ERCOT phase-transition hazards         | Planning studies approved 1.56%/month; Under ERCOT review 0.75%/month; No studies submitted 2.12%/month; Approved to energize 3.05%/month                           | ercot_tac_2026_03_large_load_status; ercot_monthly_2025_11; ERCOT status snapshots (Table tab:ercotrates) | Hazards doubled: 72 / 25 / 12% energized in 60 months; 0.5%/month cancellation: 33 / 5 / 1%; no-studies hazard is an upper bound                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Headroom thresholds and seasons        | maximum winter (Nov-Feb) and non-winter demand across 2019-2025; Duke's energy criterion                                                                            | duke_rethinking_load_growth_2025_mirror; eia930_balance_2019 .. 2025                                      | 0.5% headroom 3,798 MW; Dec-Feb winter 4,023; 2022-2025 only 3,322; single threshold 13,578; per-year hours criterion in Table 5.15                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Emissions of a flexible load           | curtail or shift the highest-intensity 5, 10 or 25% of hours; CAISO accounting intensity                                                                            | caiso_outlook_co2_and_demand_daily_files                                                                  | 2025: flat 183 t/GWh; curtail 25% 146; shift 25% 121; smaller shares in Table 5.26                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Regime scores                          | 0 to 3 per criterion under a stated rubric                                                                                                                          | ch4_regime_rubric.csv; the crosswalk cells                                                                | Descriptive cells published next to the scores so a reader can rescore (Tables 5.19 and 5.20)                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

| Assumption                                              | Value or range                                                                                   | Source                                                                                   | How it was tested and what the test showed                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Existing data center energy in the share trajectory     | 7.0 to 9.3 TWh (EPRI 2023 estimate and the CEC 1,000 MW converted at a 0.80 to 0.95 load factor) | epri_powering_intelligence_2024; cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026; ch1_dc_load_estimates.csv | Carried as a band: the 2030 Planning share runs from 6.4 to 7.2 percent across it (Table 5.27); the denominators (retail sales for the history, energy to serve load for the forecast) are stated per row |
| Electric-car energy per year (workshop comparison only) | 3 MWh per car per year (20 kWh per 100 km over 15,000 km)                                        | Manner 2026 slide 13 (manner2026); no California per-vehicle figure in the record        | Used only to express the requests in car-years (Table 3.12); it enters no gap, headroom or crosswalk result; halving or doubling it halves or doubles the car counts                                      |

**Confidence levels.** The CEC’s 70/33/0 percent for agreements, applications and inquiries sit above what ERCOT’s realized phase-transition rates would give over the same 60 months (37, 6 and 2 percent, Table 5.8) and, for agreements, below the 100 percent that PJM’s firm rule and the CEC’s own Local Reliability scenario assign. The ERCOT rates were measured while its queue quadrupled, so they measure study throughput as much as project viability, but they are the only empirical phase-transition evidence in the public record, and the CEC’s central values are not conservative against it. The sensitivity analysis shows that this matters less than it seems: the three tier probabilities together carry about 2 percent of the variance of the energy gap and 4 percent of the peak gap (Table 5.12).

**Utilization.** The 67 percent factor is the upper end of what SVP observed among its existing customers, by the memo’s own account. ERCOT’s observed monthly peaks of approved loads run at 46 to 64 percent of approved capacity depending on the month and the definition (Table 5.7, Figure 5.6); PJM uses 70 percent unless a utility supports more. The CEC’s value is in the middle of that evidence and is defensible.

**Ramp.** The CEC’s ramp puts 36 percent of the Planning forecast’s full demand on line by 2030 and 60 percent of the Local Reliability scenario’s (Table 5.5). PJM’s minimum 36-month ramp would put all of a December 2025 agreement on line by 2030. The ramp is the data center assumption with the largest effect on the peak gap (a 2.2 GW swing between its 5th and 95th percentiles, Table 5.11), which argues for publishing the utility schedules it rests on.

**The SVP exemption and the Nevada request.** Two features of the CEC forecast are not visible in its headline numbers. SVP’s 1,038 MW of requests enter at full confidence, which is 350 MW of the Planning forecast’s 2040 endpoint. VEA’s 2,600 MW application is in Nevada but inside the CAISO balancing area, so it appears in the CAISO data center component (160 and 242 MW in 2030) and in the 23,277 MW statewide total. Both are legitimate choices; both should be stated where the totals are published.

**The supply side.** The CEC discounts requests but the resource planning process does not discount planned generation in the same public way. California’s own record says it should: 65 percent of the megawatts on the January planned lists of 2016 to 2022 were operating by December 2025, with gas at 44 percent and geothermal at 6 percent (Table 4.6), and the model-weighted 2030 list loses a third of its capacity. The realization model is the symmetric counterpart of the confidence levels and is the part of this audit most worth carrying into the state’s own process.

## 6.3 What the gap is, and what it is not

The gap reported in Chapter 5 is an increment: the growth of demand from 2025 to 2030 minus the growth of supply at recent operating patterns. Its median of 50 TWh and 7.2 GW is not a forecast of blackouts. It is the amount that has to come from somewhere other than the probability-weighted pipeline: from the existing gas fleet running harder (a capacity factor of 0.40 rather than 0.24 would close the median energy gap), from imports that have fallen from 103 to 62 TWh since 2012 and could rise again, from Diablo Canyon operating past 2030, from load flexibility, or from resources that are not yet on the planned list. The 2025 system already meets its peak with in-state resources plus imports, and the incremental gap says that the same position in 2030 needs 4 to 10 GW more than the weighted pipeline delivers. Data centers are about a third of that at the median and a smaller share of its uncertainty. The energy gap moves with imports, the non-data-center forecast, hydro and Diablo Canyon; the peak gap with Diablo Canyon, the forecast case, the ramp and generation completion (Figure 5.3).

The upper bound is different in kind. Twenty gigawatts of flat load added to a 46 GW system is not a scenario the state’s planning process can absorb, and no counting regime in the crosswalk treats it as one. Its value is as the ceiling that the confidence levels, utilization and ramp are discounting from, and the audit shows the discount to be a factor of thirteen in the CEC’s central case.

**The wider picture.** Nationally, LBNL puts data centers at 176 TWh and 4.4 percent of United States electricity consumption in 2023 and at 325 to 580 TWh, 6.7 to 12 percent, by 2028 [Shehabi et al., 2024]; the IEA puts the world at 415 TWh and 1.5 percent in 2024, with the United States 45 percent of that, and its base case at 945 TWh by 2030 [International Energy Agency, 2025]. California’s 3 to 4 percent (Chapter 2) is the national share, not an outlier. The supply side is tightening in the same way as it does here: LBNL’s queue study finds that active interconnection capacity fell 10 percent in 2025 to 2,061 GW, with 1,312 GW of generation and 749 GW of storage still waiting while gas requests grew [Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory, 2026]; NERC’s assessment adds 224 GW of summer peak demand over ten years with data centers the dominant driver [North American Electric Reliability Corporation, 2026b]; and Grid Strategies notes that utility forecasts sum to 166 GW of peak growth by 2030, about 90 GW of it data centers, against market analysts’ figure of about 65 GW [Grid Strategies, 2025], the same gap between requests and expectation that the tiers measure in California. On emissions, the UNECE lifecycle assessment gives natural gas combined cycle without capture 403 to 513 g CO<sub>2</sub>e per kWh, onshore wind 7.8 to 16 and nuclear 5.1 to 6.4 [United Nations Economic Commission for Europe, 2022]. The flat-against-flexible result of Section 5.6, 183 against 121 t per GWh at a 25 percent shift, is the operating-hour counterpart of that lifecycle spread: what a data center emits in California depends less on which plant is built for it than on which hours it runs.

## 6.4 Policy implications

**For the CEC: publish the request data at the level the audit needed.** Everything in Section 6.2 was possible only because the memo states its parameters and SCE chose to publish its project-level database. The rest of the tiers are aggregates by utility. Publishing every request with its size class, requested energization year, tier and status history, as SCE already does and as ERCOT does in aggregate, would let the confidence levels be estimated from California’s own attrition rather than asserted, would make the size thresholds of Texas and FERC applicable (in

SCE's database 76 percent of active megawatts are in projects of 75 MW or more), and would make duplicate requests across utilities detectable.

**For the CEC: report monthly and by phase.** ERCOT scores highest of the American regimes on the crosswalk because it publishes its queue every month by phase, and that series is what made the stock-flow case possible (Figure 5.6). An annual vintage cannot distinguish a project that advanced from one that was replaced. A monthly or quarterly publication of the tiers with the common taxonomy of Table 5.21 would cost little and would let the state estimate its own transition rates within two years.

**For the CEC and the CPUC: separate firm from non-firm and say so.** PJM's rule, that only projects with a service obligation or construction commitment count in the near term, and the Texas forecast rule, that only executed interconnection agreements enter the forecast after 2026, both give California 5,086 MW (Table 5.24). The CEC's Planning forecast already effectively does this through the zero weight on inquiries and the third weight on applications, but it presents the result as a single number. Publishing the firm and non-firm components separately, with the discount applied to each, would make the forecast comparable with PJM's and would make the choice of confidence level visible.

**For the CPUC and CAISO: offer the flexible service the headroom pays for.** The replicated headroom of 3.1 to 4.6 GW at 0.25 to 1 percent curtailment (Table 5.13) is larger than every probability-weighted data center case and about equal to PJM's firm-only case, and almost all of the curtailment falls in a few hundred winter evening hours. FERC's June 2026 orders ask CAISO to propose new transmission services for flexible large loads [Federal Energy Regulatory Commission, 2026b]; the headroom numbers are the evidence for what such a service could offer in California, and the negative-price hours and 3.8 TWh of curtailed wind and solar are the energy the same load could absorb.

**For the resource planning process: weight the supply side.** A completion probability by technology and construction status, estimated as in Chapter 4 and updated each year from EIA-860M, should sit next to the confidence levels in the same forecast set. The two pumped-storage projects on the 2030 list, whose approvals have not been initiated, are the clearest case: 1,600 MW of nameplate that the model weights at 13 percent.

**For the Legislature: the Diablo Canyon decision is the largest single lever.** The plant's status moves the median energy gap by 18 TWh and the peak gap by 2.2 GW, more than any data center assumption. The federal licences are in hand and state law stops at 2030; the decision belongs to the Legislature and should be taken with the 2030 balance in view, not after it.

**For the federal data effort.** EIA's pilot survey covers Texas, Washington and Northern Virginia and not California [U.S. Energy Information Administration, 2026f]. A California sample would replace the four-way range of existing use in Chapter 2 (7.0 to 9.3 TWh, about 1,000 MW) with a measurement.

**What other states have done.** Virginia, the largest market, shows the cost of not discounting. JLARC's 2024 study for the legislature found that unconstrained demand for power in Virginia would double within the next ten years, with data centers the driver [Joint Legislative Audit and

Review Commission, 2024], and PJM’s capacity price rose from 28.92 USD per MW-day for 2024/25 to 269.92 for 2025/26 and 329.17 for 2026/27, an increase that the market monitor attributes 63 percent, or 9.3 billion USD in one year, to data centers [Kunkel, 2025]; PJM’s firm and non-firm rule (Section 5.5) is the planning response. Texas SB 6 sits at the other end, with disclosure duties, fees and a curtailment obligation before interconnection (Table 5.19). Between them are the first large-load rate statutes: Minnesota’s section 216B.1622 directs its commission to define a very large customer class by December 15, 2026 [Minnesota Legislature, 2025], and Oregon’s POWER Act, HB 3546, directs its commission to create a service classification for large energy use facilities [Oregon Legislative Assembly, 2025]; the Sierra Club’s fifty-state scan of January 2026 catalogues the ratepayer-protection, siting and pollution provisions states are adopting [Sierra Club, 2026]. California’s SB 57 and SB 886 (Section 2.5) belong to that family. What none of these statutes does is publish the request data at the level the audit above needed, which is why the first recommendation of this section is a data recommendation.

## 6.5 Limitations

The boundaries do not all coincide. Load, prices and carbon are CAISO’s; generation, capacity and the forecast are statewide; the incremental form of the gap cancels the level mismatch but not the geography, and the absolute peak balance leaves out imports’ contribution at the peak. The ELCC values come from the CPUC’s 2023 study and the hydro and firm derates are stated assumptions. The ERCOT hazards were estimated over ten to twelve months during a surge and the no-studies hazard is an upper bound. Several ERCOT and PJM values were transcribed from chart images and are labelled as such. The reserve margin is an assumed range with no raw file behind it. Data center energy in 2030 is the annual rate at the end-2030 level, which overstates calendar-year 2030 energy for a load still ramping. Data center load is treated as flat at the system peak, which the CEC’s own profiles support at 85 to 90 percent. The headroom replication uses seven years of load rather than Duke’s nine and a cleaning of its own, and the winter threshold decides most of the answer. No project-level California request data exist outside SCE, so the tier probabilities could not be estimated from California’s own attrition. The CEC’s utility-supplied ramp schedules are not public, which is why the replicated 2030 components differ from the published ones by 2 to 6 percent.

## 6.6 Future work

The monthly snapshot job that has run since the start of the project will, by the end of 2027, hold enough vintages of the CEC docket, ERCOT’s queue, PJM’s forecast and EIA-860M to estimate California’s own tier transition rates and to test the ERCOT-calibrated case against what ERCOT’s Batch Zero actually energizes. Matching SCE’s project-level database to Epoch AI’s facility timelines would give the first California check of paper requests against visible construction. Hourly profiles of the existing data center load, which the CEC has from utility interval meters but has published only as ratios, would replace the flat-load assumption in both the gap and the headroom. And the 2026 IEPR, which proposes a longer milestone list from inquiry to ramp, will be the first vintage against which the taxonomy of Table 5.21 can be tested.

Two measurement regimes outside the crosswalk show what California could publish. Ireland’s statistics office meters data center consumption directly: 6,969 GWh and 22 percent of metered electricity in 2024, 7,663 GWh and 23 percent in 2025, up from 5 percent in 2015 [Central Statistics Office, 2026]. A metered series of that kind would replace the four-way range of Chapter 2 outright,

and it is what the EIA pilot survey could become. Kollar and Grady’s spatial analysis places each United States data center against water stress, heat-wave exposure and the emissions intensity of its grid [Kollar and Grady, 2025]; matching their California points (Chapter 3) to SCE’s project-level requests would add the operating-risk dimension that a capacity gap alone does not carry, and that the proposal named as the complement to adequacy.

## 6.7 Conclusion

California’s data center pipeline is 20,677 MW in three tiers, 40 percent of the record CAISO peak and twenty times the load that exists (RQ1). Weighted by the CEC’s own parameters, which this report reproduces, and set against a supply side weighted by California’s own completion record, the 2030 gap between demand growth and supply growth is 50 TWh and 7.2 GW at the median, with data centers 18 TWh and 2.3 GW of it, against an upper bound of 202 to 242 TWh and 25 to 30 GW (RQ2). The regimes that count planned load differ most in timeliness, verification and public access, and the same requests are 20,677 MW under California’s, Texas’s and Finland’s counting rules, 5,086 MW under PJM’s and the Texas forecast rule, about 2,400 MW at ERCOT’s realized rates and about 1,000 MW as measured load (RQ3). The existing system holds 3.8 GW of headroom at 0.5 percent curtailment, enough for the probability-weighted data center load twice over and for half of the weighted peak gap, but for less than a fifth of the upper bound (RQ4). The method is the result: a forecast that can be rebuilt, a supply side discounted the same way, and a gap with its uncertainty and its drivers named.

## Appendix A

# Provenance of Figures and Quoted Numbers

Every figure in this report is drawn by a script from files in `data/processed/`, which are themselves produced from raw downloads recorded in `data/raw/manifest.csv` with their URL, access date and SHA-256. The tables below list, for each figure, the processed files it is drawn from, the raw sources behind them and the code that produces them. Headline values quoted in the text are printed on the figures or appear in the chapter tables; the few numbers that appear only in prose (source-document figures such as EPRI's state total, and ratios derived from tabulated values) are listed with their sources in `docs/DATA_NOTES.md`, which also records every data limit found during the audits. Rebuilding is one command per chapter (`make ch1`, `make ch2`, `make ch3`, `make ch4`); the standalone bundle reproduces every output byte for byte.

Table A.1: Chapter 2 figures: processed files, raw sources and code.

| Figure  | Content                                                                                                                                        | Processed files (data/processed)                                                                                                                                   | Raw sources (manifest ids)                                                                                                                                    | Code                                                                                                                                            |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| fig1_01 | Load duration curves; annual demand range, record peak, load factor                                                                            | chl_load_duration_curves.csv; chl_ciso_annual_summary.csv; ciso_hourly_2019_2025_clean.parquet                                                                     | eia930_balance_2019_jan_jun .. 2025_jul_dec; caiso_outlook demand and fuelsource (fills, artifact filter)                                                     | chl_baseline.load_eia930_ciso, clean_demand_against_ciso, fill_from_ciso, duration_curves; run_chapter1 step 1                                  |
| fig1_02 | Net-load duration curves; minimum net load; hours below zero with and without battery charging                                                 | chl_net_load_duration_curves.csv; chl_ciso_annual_summary.csv; ciso_hourly_2019_2025_clean.parquet                                                                 | eia930 balance files; caiso_outlook fuelsource (Batteries)                                                                                                    | chl_baseline.add_storage_adjusted, duration_curves; run_chapter1 step 1                                                                         |
| fig1_03 | Seasonal daily profiles; 12-14h and 20h means for 2019 and 2025                                                                                | chl_seasonal_profiles.csv                                                                                                                                          | eia930 balance files                                                                                                                                          | chl_baseline.seasonal_profiles; run_chapter1 step 1                                                                                             |
| fig1_04 | Top-100 net-load hours by month and hour; median start, Jul-Sep and 17-21h shares                                                              | chl_top100_net_load_hours.csv; chl_top100_net_load_timing.csv                                                                                                      | eia930 balance files                                                                                                                                          | chl_baseline.top_hours, top_hours_timing; run_chapter1 step 1                                                                                   |
| fig1_05 | Day-ahead price duration and diurnal means; extremes; 11-14h and 18-20h mean price ranges                                                      | caiso_dam_lmp_hourly.parquet; chl_price_duration_curves.csv; chl_price_by_hour_of_day.csv; chl_price_stats.csv                                                     | caiso_oasis dam_lmp monthly files (PRC_LMP DAM, DLAP nodes)                                                                                                   | chl_baseline.load_dam_lmp, price_duration, price_by_hour, price_stats; run_chapter1 step 2                                                      |
| fig1_06 | Negative-price hours: full years, matched Jan 1 to Sep 22 windows, by month; share in 10-16h                                                   | chl_negative_price_hours_windows.csv; chl_negative_price_hours_by_month.csv; chl_price_stats.csv                                                                   | caiso_oasis dam_lmp monthly files                                                                                                                             | chl_baseline.negative_hours_by_month, price_stats; run_chapter1 step 2                                                                          |
| fig1_07 | CO2 accounting intensity: annual, duration, diurnal; percentiles; eGRID reference                                                              | chl_carbon_intensity_annual.csv; chl_carbon_intensity_duration.csv; chl_carbon_intensity_diurnal.csv; chl_egrid_camx_2023.json; caiso_co2_intensity_hourly.parquet | caiso_outlook co2 and demand daily files; epa_egrid2023_rev1                                                                                                  | chl_baseline.load_caiso_outlook_hourly, carbon_summary, egrid_camx; run_chapter1 step 3                                                         |
| fig1_08 | Existing data center electricity use: statewide estimate, assumed conversion, sensitivity, utility subset                                      | chl_dc_load_estimates.csv; chl_ca_retail_sales_eia861.csv; chl_svp_fact_sheets.csv; chl_kollar_grady_points_california_flag.csv; chl_bottom_up_inputs.json         | epri_powering_intelligence_2024; cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026; eia861_2019 .. 2024; svp_fact_sheet_2017 .. 2023; kollar_grady_2025_zenodo; epoch_data_centers | chl_baseline.dc_load_estimates, bottom_up_estimate, ca_retail_sales_eia861, svp_fact_sheet_energy, kollar_grady_california; run_chapter1 step 4 |
| fig1_09 | Workshop format: hourly CAISO demand and in-CAISO net generation, 2026; minimum, maximum and mean                                              | chl_hourly_2026_workshop.csv; chl_workshop_stats.csv; caiso_co2_intensity_hourly_2026.parquet; caiso_fuelmix_hourly_2026.parquet                                   | eia930_balance_2026_jan_jun .. 2026_jul_dec; caiso_outlook demand and fuelsource 2026 (artifact filter)                                                       | chl_baseline.load_eia930_ciso, clean_demand_against_ciso, hourly_stats; run_chapter1 step 5                                                     |
| fig1_10 | Workshop format: hourly day-ahead prices at the three DLAPs, January 2025 to September 2026; minimum, maximum and mean                         | caiso_dam_lmp_hourly.parquet; chl_workshop_stats.csv                                                                                                               | caiso_oasis dam_lmp monthly files 2025-01 .. 2026-09                                                                                                          | chl_baseline.load_dam_lmp, hourly_stats; run_chapter1 step 5                                                                                    |
| fig1_11 | Workshop format: hourly CO2 intensity of CAISO demand (accounting) and of in-CAISO generation (production factor), 2026                        | chl_carbon_intensity_hourly_2026.csv; chl_workshop_stats.csv; caiso_co2_intensity_hourly_2026.parquet; caiso_fuelmix_hourly_2026.parquet                           | caiso_outlook co2, demand and fuelsource 2026 daily files                                                                                                     | chl_baseline.load_caiso_outlook_hourly, load_caiso_fuelmix_hourly, production_intensity, hourly_stats; run_chapter1 step 5                      |
| fig1_12 | Workshop format: gross imports and exports of CAISO by month, January 2025 to August 2026, from the neighbour-level interchange; annual totals | chl_imports_exports_monthly.csv; ciso_interchange_gross_2025_2026.parquet                                                                                          | eia930_interchange_2025_jan_jun .. 2026_jul_dec; eia930_balance_2025_jan_jun .. 2026_jul_dec (net check)                                                      | chl_baseline.load_eia930_interchange_ciso, monthly_imports_exports; run_chapter1 step 5                                                         |
| fig1_13 | Workshop format: hourly wind and solar generation in CAISO, 2026, against installed nameplate in the CAISO balancing authority                 | chl_hourly_2026_workshop.csv; chl_installed_wind_solar_2026_07.csv; chl_workshop_stats.csv                                                                         | eia930_balance_2026_jan_jun .. 2026_jul_dec; eia860m_2026_07                                                                                                  | chl_baseline.load_eia930_ciso, eia860m_ba_capacity, hourly_stats; run_chapter1 step 5                                                           |

Table A.2: Chapter 3 figures: processed files, raw sources and code.

| Figure  | Content                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Processed files (data/processed)                                                                                                                                                      | Raw sources (manifest ids)                                                                                                                                                                                               | Code                                                                                                                     |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| fig2_01 | Census data center construction spending with ChatGPT annotation; month-over-month growth; shares of nonresidential construction                                                                                                          | ch2_census_c30_data_center.csv                                                                                                                                                        | census_c30_privsatime; census_c30_privtime                                                                                                                                                                               | ch2_growth.census_c30; run_chapter2 step 1                                                                               |
| fig2_02 | Log-linear trends, Chow test, Bai-Perron breaks, segment growth, sequential test; ARIMA and ETS forecasts with bands and backtest                                                                                                         | ch2_census_break_summary.json; ch2_census_bai_perron.csv; ch2_census_segment_growth.csv; ch2_census_forecast_arima.csv; ch2_census_forecast_ets.csv; ch2_census_forecast_backtest.csv | census_c30_privsatime                                                                                                                                                                                                    | ch2_growth.chow_test, bai_perron, sequential_supf, arima_forecast, ets_forecast, backtest_forecasts; run_chapter2 step 2 |
| fig2_03 | California proxies: QCEW employment and establishments, CBRE Silicon Valley construction and inventory, Epoch cumulative power; break-test summary                                                                                        | ch2_qcew_518210_california.csv; ch2_cbre_california.csv; ch2_epoch_timeline.csv; ch2_break_test_comparison.csv                                                                        | qcew_518210_2014q1 .. 2026q1; cbre_*_infogram tables via cbre_california_market_series.csv; epoch_data_center_timelines; epoch_data_centers                                                                              | ch2_growth.qcew_california, cbre_california, epoch_timeline, break_analysis; run_chapter2 step 3                         |
| fig2_04 | Energization requests by vintage and tier; Nevada separated; SCE cancellations; PG E pipeline; ratios to CAISO record peak and existing load                                                                                              | ch2_tier_vintages.csv; ch2_rq1_denominators.json; ch1_dc_load_estimates.csv                                                                                                           | cec_dc_forecast_2024iepr; cec_prelim_dc_forecast_2025; cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026; cec_assembly_hearing_2026_01_28; cec_tn266008; cec_tn268459; cec_tn272026; cec_tn272065; cec_tn272807; caiso_key_statistics_2026_08 | ch2_growth.tier_vintages; run_chapter2 steps 4 and 5                                                                     |
| fig2_05 | Workshop format: current data center capacity (SVP cluster within the statewide 2023 estimate; CEC existing peak) and statistics of the projects by stage with ratios to the existing peak and the CAISO record peak; largest SCE request | ch2_project_statistics.csv; ch2_sce_largest_requests.csv; dc_load_estimates.csv; ch2_rq1_denominators.json                                                                            | cec_assembly_hearing_2026_01_28; cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026; cec_tn268459; epi_powering_intelligence_2024; svp_fact_sheet_2023; svp_assembly_hearing_2026_01_28; caiso_key_statistics_2026_08                          | ch2_growth.sce_largest_requests; run_chapter2 step 6                                                                     |
| fig2_06 | Workshop format: annual energy of the requests (flat and at the CEC utilization) in electric-car years; existing 2023 use as reference                                                                                                    | ch2_ev_equivalents.csv; ch2_sce_largest_requests.csv; ch1_dc_load_estimates.csv                                                                                                       | cec_assembly_hearing_2026_01_28; cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026; cec_tn268459; epi_powering_intelligence_2024                                                                                                              | run_chapter2 step 6 (3 MWh per car-year assumption from Manner 2026)                                                     |

Table A.3: Chapter 4 figures: processed files, raw sources and code.

| Figure  | Content                                                                                                                        | Processed files (data/processed)                                                                                                                                                     | Raw sources (manifest ids)                                                                                               | Code                                                                                                                              |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| fig3_01 | In-state generation by resource and CEC net imports 2010-2025; shares                                                          | ch3_supply_by_year.csv; ch3_eia923_generation_by_resource.csv; ch3_cec_generation_multi_year.csv                                                                                     | eia923_2010 .. 2025; cec_elec_energy_generation_page; ch1 EIA-930 imports                                                | ch3_supply.eia923_ca_generation, cec_multi_year_generation; run_chapter3 step 1                                                   |
| fig3_02 | Operable capacity by technology; battery power and energy; CAISO curtailment; July 2026 snapshot                               | ch3_eia860_capacity_by_resource.csv; ch3_battery_capacity.csv; ch3_caiso_curtailment_annual.csv; ch3_capacity_snapshot_2026_07.json                                                  | eia860_2010 .. 2025; eia860m_2026_07; caiso_curtailments_monthly_csv                                                     | ch3_supply.eia860_ca_capacity, eia860_ca_battery_energy, caiso_curtailment_annual, eia860m_capacity_snapshot; run_chapter3 step 1 |
| fig3_03 | Scheduled retirements: EIA-860M planned dates and once-through-cooling compliance dates                                        | ch3_eia860m_planned_retirements.csv; ch3_otc_units.csv                                                                                                                               | eia860m_2026_07; swrcb_otc_policy_2023                                                                                   | ch3_supply.retirement_schedule; run_chapter3 step 2                                                                               |
| fig3_04 | Realization model: outcomes by vintage and technology; logistic model; delay and cumulative-incidence curves                   | ch3_vintage_outcomes.csv; ch3_realization_by_vintage.csv; ch3_realization_by_technology.csv; ch3_logit_coefficients.csv; ch3_logit_summary.json; ch3_delay_km.csv; ch3_delay_cif.csv | eia860m_2016_01 .. 2022_01; eia860m_2016_12 .. 2025_12                                                                   | ch3_supply.eia860m_vintage_outcomes, fit_completion_logit, km_delay; run_chapter3 step 3                                          |
| fig3_05 | Capacity, energy and ELCC-derated peak in 2030: existing fleet and three cases                                                 | ch3_cases_2030.csv; ch3_cases_2030_summary.json; ch3_planned_current_weighted.csv; ch3_existing_capacity_2025.csv; ch3_capacity_factors.csv; ch3_elcc_values.csv                     | eia860m_2026_07; eia860m_2025_12; cpuc_e3_astrape_incremental_elcc_2023                                                  | ch3_supply.current_planned, cases_2030, capacity_factors, elcc_table; run_chapter3 step 4                                         |
| fig3_06 | Workshop format: electricity production by technology, 2025 as generated and the three 2030 cases at realised capacity factors | ch3_production_projection.csv; ch3_eia923_generation_by_resource.csv; ch3_cases_2030.csv; ch1_ciso_annual_summary.csv                                                                | eia923_2010 .. 2025; eia860m_2026_07; cpuc_e3_astrape_incremental_elcc_2023; eia930_balance_2019_jan_jun .. 2025_jul_dec | run_chapter3 step 5 (groups the chapter 3 case table and the EIA-923 2025 generation)                                             |

Table A.4: Chapter 5 figures: processed files, raw sources and code.

| Figure  | Content                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Processed files (data/processed)                                                                                                                                                                          | Raw sources (manifest ids)                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Code                                                                                                                                                                         |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| fig4_01 | Data center demand in 2030 under each counting rule; statewide peak by IEPR case against ELCC supply                                                                                                      | ch4_demand_cases_2030.csv; ch4_demand_totals_2030.csv; ch4_cec_replication.csv; ch4_cec_ramp_profile.csv; ch4_ca_tiers.csv; ch4_iepr_growth_summary.csv; ch4_ercot_chain.csv; ch3_cases_2030_summary.json | cec_assembly_hearing_2026_01_28; cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026; cec_tn268722 .. 268727 (CED 2025 forms); cec_tn268124; cec_tn268824; ERCOT decks and monthlies (see fig4_05); pjm_lar_summary_2025_11_24                       | ch4_gap.ca_tiers, cec_parameters, cec_forecast_replication, ced2025_scenarios, iepr_growth_cases, ercot_chain, demand_cases_2030, demand_totals_2030; run_chapter4 steps 1-3 |
| fig4_02 | Monte Carlo distributions of the 2030 energy and net-peak gap, by IEPR case; upper bound                                                                                                                  | ch4_mc_draws.parquet; ch4_mc_summary.csv; ch4_upper_bound_2030.csv; ch4_mc_inputs.csv; ch4_mc_key_numbers.json                                                                                            | chapter 3 outputs (eia860m_2026_07, eia860m_2025_12, cpuc_e3_astrape_incremental_elcc_2023, eia923, cec_elec_energy_generation_page); CED 2025 forms as above                                                                 | ch4_gap.SupplyModel, mc_inputs, monte_carlo, evaluate_gap, summarize, upper_bound_rows; run_chapter4 step 4                                                                  |
| fig4_03 | One-at-a-time tornado and Sobol indices for both gaps                                                                                                                                                     | ch4_tornado.csv; ch4_sobol.csv; ch4_mc_draws.parquet                                                                                                                                                      | as fig4_02                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | ch4_gap.tornado, sobol_indices (SALib); run_chapter4 step 5                                                                                                                  |
| fig4_04 | Curtailment-enabled headroom on CAISO hourly demand; hours curtailed; headroom against the cases and the gap                                                                                              | ch4_headroom_curve.csv; ch4_headroom_summary.csv; ch4_headroom_detail.csv; ch4_headroom_by_year.csv; ch4_headroom_vs_gap.csv; ch4_energy_side.csv; ciso_hourly_2019_2025_clean.parquet                    | eia930_balance_2019 .. 2025 (CISO adjusted demand); duke_rethinking_load_growth_2025_mirror (method, CAISO values); caiso_oasis_dam_lmp; caiso_curtailments_monthly_csv                                                       | ch4_gap.headroom, headroom_by_year; run_chapter4 step 6                                                                                                                      |
| fig4_05 | ERCOT tracked requests by month, approvals and observed load, queue by status at each snapshot                                                                                                            | ch4_ercot_queue_monthly.csv; ch4_ercot_approvals_monthly.csv; ch4_ercot_status_snapshots.csv; ch4_ercot_narrative.csv; ch4_ercot_transition_rates.csv                                                     | ercot_board_2025_12_system_planning; ercot_tac_2026_03_large_load_status; ercot_monthly_2025_07 .. 2026_06; ercot_house_hearing_2026_04_09; ercot_board_2026_05_interconnection_update; ercot_ops_overview_2026_04 .. 2026_08 | ch4_gap.ercot_series, ercot_transition_rates; run_chapter4 steps 2 and 7                                                                                                     |
| fig4_06 | CAISO hourly intensity 2025 and emissions of a flat, curtailed or shifted 1 MW load                                                                                                                       | ch4_emissions_flat_vs_flexible.csv; caiso_co2_intensity_hourly.parquet                                                                                                                                    | caiso_outlook_co2_and_demand_daily_files                                                                                                                                                                                      | ch4_gap.flat_vs_flexible_emissions; run_chapter4 step 8                                                                                                                      |
| fig4_07 | Scored crosswalk of the seven regimes (0-3 per criterion)                                                                                                                                                 | ch4_regime_scores.csv; ch4_regime_rubric.csv; ch4_regime_crosswalk.csv                                                                                                                                    | the regime sources of Table ch4_crosswalk (EK, CEC, ERCOT, PJM, EIA, Texas SB 6, FERC RM26-4 filings)                                                                                                                         | ch4_regimes.regime_scores, crosswalk_matrix; run_chapter4 step 7                                                                                                             |
| fig4_08 | Data centers as a share of California's electricity: history (EPRI 2023, CEC 1,000 MW converted), CED 2025 Planning and Local Reliability trajectories with the existing range, and the 2030 upper bounds | ch4_dc_share_trajectory.csv; ch1_dc_load_estimates.csv; ch4_ced2025_data_center_energy.csv; ch4_ced2025_scenarios.csv; ch4_demand_cases_2030.csv                                                          | epri_powering_intelligence_2024; cec_dc_methodology_memo_2026; eia861_2019 .. 2024; cec_tn268727; cec_tn268725; cec_tn268824; cec_tn268124; cec_assembly_hearing_2026_01_28                                                   | run_chapter4 step 9                                                                                                                                                          |

## Appendix B

# Manifest Rows Behind the Figures

Each figure’s source line names manifest ids. This appendix prints the manifest row behind every id that any figure names: owner, access date, SHA-256 and URL, as recorded in `data/raw/manifest_frozen_2026-09-26.csv` at the data freeze. Files that come in dated series (the EIA-930 half-year files, the EIA-923, EIA-860 and EIA-860M vintages, the QCEW quarters, the ERCOT newsletters, the CBRE Infogram tables) are listed on one line each with their count and the URL of the first file; the CAISO Today’s Outlook ids stand for directories of daily files whose own manifest sits beside them. The machine-readable list is `data/processed/ch5_manifest_rows_used.csv`, and the appendix build fails if any source label in a figure does not resolve to a manifest row.

Table B.1: Manifest rows behind the figures: every source id named in a figure’s source line, with owner, access date, SHA-256 (first 12 hex digits) and URL; groups of dated files are listed on one line with their count and the URL of the first file. The frozen manifest holds every row in full.

| Manifest id (figures)                                                       | Owner          | Access date | SHA-256      | URL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|-------------|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| caiso_comments__<br>ferc_rm26_4_2025__<br>11 (fig4_07)                      | CAISO          | 2026-09-22  | 7bb021c162fe | <a href="https://www.caiso.com/documents/nov-21-2025-comments-on-the-advanced-notice-of-proposed-rulemaking-interconnection-of-large-loads-to-the-interstate-transmission-system-rm26-4.pdf">https://www.caiso.com/documents/nov-21-2025-comments-on-the-advanced-notice-of-proposed-rulemaking-interconnection-of-large-loads-to-the-interstate-transmission-system-rm26-4.pdf</a> |
| caiso_curtailments__<br>monthly_csv (fig3_02<br>fig4_04)                    | CAISO          | 2026-09-21  | 8a283e4d5ab5 | <a href="https://www.caiso.com/content/charts/curtailments-monthly.csv">https://www.caiso.com/content/charts/curtailments-monthly.csv</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| caiso_dam_lmp__<br>monthly_dlap (fig1__<br>05 fig1_06 fig1_10<br>fig4_04)   | CAISO<br>OASIS | 2026-09-21  | 55e58dd29ca1 | <a href="https://oasis.caiso.com/oasisapi/SingleZip?queryname=PRC_LMP&amp;market_run_id=DAM&amp;version=12">https://oasis.caiso.com/oasisapi/SingleZip?queryname=PRC_LMP&amp;market_run_id=DAM&amp;version=12</a>                                                                                                                                                                   |
| caiso_dam_lmp__<br>monthly_hubs (fig1__<br>05 fig1_06 fig1_10<br>fig4_04)   | CAISO<br>OASIS | 2026-09-21  | 1ece080a200c | <a href="https://oasis.caiso.com/oasisapi/SingleZip?queryname=PRC_LMP&amp;market_run_id=DAM&amp;version=12">https://oasis.caiso.com/oasisapi/SingleZip?queryname=PRC_LMP&amp;market_run_id=DAM&amp;version=12</a>                                                                                                                                                                   |
| caiso_key_statistics__<br>2026_08 (fig2_04<br>fig2_05)                      | CAISO          | 2026-09-21  | b1c98ee0da95 | <a href="https://www.caiso.com/documents/key-statistics-aug-2026.pdf">https://www.caiso.com/documents/key-statistics-aug-2026.pdf</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| caiso_outlook_co2<br>(fig1_07 fig1_11 fig4__<br>06)                         | CAISO          | 2026-09-21  | f4f6aeda05d4 | <a href="https://www.caiso.com/outlook/history/YYYYMMDD/co2.csv">https://www.caiso.com/outlook/history/YYYYMMDD/co2.csv</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| caiso_outlook__<br>demand (fig1_01<br>fig1_07 fig1_09 fig1__<br>11 fig4_06) | CAISO          | 2026-09-21  | 76bf6c866f07 | <a href="https://www.caiso.com/outlook/history/YYYYMMDD/demand.csv">https://www.caiso.com/outlook/history/YYYYMMDD/demand.csv</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

| Manifest id (figures)                                                                                                           | Owner                       | Access date                    | SHA-256                      | URL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| caiso_outlook_<br>fuelsource (fig1_01<br>fig1_02 fig1_09 fig1_11)                                                               | CAISO                       | 2026-09-21                     | 8c8dced65ca7                 | <a href="https://www.caiso.com/outlook/history/YYYYMMDD/fuelsource.csv">https://www.caiso.com/outlook/history/YYYYMMDD/fuelsource.csv</a>                                                                                                                         |
| cbre_h1_2023_<br>overview_infogram_<br>fig1 to cbre_h1_<br>2026_silicon_valley_<br>infogram_fig6 (28<br>files; figures fig2_03) | CBRE<br>(Infogram<br>embed) | 2026-09-21<br>to<br>2026-09-21 | dc992936275c<br>(first file) | <a href="https://e.infogram.com/0bf12807-e98f-428c-b61b-d61dacecec5d">https://e.infogram.com/0bf12807-e98f-428c-b61b-d61dacecec5d</a> (first file)                                                                                                                |
| cbre_h2_2023_<br>overview_infogram_<br>fig1 to cbre_h2_<br>2025_silicon_valley_<br>infogram_fig5 (22<br>files; figures fig2_03) | CBRE<br>(Infogram<br>embed) | 2026-09-21<br>to<br>2026-09-21 | 56c258539eff<br>(first file) | <a href="https://e.infogram.com/ee5b50d9-abcb-4bba-848c-7769aab3b260">https://e.infogram.com/ee5b50d9-abcb-4bba-848c-7769aab3b260</a> (first file)                                                                                                                |
| cec_assembly_<br>hearing_2026_01_28<br>(fig2_04 fig2_05 fig2_06 fig4_01 fig4_07<br>fig4_08)                                     | CEC / CA<br>Assembly        | 2026-09-21                     | 79ba096ebff8                 | <a href="https://autl.assembly.ca.gov/media/1402">https://autl.assembly.ca.gov/media/1402</a>                                                                                                                                                                     |
| cec_dc_forecast_<br>2024iepr (fig2_04)                                                                                          | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | 5b673761ad74                 | <a href="https://www.energy.ca.gov/sites/default/files/2025-03/Data_Center_Forecast_Final_ada.pdf">https://www.energy.ca.gov/sites/default/files/2025-03/Data_Center_Forecast_Final_ada.pdf</a>                                                                   |
| cec_dc_<br>methodology_memo_<br>2026 (fig1_08 fig2_04<br>fig2_05 fig2_06 fig4_01 fig4_07 fig4_08)                               | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | 06b6449e84f2                 | <a href="https://www.energy.ca.gov/sites/default/files/2026-04/Data_Center_Methodology_Memo_ada.pdf">https://www.energy.ca.gov/sites/default/files/2026-04/Data_Center_Methodology_Memo_ada.pdf</a>                                                               |
| cec_elec_energy_<br>generation_page<br>(fig3_01 fig4_02 fig4_03)                                                                | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | fdfb018724c6                 | <a href="https://www.energy.ca.gov/data-reports/energy-almanac/california-electricity-data/california-electrical-energy-generation">https://www.energy.ca.gov/data-reports/energy-almanac/california-electricity-data/california-electrical-energy-generation</a> |
| cec_prelim_dc_<br>forecast_2025 (fig2_04)                                                                                       | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | b99ff97ba18f                 | <a href="https://www.energy.ca.gov/sites/default/files/2025-11/2025_IEPR_Preliminary_Data_Center_Forecast_ada.pdf">https://www.energy.ca.gov/sites/default/files/2025-11/2025_IEPR_Preliminary_Data_Center_Forecast_ada.pdf</a>                                   |
| cec_tn266008 (fig2_04)                                                                                                          | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | 7ca6289050a6                 | <a href="https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=266008">https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=266008</a>                                                                                                                                   |
| cec_tn268124 (fig4_01<br>fig4_02 fig4_03 fig4_08)                                                                               | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | acaf3499f858                 | <a href="https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=268124">https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=268124</a>                                                                                                                                   |
| cec_tn268459 (fig2_04<br>fig2_05 fig2_06 fig4_07)                                                                               | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | 510bfd2b60a                  | <a href="https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=268459">https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=268459</a>                                                                                                                                   |
| cec_tn268722 (fig4_01<br>fig4_02 fig4_03)                                                                                       | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | 5dc8fc49111e                 | <a href="https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=268722">https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=268722</a>                                                                                                                                   |
| cec_tn268725 (fig4_01<br>fig4_02 fig4_03 fig4_08)                                                                               | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | dba48fac672f                 | <a href="https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=268725">https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=268725</a>                                                                                                                                   |
| cec_tn268726 (fig4_01<br>fig4_02 fig4_03)                                                                                       | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | 541f24a159fa                 | <a href="https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=268726">https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=268726</a>                                                                                                                                   |
| cec_tn268727 (fig4_01<br>fig4_02 fig4_03 fig4_08)                                                                               | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | 3a0c449e322f                 | <a href="https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=268727">https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=268727</a>                                                                                                                                   |
| cec_tn268824 (fig4_01<br>fig4_02 fig4_03 fig4_08)                                                                               | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | aa1720541d2e                 | <a href="https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=268824">https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=268824</a>                                                                                                                                   |
| cec_tn272026 (fig2_04<br>fig4_07)                                                                                               | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | 4694d5083fa4                 | <a href="https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=272026">https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=272026</a>                                                                                                                                   |
| cec_tn272065 (fig2_04)                                                                                                          | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | 31a5b0360827                 | <a href="https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=272065">https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=272065</a>                                                                                                                                   |
| cec_tn272807 (fig2_04)                                                                                                          | CEC                         | 2026-09-21                     | 2ed53e0e679c                 | <a href="https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=272807">https://efiling.energy.ca.gov/GetDocument.aspx?tn=272807</a>                                                                                                                                   |
| census_c30_<br>privsatime (fig2_01<br>fig2_02)                                                                                  | U.S.<br>Census<br>Bureau    | 2026-09-21                     | d71e721c2e46                 | <a href="https://www.census.gov/construction/c30/xlsx/privsatime.xlsx">https://www.census.gov/construction/c30/xlsx/privsatime.xlsx</a>                                                                                                                           |

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| census_c30_privtime (fig2_01)                                                                                                                                  | U.S. Census Bureau                                                               | 2026-09-21               | 4abbfdca1db6              | <a href="https://www.census.gov/construction/c30/xlsx/privtime.xlsx">https://www.census.gov/construction/c30/xlsx/privtime.xlsx</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| cpuc_e3_astrape_incremental_elcc_2023 (fig3_05 fig3_06 fig4_02 fig4_03)                                                                                        | CPUC / E3 / Astrape (via Wayback Machine capture 2025-11-20)                     | 2026-09-21               | 01be5998d006              | <a href="http://web.archive.org/web/20251120173029id/https://www.cpuc.ca.gov/-/media/cpuc-website/divisions/energy-division/documents/integrated-resource-plan-and-long-term-procurement-plan-irp-ltpp/20230210_irp_e3_astrape_updated_incremental_elcc_study.pdf">http://web.archive.org/web/20251120173029id/https://www.cpuc.ca.gov/-/media/cpuc-website/divisions/energy-division/documents/integrated-resource-plan-and-long-term-procurement-plan-irp-ltpp/20230210_irp_e3_astrape_updated_incremental_elcc_study.pdf</a> |
| duke_rethinking_load_growth_2025_mirror (fig4_04)                                                                                                              | Duke Nicholas Institute (mirror: Illinois Commerce Commission docket P2025-0679) | 2026-09-21               | e11c266266a5              | <a href="https://www.icc.illinois.gov/docket/P2025-0679/documents/371138/files/650737.pdf">https://www.icc.illinois.gov/docket/P2025-0679/documents/371138/files/650737.pdf</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| eia860_2010 to eia860_2025 (16 files; figures fig3_02)                                                                                                         | EIA                                                                              | 2026-09-21 to 2026-09-21 | 2de9ea2c4828 (first file) | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia860/archive/xls/eia8602010.zip">https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia860/archive/xls/eia8602010.zip</a> (first file)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| eia860m_2016_01 to eia860m_2026_07 (18 files; figures fig1_13 fig3_02 fig3_03 fig3_04 fig3_05 fig3_06 fig4_02 fig4_03)                                         | EIA                                                                              | 2026-09-21 to 2026-09-21 | 6876f2e13d08 (first file) | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia860m/archive/xls/january_generator2016.xlsx">https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia860m/archive/xls/january_generator2016.xlsx</a> (first file)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| eia861_2019 (fig1_08 fig4_08)                                                                                                                                  | EIA                                                                              | 2026-09-21               | 25043e6baa8f              | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia861/archive/zip/f8612019.zip">https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia861/archive/zip/f8612019.zip</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| eia861_2020 (fig1_08 fig4_08)                                                                                                                                  | EIA                                                                              | 2026-09-21               | abed9f678bd7              | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia861/archive/zip/f8612020.zip">https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia861/archive/zip/f8612020.zip</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| eia861_2021 (fig1_08 fig4_08)                                                                                                                                  | EIA                                                                              | 2026-09-21               | 6008618e91bc              | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia861/archive/zip/f8612021.zip">https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia861/archive/zip/f8612021.zip</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| eia861_2022 (fig1_08 fig4_08)                                                                                                                                  | EIA                                                                              | 2026-09-21               | fe2530295d93              | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia861/archive/zip/f8612022.zip">https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia861/archive/zip/f8612022.zip</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| eia861_2023 (fig1_08 fig4_08)                                                                                                                                  | EIA                                                                              | 2026-09-21               | 0acd67ab84cd              | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia861/archive/zip/f8612023.zip">https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia861/archive/zip/f8612023.zip</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| eia861_2024 (fig1_08 fig4_08)                                                                                                                                  | EIA                                                                              | 2026-09-21               | 77ce49c60ac5              | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia861/zip/f8612024.zip">https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia861/zip/f8612024.zip</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| eia923_2010 to eia923_2025 (16 files; figures fig3_01 fig3_06 fig4_02 fig4_03)                                                                                 | EIA                                                                              | 2026-09-21 to 2026-09-21 | ad78232bbc2c (first file) | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia923/archive/xls/f923_2010.zip">https://www.eia.gov/electricity/data/eia923/archive/xls/f923_2010.zip</a> (first file)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| eia930_balance_2019_jan_jun to eia930_balance_2026_jul_dec (16 files; figures fig1_01 fig1_02 fig1_03 fig1_04 fig1_09 fig1_12 fig1_13 fig3_01 fig3_06 fig4_04) | EIA                                                                              | 2026-09-21 to 2026-09-22 | 02548d6bc49f (first file) | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/electricity/gridmonitor/sixMonthFiles/EIA930_BALANCE_2019_Jan_Jun.csv">https://www.eia.gov/electricity/gridmonitor/sixMonthFiles/EIA930_BALANCE_2019_Jan_Jun.csv</a> (first file)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| eia930_interchange_2025_jan_jun (fig1_12)                                                                                                                      | EIA                                                                              | 2026-09-21               | 26346191ea9b              | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/electricity/gridmonitor/sixMonthFiles/EIA930_INTERCHANGE_2025_Jan_Jun.csv">https://www.eia.gov/electricity/gridmonitor/sixMonthFiles/EIA930_INTERCHANGE_2025_Jan_Jun.csv</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| eia930_interchange_2025_jul_dec (fig1_12)                                                                                                                      | EIA                                                                              | 2026-09-21               | 6e9a627d9266              | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/electricity/gridmonitor/sixMonthFiles/EIA930_INTERCHANGE_2025_Jul_Dec.csv">https://www.eia.gov/electricity/gridmonitor/sixMonthFiles/EIA930_INTERCHANGE_2025_Jul_Dec.csv</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| eia930_interchange_2026_jan_jun (fig1_12)                                                                                                                      | EIA                                                                              | 2026-09-21               | c0337a3b4c94              | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/electricity/gridmonitor/sixMonthFiles/EIA930_INTERCHANGE_2026_Jan_Jun.csv">https://www.eia.gov/electricity/gridmonitor/sixMonthFiles/EIA930_INTERCHANGE_2026_Jan_Jun.csv</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

| Manifest id (figures)                                             | Owner    | Access date | SHA-256      | URL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------------|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| eia930_interchange_2026_jul_dec (fig1_12)                         | EIA      | 2026-09-21  | e3039f26a14d | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/electricity/gridmonitor/sixMonthFiles/EIA930_INTERCHANGE_2026_Jul_Dec.csv">https://www.eia.gov/electricity/gridmonitor/sixMonthFiles/EIA930_INTERCHANGE_2026_Jul_Dec.csv</a>                                                       |
| eia_press585_dc_pilot_surveys (fig4_07)                           | EIA      | 2026-09-21  | 44f8ab9e696e | <a href="https://www.eia.gov/pressroom/releases/press585.php">https://www.eia.gov/pressroom/releases/press585.php</a>                                                                                                                                           |
| ek_green_investments_dashboard (fig4_07)                          | EK       | 2026-09-26  | 9972c9c71d0a | <a href="https://ek.fi/en/green-investments-in-finland/">https://ek.fi/en/green-investments-in-finland/</a>                                                                                                                                                     |
| epa_egrid2023_rev1 (fig1_07)                                      | U.S. EPA | 2026-09-21  | e79bca56148f | <a href="https://www.epa.gov/system/files/documents/2025-01/egrid2023_data_rev1.xlsx">https://www.epa.gov/system/files/documents/2025-01/egrid2023_data_rev1.xlsx</a>                                                                                           |
| epoch_data_center_timelines (fig2_03)                             | Epoch AI | 2026-09-22  | 5686736861be | <a href="https://epoch.ai/data/data_centers/data_center_timelines.csv">https://epoch.ai/data/data_centers/data_center_timelines.csv</a>                                                                                                                         |
| epoch_data_centers (fig1_08 fig2_03)                              | Epoch AI | 2026-09-22  | d4bf18991d2c | <a href="https://epoch.ai/data/data_centers/data_centers.csv">https://epoch.ai/data/data_centers/data_centers.csv</a>                                                                                                                                           |
| epri_powering_intelligence_2024 (fig1_08 fig2_05 fig2_06 fig4_08) | EPRI     | 2026-09-21  | e76ef3021255 | <a href="https://restservice.epri.com/publicdownload/000000003002028905/0/Product">https://restservice.epri.com/publicdownload/000000003002028905/0/Product</a>                                                                                                 |
| ercot_board_2025_12_system_planning (fig4_01 fig4_05)             | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | 99da7eff620f | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2025/12/02/16.2-System-Planning-and-Weatherization-Update_Revised.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2025/12/02/16.2-System-Planning-and-Weatherization-Update_Revised.pdf</a>                                     |
| ercot_board_2026_05_interconnection_update (fig4_01 fig4_05)      | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | 24e3ccc8fb0c | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/05/24/8-Interconnection-and-Grid-Analysis-Update.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/05/24/8-Interconnection-and-Grid-Analysis-Update.pdf</a>                                                             |
| ercot_house_hearing_2026_04_09 (fig4_01 fig4_05 fig4_07)          | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | 0e89b425ca0f | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/04/09/ERCOTLargeLoadUpdate-April19HouseStateAffairsHearing.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/04/09/ERCOTLargeLoadUpdate-April19HouseStateAffairsHearing.pdf</a>                                         |
| ercot_monthly_2025_07 (fig4_01 fig4_05)                           | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | cdd7bb3ceb8c | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2025/08/06/ERCOT-Monthly-July-2025.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2025/08/06/ERCOT-Monthly-July-2025.pdf</a>                                                                                                   |
| ercot_monthly_2025_08 (fig4_01 fig4_05)                           | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | 7f2aala82899 | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2025/09/10/ERCOT-Monthly-August-2025.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2025/09/10/ERCOT-Monthly-August-2025.pdf</a>                                                                                               |
| ercot_monthly_2025_09 (fig4_01 fig4_05)                           | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | 67b18b1ca9c9 | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2025/10/09/ERCOT-Monthly-September-2025.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2025/10/09/ERCOT-Monthly-September-2025.pdf</a>                                                                                         |
| ercot_monthly_2025_10 (fig4_01 fig4_05)                           | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | 6a827f41f6b0 | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2025/11/14/ERCOT-Monthly-October-2025.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2025/11/14/ERCOT-Monthly-October-2025.pdf</a>                                                                                             |
| ercot_monthly_2025_11 (fig4_01 fig4_05 fig4_07)                   | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | 6ee3a27eec5d | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2025/12/19/ERCOT-Monthly-November-2025-FINAL.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2025/12/19/ERCOT-Monthly-November-2025-FINAL.pdf</a>                                                                               |
| ercot_monthly_2025_12 (fig4_01 fig4_05)                           | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | 08edb4d875f9 | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/01/20/ERCOT-Monthly-December-2025-FINAL.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/01/20/ERCOT-Monthly-December-2025-FINAL.pdf</a>                                                                               |
| ercot_monthly_2026_01 (fig4_01 fig4_05)                           | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | 862bf7a68a15 | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/02/13/ERCOT-Monthly-January-2026-FINAL.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/02/13/ERCOT-Monthly-January-2026-FINAL.pdf</a>                                                                                 |
| ercot_monthly_2026_02 (fig4_01 fig4_05)                           | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | 3d21f664f146 | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/03/17/ERCOT-Monthly-February-2026-FINAL.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/03/17/ERCOT-Monthly-February-2026-FINAL.pdf</a>                                                                               |
| ercot_monthly_2026_04 (fig4_01 fig4_05)                           | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | 78879e3172db | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/05/13/ERCOT-Monthly-April-2026-FINAL.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/05/13/ERCOT-Monthly-April-2026-FINAL.pdf</a>                                                                                     |
| ercot_monthly_2026_05 (fig4_01 fig4_05)                           | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | 079d92ddf546 | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/06/19/ERCOT-Monthly-May-2026.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/06/19/ERCOT-Monthly-May-2026.pdf</a>                                                                                                     |
| ercot_monthly_2026_06 (fig4_01 fig4_05)                           | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | 7c55339095a5 | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/07/10/ERCOT-Monthly-June-2026-FINAL.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/07/10/ERCOT-Monthly-June-2026-FINAL.pdf</a>                                                                                       |
| ercot_npr1267_status_report_proposal (fig4_07)                    | ERCOT    | 2026-09-21  | ec247039de77 | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2025/01/08/1267NPRR-01%20Large%20Load%20Interconnection%20Status%20Report%20010825.docx">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2025/01/08/1267NPRR-01%20Large%20Load%20Interconnection%20Status%20Report%20010825.docx</a> |
| ercot_ops_overview_2026_04 (fig4_01 fig4_05)                      | ERCOT    | 2026-09-22  | 002e14196894 | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/05/19/ERCOT-Monthly-Operational-Overview-April-2026.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/05/19/ERCOT-Monthly-Operational-Overview-April-2026.pdf</a>                                                       |

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ercot_ops_overview_2026_06 (fig4_01 fig4_05 fig4_07)                 | ERCOT                                                             | 2026-09-22               | a967182359f6              | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/07/17/ERCOT-Monthly-Operational-Overview-June-2026.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/07/17/ERCOT-Monthly-Operational-Overview-June-2026.pdf</a>                                                                                                                             |
| ercot_ops_overview_2026_07 (fig4_01 fig4_05)                         | ERCOT                                                             | 2026-09-22               | 07f3e1693eff              | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/08/17/ERCOT-Monthly-Operational-Overview-July-2026.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/08/17/ERCOT-Monthly-Operational-Overview-July-2026.pdf</a>                                                                                                                             |
| ercot_ops_overview_2026_08 (fig4_01 fig4_05)                         | ERCOT                                                             | 2026-09-22               | f02f0b38492f              | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/09/16/ERCOT-Monthly-Operational-Overview-August-2026.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/09/16/ERCOT-Monthly-Operational-Overview-August-2026.pdf</a>                                                                                                                         |
| ercot_tac_2026_03_large_load_status (fig4_01 fig4_05 fig4_07)        | ERCOT                                                             | 2026-09-21               | e152e34d90e3              | <a href="https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/03/12/March-TAC-Report.pdf">https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2026/03/12/March-TAC-Report.pdf</a>                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| ferc_news_2026_04_16_large_load (fig4_07)                            | FERC                                                              | 2026-09-22               | 8eb0d1ed382e              | <a href="https://www.ferc.gov/news-events/news/ferc-act-large-load-interconnection-docket-june-2026">https://www.ferc.gov/news-events/news/ferc-act-large-load-interconnection-docket-june-2026</a>                                                                                                                                 |
| ferc_news_2026_06_18_show_cause (fig4_07)                            | FERC                                                              | 2026-09-22               | 74add78d8855              | <a href="https://ferc.gov/news-events/news/ferc-launches-aggressive-targeted-action-speed-large-load-integration">https://ferc.gov/news-events/news/ferc-launches-aggressive-targeted-action-speed-large-load-integration</a>                                                                                                       |
| kollar_grady_2025_zenodo (fig1_08)                                   | Kollar & Grady (Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.17372375)                   | 2026-09-21               | 67fb70c7a5a3              | <a href="https://zenodo.org/records/17372375/files/DataCenterRiskRepository.zip?download=1">https://zenodo.org/records/17372375/files/DataCenterRiskRepository.zip?download=1</a>                                                                                                                                                   |
| nerc_rm26_4_accelerated_plan_2026_03 (fig4_07)                       | NERC                                                              | 2026-09-22               | 969af16ac5e6              | <a href="https://www.nerc.com/globalassets/who-we-are/legal--regulatory/filings--orders/nerc-filings-to-ferc/2026/nerc_accelerated-ll-action-plan_rm26-4_signed.pdf">https://www.nerc.com/globalassets/who-we-are/legal--regulatory/filings--orders/nerc-filings-to-ferc/2026/nerc_accelerated-ll-action-plan_rm26-4_signed.pdf</a> |
| pjm_2026_load_forecast_report (fig4_07)                              | PJM                                                               | 2026-09-21               | 9f2826cfc393              | <a href="https://www.pjm.com/-/media/DotCom/library/reports-notice/load-forecast/2026-load-report.pdf">https://www.pjm.com/-/media/DotCom/library/reports-notice/load-forecast/2026-load-report.pdf</a>                                                                                                                             |
| pjm_2026_load_report_tables (fig4_07)                                | PJM                                                               | 2026-09-22               | 59a62facf819              | <a href="https://www.pjm.com/-/media/DotCom/planning/res-adeq/load-forecast/2026-load-report-tables.xlsx">https://www.pjm.com/-/media/DotCom/planning/res-adeq/load-forecast/2026-load-report-tables.xlsx</a>                                                                                                                       |
| pjm_lar_summary_2025_11_24 (fig4_01 fig4_07)                         | PJM                                                               | 2026-09-22               | c3b8e176edcb              | <a href="https://www.pjm.com/-/media/DotCom/committees-groups/subcommittees/las/2025/20251124/20251124-item-03---large-load-adjustment-requests-summary.pdf">https://www.pjm.com/-/media/DotCom/committees-groups/subcommittees/las/2025/20251124/20251124-item-03---large-load-adjustment-requests-summary.pdf</a>                 |
| qcew_518210_2014q1 to qcew_518210_2026q1 (49 files; figures fig2_03) | BLS                                                               | 2026-09-21 to 2026-09-21 | ebc3a38c9c51 (first file) | <a href="https://data.bls.gov/qcew/data/api/2014/1/industry/518210.csv">https://data.bls.gov/qcew/data/api/2014/1/industry/518210.csv</a> (first file)                                                                                                                                                                              |
| svp_assembly_hearing_2026_01_28 (fig2_05)                            | Silicon Valley Power / CA Assembly                                | 2026-09-21               | 867383779853              | <a href="https://autl.assembly.ca.gov/media/1404">https://autl.assembly.ca.gov/media/1404</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| svp_fact_sheet_2017 (fig1_08)                                        | Silicon Valley Power (via Wayback Machine capture 20260509224755) | 2026-09-21               | e110ccc33a42              | <a href="http://web.archive.org/web/20260509224755id/https://www.siliconvalleypower.com/home/showpublisheddocument/63875/636918608411270000">http://web.archive.org/web/20260509224755id/https://www.siliconvalleypower.com/home/showpublisheddocument/63875/636918608411270000</a>                                                 |
| svp_fact_sheet_2018 (fig1_08)                                        | Silicon Valley Power (via Wayback Machine capture 20260509233703) | 2026-09-21               | 3db781034ebe              | <a href="http://web.archive.org/web/20260509233703id/https://www.siliconvalleypower.com/home/showpublisheddocument/66906/637200353755670000">http://web.archive.org/web/20260509233703id/https://www.siliconvalleypower.com/home/showpublisheddocument/66906/637200353755670000</a>                                                 |

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|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| svp_fact_sheet_2019<br>(fig1_08)         | Silicon Valley Power (via Wayback Machine capture 2026050922 4600) | 2026-09-21  | a3c8f24ca287 | <a href="http://web.archive.org/web/20260509224600id_/https://www.siliconvalleypower.com/home/showpublisheddocument/66908/637200354106170000">http://web.archive.org/web/20260509224600id_/https://www.siliconvalleypower.com/home/showpublisheddocument/66908/637200354106170000</a> |
| svp_fact_sheet_2020<br>(fig1_08)         | Silicon Valley Power (via Wayback Machine capture 2026050923 1536) | 2026-09-21  | ed8189e99969 | <a href="http://web.archive.org/web/20260509231536id_/https://www.siliconvalleypower.com/home/showpublisheddocument/72343/637515110025130000">http://web.archive.org/web/20260509231536id_/https://www.siliconvalleypower.com/home/showpublisheddocument/72343/637515110025130000</a> |
| svp_fact_sheet_2021<br>(fig1_08)         | Silicon Valley Power (via Wayback Machine capture 2026050923 2142) | 2026-09-21  | 6f0568cbb92  | <a href="http://web.archive.org/web/20260509232142id_/https://www.siliconvalleypower.com/home/showpublisheddocument/76639/637812250378500000">http://web.archive.org/web/20260509232142id_/https://www.siliconvalleypower.com/home/showpublisheddocument/76639/637812250378500000</a> |
| svp_fact_sheet_2022<br>(fig1_08)         | Silicon Valley Power (via Wayback Machine capture 2026050922 3802) | 2026-09-21  | 4d89cd6dc5c5 | <a href="http://web.archive.org/web/20260509223802id_/https://www.siliconvalleypower.com/home/showpublisheddocument/79910/638151194612430000">http://web.archive.org/web/20260509223802id_/https://www.siliconvalleypower.com/home/showpublisheddocument/79910/638151194612430000</a> |
| svp_fact_sheet_2023<br>(fig1_08 fig2_05) | Silicon Valley Power (via Wayback Machine capture 2026050922 5205) | 2026-09-21  | ea00c6e9fd2f | <a href="http://web.archive.org/web/20260509225205id_/https://www.siliconvalleypower.com/home/showpublisheddocument/83511/638470585164300000">http://web.archive.org/web/20260509225205id_/https://www.siliconvalleypower.com/home/showpublisheddocument/83511/638470585164300000</a> |
| swrcb_otc_policy_2023 (fig3_03)          | State Water Resources Control Board                                | 2026-09-22  | bcb98e6f102  | <a href="https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/water_issues/programs/ocean/cwa316/docs/otc-policy-2023/otc-policy-2023.pdf">https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/water_issues/programs/ocean/cwa316/docs/otc-policy-2023/otc-policy-2023.pdf</a>                                                   |
| texas_sb6_2025_enrolled (fig4_07)        | Texas Legislature                                                  | 2026-09-21  | d8871039ec5a | <a href="https://capitol.texas.gov/tlodocs/89R/billtext/pdf/SB00006F.pdf">https://capitol.texas.gov/tlodocs/89R/billtext/pdf/SB00006F.pdf</a>                                                                                                                                         |

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